MODULE 1

Becoming an Independent Academic Reader

Big question: How do successful university students read?

University reading is not simply about reading more. It is about choosing the right strategy, identifying important information, and using what you read to support your learning.

By the end of this module, you will be able to:

- use skimming and scanning effectively
- identify main ideas and supporting details
- paraphrase simple academic information
- read actively before, during and after a text
- use context to understand unfamiliar words
- reflect on your own reading habits

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

When you start reading a university text, what do you usually do first?

- ☐ Read from the first sentence and continue carefully.
- ☐ Look at the title, headings and visuals.
- ☐ Search immediately for key words or answers.
- ☐ Read the introduction and conclusion first.
- ☐ Something else: _____

Compare your answer with a partner. What is similar? What is different?

1. Reading Like a University Student

Good academic readers do not use the same method for every text. They change their approach according to their purpose.

> **The best reading strategy is the one that helps you complete your task efficiently.**

Read quickly

to understand the general topic, structure or direction of a text.

Search

to locate one fact, name, date, example or definition.

Read carefully

to understand arguments, evidence and important details.

ACTIVITY 1 · MATCH THE PURPOSE TO THE STRATEGY

Situation	Most useful strategy
You need the date of a midterm examination.	
You are deciding whether an article is useful for an assignment.	
You must explain the writer's argument in class.	
You want to find the meaning of one term in a long chapter.	
You are reviewing your notes before an exam.	

> **Think:** Before reading, ask: *Why am I reading this? What do I need to find or understand?*

QUICK REFLECTION

Which type of reading do you use most often? Which one do you need to practise more?

(2)

LAN 100 | READING SKILLS

Skimming & Scanning

Two ways to read efficiently

Good readers change their reading strategy according to their purpose.

	SKIMMING	SCANNING
Purpose	Understand the **main idea** or general meaning.	Find **one specific piece of information**.
How	Read quickly. Do not stop at every word or unfamiliar expression.	Move your eyes quickly until you locate the detail you need.
Focus on	Titles, headings, first and last sentences, repeated ideas and key words.	Names, dates, numbers, times, places and key words from the question.
Ask yourself	**What is this text mainly about?**	**Where is the information I need?**
Example	Skim an article to decide whether it is relevant.	Scan a timetable to find the time of your class.

Quick Check: Would you skim or scan?

Situation	Skim	Scan
Find tomorrow's exam time.	☐	☐
Understand the main idea of an article.	☐	☐
Find your classroom number.	☐	☐
Decide whether a book interests you.	☐	☐
Find the due date for an assignment.	☐	☐
Understand the overall message of a webpage.	☐	☐

Remember: Skimming = Main idea | Scanning = Specific information

2. Four Core Reading Techniques

Technique	What it helps you do	Typical use
Skimming	Understand the general idea or structure.	Previewing a chapter or article.
Scanning	Find one specific piece of information.	Locating a date, name, number or key term.
Detailed reading	Understand important ideas, evidence and relationships.	Preparing for discussion or writing.
Revision reading	Confirm and strengthen what you already know.	Reviewing notes before an assessment.

ACTIVITY 2 · CHOOSE THE BEST TECHNIQUE

Write **S** (skimming), **SC** (scanning), **D** (detailed reading), or **R** (revision reading).

1. Finding the percentage of students who completed a survey. _____
2. Understanding why the author disagrees with a common belief. _____
3. Looking through a chapter before the lecture begins. _____
4. Checking your highlighted notes the night before a test. _____
5. Deciding whether a website is relevant to your topic. _____
6. Understanding how two ideas in a paragraph are connected. _____

Important: Academic readers often combine techniques. You may skim first, scan for important information, and then read selected parts carefully.

YOUR STRATEGY PLAN

Choose one text you need to read this week. What will you do first, next and finally?

(4)

3. Before, During and After Reading

Effective reading is a process. Breaking it into stages helps you stay focused and understand more.

Before reading

- Read the title and headings.
- Look at visuals and key words.
- Read the introduction and conclusion.
- Decide what you need to learn.

During reading

- Follow the development of ideas.
- Mark key terms and main points.
- Ask questions.
- Notice evidence and examples.

After reading

- Summarise the main ideas.
- Review important vocabulary.
- Check your understanding.
- Connect the text to your course.

ACTIVITY 3 · PUT THE ACTIONS IN THE CORRECT STAGE

Write **B** (before), **D** (during), or **A** (after).

1. Write a one-sentence summary. _____
2. Predict what the text may discuss. _____
3. Underline an unfamiliar key term. _____
4. Ask whether the writer gives enough evidence. _____
5. Review the headings and subheadings. _____
6. Explain the main idea to a partner. _____

> **Study habit:** Do not highlight everything. Highlight only information that helps you understand, remember or use the text.

PERSONAL ACTION

Choose one reading habit from this page that you will try this week.

Curated and adapted from the reading-process material in the original LAN 100 course pack.

4. Active Reading

Active readers do something with a text. They predict, question, annotate, summarise and connect ideas.

Useful active-reading actions

- Ask a pre-reading question.
- Identify unfamiliar terms.
- Mark the main idea of a paragraph.
- Write a short note in the margin.
- Turn a heading into a question.
- Explain one idea in your own words.
- Write a one-sentence summary.

Avoid passive reading

Simply moving your eyes across the page is not enough. Stop regularly and check whether you understand.

Can you explain what you have just read without looking?

ACTIVITY 4 · TURN HEADINGS INTO QUESTIONS

Turn each heading into a question that could guide your reading.

Heading	Your guiding question
Benefits of Regular Exercise	
Challenges of Online Learning	
How Memory Works	
Strategies for Managing Stress	

ACTIVITY 5 · CREATE A MARGIN NOTE

Read the sentence and write a short margin note of no more than six words.

> Students who review new information over several short study sessions usually remember more than students who study the same material once for a long period.

Margin note: _____

(6)

5. Skimming for the General Idea

Skimming means reading quickly to understand what a text is generally about. You do not read every word.

Focus on: title · headings · first and last paragraphs · topic sentences · repeated key words

ACTIVITY 6 · SKIM IN 45 SECONDS

Read the paragraph quickly. Do not stop at unfamiliar words.

> University students often experience stress because they must balance classes, assignments, exams, employment and personal responsibilities. Some pressure can be useful because it encourages students to plan and act. However, too much stress can affect sleep, concentration and motivation. Students can reduce stress by organising their time, taking regular breaks, exercising and asking for support when necessary. The most effective strategy is usually not one single action, but a combination of healthy routines.

1. What is the paragraph mainly about?
2. Which words or sentences helped you decide?
3. Choose the best title:
   a. Why Exams Should Be Removed
   b. Managing Stress at University
   c. The Benefits of Employment

ACTIVITY 7 · SKIMMING CHECKLIST

Before reading a longer text, I will:

- ☐ read the title and headings
- ☐ look at the introduction and conclusion
- ☐ notice repeated key words
- ☐ predict the main topic

6. Scanning for Specific Information

Scanning means moving your eyes quickly across a text to find one specific fact or detail.

> **Do not read everything.** First decide exactly what you are looking for: a name, date, number, term or example.

ACTIVITY 8 · FIND THE INFORMATION

Academic Skills Workshop Schedule	Date	Time	Room
Reading Academic Articles	7 October	10:00–11:15	LC 204
Taking Better Lecture Notes	14 October	12:30–13:45	LC 106
Paraphrasing and Source Use	21 October	10:00–11:15	LC 204
Preparing for Oral Tasks	28 October	14:00–15:15	LC 108

1. Which workshop begins at 14:00?
2. Where is the lecture-note workshop held?
3. Which two workshops take place in the same room?
4. When is the paraphrasing workshop?

ACTIVITY 9 · SCAN THE PARAGRAPH

> A survey of 240 first-year students found that 68% reviewed course notes every week, 21% reviewed only before tests, and 11% rarely reviewed. Students who reviewed weekly reported greater confidence before examinations.

1. How many students took part?
2. What percentage reviewed only before tests?
3. Which group reported greater confidence?

7. Main Ideas and Supporting Details

The **main idea** is the most important message in a paragraph. **Supporting details** explain, develop or prove that message.

Ask two questions:

1. What is the paragraph mostly about?
2. What does the writer want me to understand about it?

ACTIVITY 10 · IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE

Living away from home for the first time can be a challenging experience. Students must organise their own schedules, manage money, prepare meals and solve everyday problems independently. Although this can feel difficult at first, these responsibilities often help students become more confident and self-reliant.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

Supporting detail 1: _____

Supporting detail 2: _____

ACTIVITY 11 · MAIN OR MINOR DETAIL?

Label each statement **MI** (main idea), **SD** (supporting detail), or **mSD** (minor supporting detail).

1. University students need effective ways to manage stress. _____
2. Exercise is one common way to reduce stress. _____
3. Some students prefer walking, swimming or team sports. _____
4. Good time management can also reduce unnecessary pressure. _____

8. Understanding Words in Context

You do not need to use a dictionary every time you meet an unfamiliar word. The sentence and surrounding ideas often provide useful clues.

Context clue	What to look for
Definition	The meaning is explained directly.
Example	Examples show what the word means.
Contrast	An opposite idea gives a clue.
Synonym	A similar word appears nearby.
General sense	The overall situation suggests the meaning.

ACTIVITY 12 · USE THE CONTEXT

1. The lecturer's explanation was **concise**; it was brief but complete.
   Concise means: _____
2. Unlike the confusing first draft, the revised paragraph was **coherent** and easy to follow.
   Coherent means: _____
3. The workshop was **optional**, so students could choose whether to attend.
   Optional means: _____
4. Students were asked to **evaluate** the source by considering its strengths and weaknesses.
   Evaluate means: _____

VOCABULARY RECORD

Word	Meaning in this text	Useful word partner	My example
strategy		effective strategy	
identify		identify a problem	
evidence		supporting evidence	

approach		academic approach	

(11)

CAMPUS HOROSCOPES

A skimming and scanning challenge

Section: _____

Group members: _____

SKIMMING	SCANNING
Read quickly to understand the general idea. Focus on headings, repeated ideas and the first or final sentence. Do not stop at every unfamiliar word.	Move your eyes quickly to locate one exact detail, such as a name, place, action or keyword. You do not need to read every sentence.

Read the twelve original campus horoscopes. They are fictional and are used only for reading practice.

ARIES *March 21-April 19*

A busy start to the week may tempt you to answer every message immediately. Pause before replying to an important email, especially if the instructions are unclear. A classmate may have noticed a detail you missed. Later, a short walk across campus will help you reset. Your best move: check the facts, then act with confidence.

TAURUS *April 20-May 20*

A practical idea could save your group time on a shared assignment. Suggest dividing the work into clear stages rather than trying to finish everything in one meeting. Keep a note of deadlines in your calendar. Money may also be on your mind, so avoid an unnecessary purchase today. Your best move: organise first and spend carefully.

GEMINI *May 21-June 20*

Your curiosity is strong, and a lecture may lead you towards a completely new topic. Write down the question you most want to explore before it disappears from your mind. A lively conversation in the cafeteria could produce an excellent project idea. However, do not stay up too late researching it. Your best move: capture the idea, then protect your sleep.

CANCER *June 21-July 22*

Someone in your class may seem quieter than usual. A friendly question could make them feel included, but give them space if they do not want to talk. Several notifications may interrupt your study time this afternoon. Put your phone away for twenty minutes and focus on one small task. Your best move: show kindness while protecting your concentration.

LEO *July 23-August 22*

You may hear an exciting rumour about a course, event or assessment. Before sharing it, check the official announcement on Teams or ask your instructor. Your confidence will be useful during a discussion, especially if the group is hesitant to begin. Make sure others also have time to speak. Your best move: lead responsibly and verify information.

VIRGO *August 23-September 22*

A small detail in an assignment brief may be more important than it first appears. Read the task instructions carefully before planning your response. Feedback from a previous piece of work can help you avoid repeating the same mistake. Do not aim for perfection in the first draft. Your best move: use the evidence, begin early and improve step by step.

CAMPUS HOROSCOPES

Campus Horoscopes - continued

LIBRA *September 23-October 22*

Two attractive opportunities may compete for your attention: a social event and a study commitment. You do not need to reject either one, but you may need to adjust your timetable. A clear conversation with a friend will prevent misunderstanding. Your best move: balance your priorities and communicate your plans before making a promise.

SCORPIO *October 23-November 21*

Your energy may be lower than usual after several demanding days. Instead of forcing yourself through a long study session, choose one achievable goal and then take a proper break. A useful resource may be hiding in a folder you have ignored. Your best move: work strategically, search carefully and allow yourself time to recover.

SAGITTARIUS *November 22-December 21*

A new club, workshop or campus activity may catch your attention. Joining could introduce you to people outside your usual circle and give you a fresh perspective. Check the time and location before setting off, as a last-minute room change is possible. Your best move: explore something new, but scan the practical details first.

CAPRICORN *December 22-January 19*

A long-term academic goal may suddenly feel more realistic. Speak to someone with experience, such as a senior student, adviser or instructor, and ask one specific question. Group politics could distract you from a shared task, so keep the conversation focused on the work. Your best move: seek useful guidance and stay professional.

AQUARIUS *January 20-February 18*

Technology could help you solve a problem today, but only after a frustrating start. Save your work, check the file name and make sure you are using the correct version before uploading anything. An unusual idea may improve a class activity if you explain it clearly. Your best move: be inventive, but double-check every digital detail.

PISCES *February 19-March 20*

A disappointing result or confusing comment may seem worse than it really is. Read the feedback again when you are calm and identify one action you can take. A quiet place in the library could help you think more clearly. Your best move: do not panic; turn the information into a practical next step.

CAMPUS HOROSCOPES

Task 1: Scan for precise information

Work against the clock. Do not read every horoscope again. Scan for the key words in each question and write the correct star sign.

#	Find the horoscope...	Sign
1	Which sign is advised to check Teams or ask the instructor?	_____
2	Which sign should avoid an unnecessary purchase?	_____
3	Which sign may discover a useful resource in an ignored folder?	_____
4	Which sign is warned about a possible room change?	_____
5	Which sign should check a file name before uploading?	_____
6	Which sign is encouraged to use earlier feedback?	_____
7	Which sign may get a project idea in the cafeteria?	_____
8	Which sign should put their phone away for twenty minutes?	_____
9	Which sign is advised to ask an experienced person one specific question?	_____
10	Which sign should find a quiet place in the library?	_____
11	Which sign needs to balance a social event and study commitment?	_____
12	Which sign should pause before answering an important email?	_____

Scanning check

Which strategy helped you find answers quickly? Tick one.

☐ I searched for repeated key words. ☐ I looked for names and places. ☐ I read every text from the beginning.

CAMPUS HOROSCOPES

Task 2: Skim for overall meaning

Skim each horoscope again. Match each star sign with the main idea below. One main idea is used twice.

A	Check information before responding or sharing it.
B	Organise responsibilities and use time or money carefully.
C	Follow your curiosity, but protect your wellbeing.
D	Support another person without losing your own focus.
E	Use instructions and feedback to improve your work.
F	Balance competing priorities through communication.
G	Reduce the task and recover your energy.
H	Explore a new opportunity after checking practical details.
I	Seek guidance and keep group work professional.
J	Use technology creatively but carefully.
K	Turn disappointment into a manageable next step.

Write the matching letter:

Aries: ___	Taurus: ___	Gemini: ___	Cancer: ___
Leo: ___	Virgo: ___	Libra: ___	Scorpio: ___
Sagittarius: ___	Capricorn: ___	Aquarius: ___	Pisces: ___

(15)

CAMPUS HOROSCOPES

Task 3: Vocabulary and reflection

Build vocabulary from context

Choose four useful or unfamiliar words from the horoscopes. First predict each meaning from context. Then check with your group or a dictionary.

Word	My predicted meaning	Checked meaning	Horoscope

Task 4: Compare and discuss

Choose one horoscope from the set. As a group, discuss whether its advice would be useful for a university student. Give one reason and one example.

Our chosen sign is _____

The main advice is _____

We think this advice is useful / not useful because

_____

Exit check

Complete the sentences in your own words:

Skimming is useful when I need to _____

Scanning is useful when I need to _____

9. Introduction to Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing means expressing information from a source in your own words while keeping the original meaning.

A good paraphrase:

- keeps the original meaning
- uses different vocabulary where appropriate
- changes the sentence structure
- is written clearly and naturally
- still acknowledges the source when required

A weak paraphrase:

- changes only one or two words
- copies the original sentence pattern
- adds ideas that were not in the source
- changes the meaning

Worked example

> **Original:** University students benefit from using different reading strategies depending on their purpose.

> **Paraphrase:** Students at university read more effectively when they select a method that matches what they need to achieve.

ACTIVITY 13 · WHAT CHANGED?

Underline the changes in vocabulary. Circle the changes in sentence structure.

Has the meaning stayed the same? **Yes / No**

> **Remember:** Paraphrasing is not replacing every word with a synonym. It is understanding an idea and expressing it naturally in a new way.

Curated and adapted from the paraphrasing guidance in the original LAN 100 course pack.

10. A Simple Paraphrasing Process

1. **Read** the original sentence until you understand it.
2. **Identify** the essential meaning and key terms.
3. **Look away** from the original.
4. **Rewrite** the idea in a new sentence.
5. **Compare** the two versions.
6. **Check** that the meaning is accurate and the wording is sufficiently different.

ACTIVITY 14 · GUIDED PARAPHRASING

Original: Regular review helps students transfer new information from short-term memory to long-term memory.

Step 1 · Key meaning: _____

Step 2 · Useful alternatives:

- regular review → frequent revision / reviewing often
- helps students → enables learners to
- transfer → move / store
- new information → recently learned material

Your paraphrase:

ACTIVITY 15 · PARAPHRASE INDEPENDENTLY

1. Active readers ask questions while they read.
2. Students often understand difficult texts more easily when they discuss them with others.
3. Good time management can reduce unnecessary academic stress.

11. Reading Workshop

Read the text first using the strategies from this module.

Becoming a More Effective Learner

Students do not all learn in the same way. Some understand information best when they see diagrams, charts or written notes. Others learn more effectively by listening to explanations or discussing ideas with classmates. Many students also need to practise a skill before they feel confident using it. These differences do not mean that one approach is better than another. They simply show that learners may need different strategies for different tasks.

Effective learners become aware of what helps them understand and remember. Before beginning a task, they identify its purpose and decide how to approach it. While working, they ask questions, connect new information to what they already know and check whether they are following the main ideas. Afterwards, they review important points and consider what they could do differently next time.

Most students use a combination of strategies. A learner may first read a chapter quickly to understand its structure, then return to difficult sections for detailed reading. The same student may use a diagram to organise information and later explain the key points aloud. The goal is not to label yourself as one fixed type of learner. It is to build a flexible set of strategies and choose the ones that work best for each situation.

Adapted and condensed from the "Becoming an Effective Learner" material in the original LAN 100 course pack.

BEFORE AND DURING READING

1. What did you predict from the title?
2. Underline one sentence that expresses the main idea of paragraph 2.
3. Circle three words that are repeated or closely related.
4. Mark one idea that you could apply to your own studies.

12. Apply the Strategies

A · GLOBAL UNDERSTANDING

1. Choose the best summary of the whole text.
   a. Students should identify one learning style and always use it.
   b. Effective learners use a flexible combination of strategies.
   c. Visual learning is more effective than listening.
2. What is the writer's main purpose?
   a. To entertain readers with a personal story
   b. To explain how students can become more effective learners
   c. To persuade universities to change their courses

B · SELECTIVE READING

1. Name two ways students may prefer to learn.
2. What should learners do before beginning a task?
3. Give two actions effective learners use while working.
4. Why should students avoid labelling themselves as one fixed type of learner?

C · VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT

Find words in the text that mean:

1. a method or plan for doing something: _____
2. able to change according to the situation: _____
3. to make information easier to see and understand: _____

D · PARAPHRASE

Rewrite the sentence in your own words:

> The goal is not to label yourself as one fixed type of learner.

(20)

13. Discuss and Reflect

PAIR DISCUSSION

1. Which reading strategy from this module is most useful for you?
2. Which strategy do you rarely use?
3. How could you become a more active reader?
4. What advice would you give a new university student?

MY READING STRATEGY PLAN

Before reading, I will...	During reading, I will...	After reading, I will...

MODULE REFLECTION

I can...

- ☐ choose a reading strategy that matches my purpose
- ☐ skim for the general idea
- ☐ scan for specific information
- ☐ identify main ideas and supporting details
- ☐ use context to understand unfamiliar words
- ☐ paraphrase a simple academic idea

The skill I need to practise most is:

14. My Learning Record

VOCABULARY BANK

New word or phrase	Meaning	Example or collocation

ONE-MINUTE SUMMARY

Without looking back, write the three most important ideas from this module.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Looking ahead

In Module 2, you will explore how writers organise academic texts and how to recognise purpose, audience and rhetorical patterns.

Read with a purpose. Think while you read. Use what you learn.

SECTION

Mediation

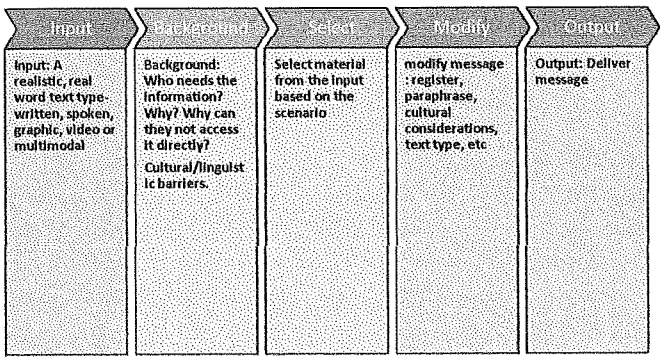
Oral presentation, explanation
and communication tasks

Introduction to Mediation

Preparing for Written and Spoken Mediation and Production Tasks

1

What will a mediation task look like?



2

Look at the FOUR steps when completing the mediation activity

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4
• Read the question	• Break down the requirements of the task	• Select the information from the prompt	• Modify the information for the audience

3

Part III: Written production and written mediation

This type of question will require that you **MEDIATE** information and **PRODUCE** a personal response in a unified paragraph of 150 words approximately.

4

The INPUT can be

- an image
- a song
- a video

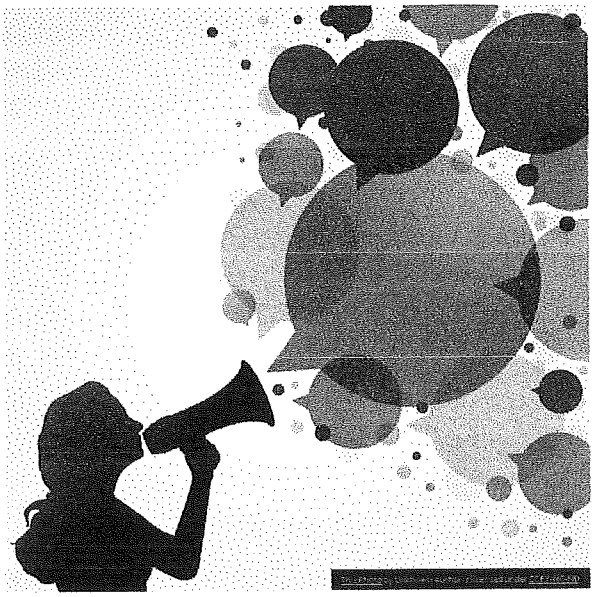
5

Spoken production and spoken mediation

Here you will be asked to provide your answer in SPOKEN form.

You will need to:

MEDIATE information and **PRODUCE** a personal response of some kind.



6

The INPUT can be

an image

a song

a video

7

Sample phrases:

- Written Mediation
- Written Production

- Spoken Mediation
- Spoken Production

8

MEDIATION
(Written/Spoken)

This
image/video/song/advertisement ...

- depicts.....
- aims to convey.....
- communicates ....
- exemplifies...
- illustrates .....

9

MEDIATION
(Written/Spoken)

- as we can see.....
- as is shown.....
- the obvious message(s) ....
- another message...
- the overall meaning/idea

10

MEDIATION
(Written/Spoken)
REFER to the PROMPT!!!

- we can see this through.....
- this is evident via.....
- this is clearly shown ....
- there is an overall feeling/ tone/mood of...
- we are able to ascertain/understand/recognise

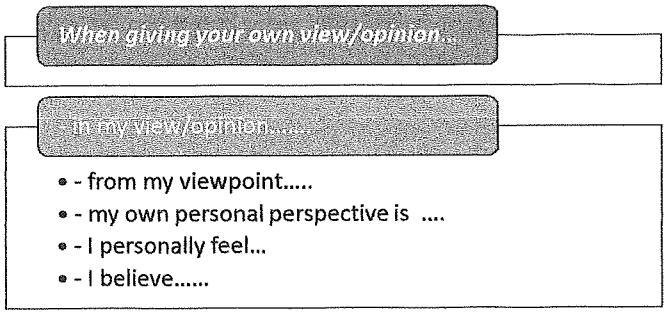
11

MEDIATION
(Written/Spoken)

- in addition /additionally.....
- we are also able to see.....
- the idea that ....
- another message which is communicated/conveyed...
- the prompt/image/song/advert is trying to tell us that.....

12

PRODUCTION
(Written/Spoken)



13

PRODUCTION
(Written/Spoken)

When giving your own view/opinion...

- I personally agree with.....
- I partially agree.....
- I (totally) disagree....
- I feel / believe/ ...

14

PRODUCTION
(Written/Spoken)

To conclude...

- Overall.....
- Finally.....
- As discussed,....
- To conclude ...

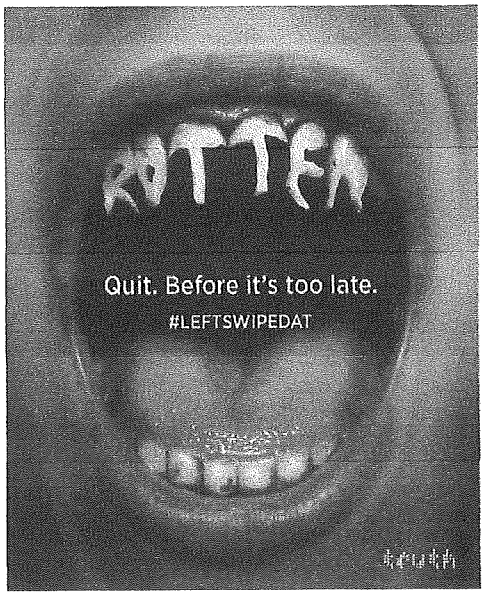
15

Written or Spoken Mediation & Production

Your friend has just seen this image online but hasn't understood it's intended meaning.

Write an email or paragraph to your friend in which you:

- **describe** what you see in the image
- **mediate** 2 messages that the image communicates
- **share** your opinion on the topic
- **highlight** the importance of the topic



16

Response

The image shows a close-up of someone's mouth, and the word "ROTTEN" is disturbingly shaped into their decayed upper teeth. Below, it reads: "Quit. Before it's too late," followed by the hashtag #LeftSwipeDat. This is clearly a graphic anti-smoking message. One message conveyed is a warning about the damage smoking can do to oral health. The visual is shocking, but it effectively drives home the consequences of smoking, like tooth decay, in addition to communicating the message that smoking may lead to other health risks.

In my opinion, this type of campaign is important because it doesn't sugarcoat the reality—it's a wake-up call. Smoking-related issues don't just affect health invisibly; they can be visibly damaging, too. Raising awareness like this could encourage people, especially younger ones, to think twice about starting or continuing to smoke. It's crucial we address such topics to promote healthier lifestyles.

17

The Skill of MEDIATION

This semester you will be given the opportunity to improve your mediation skills. Mediation tasks involve understanding information/meaning from an original source and being able to relay (pass on) this information either in written or spoken form. Mediation is extremely important in language learning as it assists the learner in finding strategies (ways) to demonstrate and improve their language skills.

There are three main types of mediation tasks:

- **mediating a text**
  - ✓ relaying (paraphrasing) specific information (either in spoken or written form)
  - ✓ explaining data (a map/graph/table/visual or graphic)
  - ✓ processing text (understanding key message/content)
  - ✓ relaying the key points of a written text (either in spoken or written form)
  - ✓ taking notes (of lectures/seminars/meetings)
  - ✓ expressing a personal response to a creative text (song/film/advertisement/work of art/literature)
  - ✓ analysing or criticising a creative text (song/film/advertisement/work of art/literature)

**Self-assessment check (B2+ CEFR)*
"I can convey detailed information and arguments reliably, e.g., the significant point(s) contained in complex but well-structured texts within my fields of professional, academic, and personal interest."

- **mediating concepts** (ideas/notions)
  - ✓ facilitating (assisting) collaborative interaction among peers
  - ✓ collaborating (working with others) to construct meaning
  - ✓ assisting discussion about concepts/ideas

  Self-assessment check (B2+ CEFR)
  "I can encourage participation and pose questions that invite reactions from other group members' perspectives or ask people to expand on their thinking and clarify their opinions. I can further develop other people's ideas and link them into coherent lines of thinking, considering different sides of an issue."

- **mediating communication**
  - ✓ facilitating (assisting) collaborative interaction among peers (helping people understand each other's intended meaning) – example, if you were helping a very weak speaker of English to understand a native speaker of English, you would be involved in mediating communication)
  - ✓ facilitating (assisting) communication in delicate situations

  Self-assessment check (B2+ CEFR)
  "I can encourage a shared communication culture by adapting the way I proceed, by expressing appreciation of different ideas, feelings, and viewpoints, and inviting participants to react to each other's' ideas. I can communicate the significance of important statements and viewpoints on subjects within my fields of interest, providing speakers give clarifications if needed."

Mediation Strategies

- How do we go about the task of mediation (whether it be written or spoken?)
- **Strategies to explain a new concept**
  - ✓ Linking to previous knowledge (using what we already know to help us)
  - ✓ Adapting language (using appropriate language according to the situation)
  - ✓ Breaking down complicated information (to help someone better understand)

- **Strategies to simplify a text**
  - ✓ Simplifying a dense (complex) text by using simpler, less complex language)
  - ✓ Streamlining a text (removing unnecessary information/details in order to communicate the main message/content while taking into account the intended audience)

Adapted from: Nagai (2020, p.43-86)

VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT

Visual Learner
Definition: learns best by seeing
Application: highlights key points, and recopies notes

What does it mean to be a visual learner? A **visual learner** is one who learns best by seeing. Visual learners like to use textbooks, course outlines, maps, diagrams, charts, and pictures. Their goal is to be able to visualize the subject they are trying to learn. Visual learners prefer teachers who use a whiteboard, an overhead projector, or PowerPoint slides over ones who primarily talk. Visual learners often have a superior ability to visualize pages of print. They learn material well by highlighting key points and by copying and recopying their notes. Most people are visual learners.

Auditory Learner
Definition: _____
_____
Application: _____
_____
_____
_____

What does it mean to be an auditory learner? An **auditory learner** is one who learns best through hearing. Auditory learners have a superior ability to hear and remember sounds in their mind. Auditory learners like to listen, and they prefer teachers who lecture and encourage discussion. They learn material well by talking to themselves and repeating words and phrases out loud. If you are an auditory learner, you might learn best by reading your textbook out loud or by studying with a friend and talking through the key points. Auditory learners might do very well in class group activities. Many people are auditory learners.

Kinesthetic Learner
Definition: _____
_____
Application: _____
_____
_____
_____

What does it mean to be a kinesthetic learner? **Kinesthetic learners,** who are the smallest group, learn best by doing and performing. They are hands-on, or tactile, learners. They have a superior ability to remember their actions. Kinesthetic learners like to be in movement while learning. Their special talent is in associating ideas and concepts with motion. When learning material, they may prefer to gesture or walk around. These students need to take frequent short study breaks. It is a good idea for kinesthetic learners to take notes and underline key points as they read. Kinesthetic learners might benefit from taking part in classroom skits and role-playing activities.

Keep in mind, though, that even if one of your scores was way above the other two, all that the test results show is a *tendency* on your part. For example, if you have a high score for auditory learning, this just means that you tend to be an auditory learner, but you are still likely to have a significant ability to learn in visual and kinesthetic ways. Most of us learn best by using some combination of all three learning styles. Suppose, for example, you want to learn how to ski. You might attend a lecture where someone discusses how to ski (auditory). Or you might watch a video in which someone demonstrates skiing techniques (visual). Or you might strap on a pair of skis and go down the beginner slope (kinesthetic). But the person who involves all three learning styles by doing all three things might learn to ski faster. The trick is to find the combination that works best for you.

Words in Context

A technique for discovering the meaning of an unfamiliar word is to examine its context, the words surrounding it. In many instances, the neighboring words provide clues to help decipher the meaning.

There are several different kinds of context clues you can use, and it is worthwhile to become familiar with all of them. Familiarizing yourself with these techniques will go a long way to helping you study your college textbooks without having to interrupt your reading to look up a specific word. When having a precise definition is not necessary, the use of context clues can be sufficient and save you time. Of course, if a precise definition is necessary, consulting a dictionary is essential.

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A good strategy is to underline or circle the words you are unfamiliar with as you move through the text. Use context clues to come up with a definition that seems to make sense and continue your reading. When you complete the reading, go back and look up in a dictionary any word for which you need a more precise definition.

Here are some common techniques for using context to determine the meaning of new words.

Definition: Sometimes a writer simply provides us with a definition of a word somewhere within the sentence, especially if the word is one that we are unlikely to be familiar with:

> A *thesaurus,* or dictionary that lists synonyms, antonyms, and other related words, can help you express your ideas more clearly and effectively.

You can see that the author defines a *thesaurus* as a special type of dictionary.

Synonym: A synonym, which is another word with a similar meaning, may be used elsewhere in the sentence.

> Four types of objects *revolve* around the sun; however, the planets are the largest objects that circle our fiery star.

If you did not know the meaning of *revolve,* you could determine its meaning from the word *circle.* To circle and to revolve mean approximately the same thing.

Antonym: Sometimes you can determine the meaning of a word by finding an antonym, a word with an opposite meaning, somewhere in the sentence.

> Gustavo was a very skillful soccer player, but Pedro was *inept.*

You can see that the writer is making a contrast, and that skillful is the opposite of *inept.*

Examples: Sometimes examples illustrate the meaning of a word.

> In a *brazen* act of defiance, Marco lit his cigarette while standing in front of a "No Smoking" sign and then refused to put it out when asked to do so.

This example suggests to you that a *brazen* act is one that is bold and shameless.

Explanation: Sometimes a writer simply gives an explanation of what a word means.

> In your communications class, you will probably have to give an *impromptu* speech. For this type of speech, you will be given a topic and only a few minutes to prepare your talk.

The writer is telling you that an *impromptu* speech is one that is given with very little preparation.

Experience: This way of discovering the meaning of a word draws on your personal experience.

> Have your efforts to complete a paper for a class ever been *thwarted* because your computer broke down?

Perhaps you have experienced this or a similar situation, and you remember that your efforts were "hindered" or "frustrated" at least for the time being.

Knowledge of Subject: In this technique, you have just enough familiarity with the subject the writer is discussing to enable you to figure out the meaning of the unknown word.

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Although many Americans often diet, many have difficulty maintaining a *svelte* shape for more than a few months.

You know that people often diet to make themselves "slim" or "slender."

Combination: Can you use a number of these techniques at the same time to detect the meaning of a word? You bet!

The man at the party was a real *extrovert*. He acted like a clown and had everyone laughing the whole evening.

Here you probably used explanation, experience, and familiarity with the subject to determine that an *extrovert* is a very outgoing person.

Now work with a partner on the following exercises. Remember, no peeking at your dictionary.

Context Clue Practice 1

Directions: On the first line, write your own definition for the italicized word. Then on the second line, note the technique you used to arrive at the definition. The first item is done for you. Answers will vary.

1. Everyone in the family was *elated* to discover that Howard had the winning million-dollar lottery ticket in his pocket.

   Definition: jubilant; overjoyed

   Technique(s) used: knowledge of subject, explanation, maybe experience

2. Believing the 12-year-old offender to be *contrite*, the judge decided to give him another chance before putting him in juvenile detention.

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

3. Should football games be canceled because of *inclement* weather?

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

4. Should sexually *explicit* scenes be deleted from movies when they are shown on television?

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

5. Carol was extremely relieved to discover that her tumor was *benign* rather than malignant and so she would require no further treatment.

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

6. Her house was so *immaculate* that you could literally eat off the floor.

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

7. Many boys in high school *aspire* to be professional athletes, but very few are actually good enough to make it to the professional ranks.

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

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8. The FBI conducted *covert,* or secret, operations to find out information about the drug-smuggling ring.

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

9. Many students are not *affluent* enough to attend college without working part-time or receiving some type of financial assistance.

   Definition: _____

   Technique(s) used: _____

Context Clue Practice 2

Directions: Use the context clues in the second sentence to define the italicized word in the first. Circle the clue word (or words) in the second sentence that provided the clue(s).

1. "Yes, this computer is *obsolete,*" said Matt. "But out of date or not, it's too expensive to replace."
2. "I can't accept any *remuneration* for taking care of your dog while you were in the hospital," said Carrie. "Nonsense dear," said Mrs. Watson, "you should get paid for doing a good deed."
3. It would be *presumptuous* to accuse him of the crime. Taking him in for questioning without solid evidence would simply be too bold.
4. Mountain climbing is full of *hazards.* However, the adventure is worth all of the risks.
5. He considered it an *indignity* for his parents to ignore his college graduation. He couldn't envision a worse insult.
6. Martha complained that she was getting tired of *goading* her son to do his homework. At his age, he should be able to finish it without her urging.
7. Some people *feign* injuries after their car is rear-ended. They don't stop pretending until they have received a cash settlement.
8. Todd, the pilot of our small airplane, seemed very *apprehensive* about taking off during the storm. His anxious behavior was upsetting the passengers.
9. I was certain he was *despondent* because he hadn't smiled all week. Perhaps he had good reason to be so depressed.
10. The teacher was *cognizant* of the difficulties involved in learning a new language. Her awareness was based on the fact that she too had once emigrated from her homeland.
11. In the United States, many families celebrate Thanksgiving with a *sumptuous* meal. However, after the lavish feast, many Americans begin dieting in earnest.

Context Clue Practice 3

Directions: Use the context clues in each sentence to help determine the missing word. Briefly describe the clue or clues that helped you.

1. If you believe that you control your own destiny, you have an internal locus of control; however, if you believe that your fate is determined by chance or outside forces, you have an _____ locus of control.

   Clue: _____

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Name:_____ Date:_____

Vocabulary and Context Clues 1

Directions:

Read each sentence. Look for clues about the meaning of the boldfaced word. Underline another word or phrase that helps you understand it.

1. Hank was an **opportunist**, taking advantage of every possible angle.
2. My mother was **candid**, honestly sharing her ideas on the subject.
3. The **stupendous** actor attracted everyone's attention because he was so good.
4. President Miller's policies changed society, **catalysts** for improved living around the country.
5. Peter was likely to be late, and **apt** to forget necessary supplies as well.
6. **Exchanging** screen names is almost like trading phone numbers.
7. The preacher's charm and **charisma** made him attractive to both young and old.
8. The yellow cookie had a bite out of it, looking like nothing so much as a crumbly **crescent** moon.
9. Elizabeth had the perfect **trifecta** of attributes: power, beauty and money.
10. **Precisely** where were you last night, and exactly what were you doing?

Put the letter of the matching definition on each line:

_____ precisely
_____ opportunist
_____ charisma
_____ catalysts
_____ candid
_____ stupendous
_____ apt
_____ crescent
_____ exchanging
_____ trifecta

a. Very, very good
b. One who takes advantage
c. Group of three
d. Honest
e. Trading one for another
f. Agent of change
g. Likely
h. Shape like a portion of a circle
i. Exactly
j. Extremely attractive quality

Name:_____ Date:_____

Vocabulary and Context Clues 2

Directions:

Read each sentence. Look for clues about the meaning of the boldfaced word. Underline another word or phrase that helps you understand it.

1. He realized that his **carriage** was important, so he walked proudly with his back straight.
2. The surface was **marred** by deep scratches and gouges.
3. Many **media** were used in the artwork, including paint, colored pencils and crayons.
4. The soft, bouncy surface **cushioned** his landing.
5. The two of them are usually **civil** but today they were quite impolite to each other.
6. Sarah demonstrated how much she cared for others by showing **compassion** to the man in the store.
7. The salesman obviously wanted to **haggle**, so we offered a lower price.
8. The local economy was based on a **barter** system, so the doctor often was paid with fresh produce from the farms.
9. Tom was known to be a **cad**, treating others without respect or kindness.
10. Greta shared many **traits** with her sister, including attributes like honesty and humor.

Put the letter of the matching definition on each line:

_____ haggle
_____ cad
_____ carriage
_____ marred
_____ barter
_____ traits
_____ cushioned
_____ civil
_____ compassion
_____ media

a. Polite and kind
b. Bargain
c. A disreputable person
d. Posture and body language
e. Damaged
f. Trade
g. Characteristics or attributes
h. Softened
i. Kindness and caring
j. Artistic materials

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LAN 100

VOCABULARY FROM CONTEXT PRACTICE

Instructions: Each of the sentences below contains an italicized word. Choose the multiple choice answer closest in meaning to the italicized word.

1. Mean-spirited people enjoy spreading *malicious* gossip. The rumors they spread damage the victim's reputation unfairly and cause undeserved pain and embarrassment.

a) harmful
b) interesting
c) cheerful
d) uplifting

2. The cast of the television series is currently enjoying a three-month *hiatus*, but they will start work again in the fall.

a) break
b) strike
c) call
d) probation

3. Certain college courses are *compulsory* for all students who wish to receive a degree; however, there are also elective courses, and students can choose whichever of those they prefer.

a) difficult
b) required
c) unpleasant
d) enjoyable

4. At the formal dinner party, the employee made an embarrassing *faux pas* when he drank the water in the finger bowl instead of rinsing his fingertips in it.

a) international incident
b) illegal action
c) grammatical error
d) social mistake

5. The *manic* pace of Saigon is evident even in the streets, where swarms of motorbikes zip through intersections.

a) happy; upbeat
b) excessively active; intense
c) violent; destructive
d) leisurely; relaxed

AUTHOR'S PURPOSE

LAN 100 | READING SKILLS

Author's Purpose

Why is the author writing?

When you identify an author's purpose, ask what the writer wants the reader to think, feel, know or do.

To Entertain

The author wants to interest, amuse or entertain the reader.

Look for:

- humour
- characters and events
- creative or imaginative language

Examples: comics, novels, short stories

To Inform

The author gives information and helps the reader learn about a topic.

Look for:

- facts, statistics and definitions
- examples and explanations
- objective or neutral language
- little or no visible personal opinion

Examples: textbooks, medical journals, encyclopedias

To Persuade

The author tries to influence the reader's opinion or encourage action.

Look for:

- subjective or persuasive language
- a clear point of view or bias
- arguments that appeal to reason, emotion or ethics
- words such as *must*, *need to* and *have to*
- a request for change or action

Examples: advertisements, speeches, political texts

Multiple Purposes

A text may combine purposes, for example, to inform and persuade. Decide which purpose is the **overall or primary purpose**.

When persuasion is present and drives the text, the overall purpose is usually to persuade.

Primary Purpose vs Specific Purpose

Primary purpose: To persuade

Specific purpose: To persuade readers to exercise regularly.

Primary purpose: To inform

Specific purpose: To inform readers that excessive sun exposure may lead to skin cancer.

CHAPTER 3

Determining an Author's Purpose

CHAPTER PREVIEW

In this chapter, you will

- Learn the difference between a general and a specific purpose.
- Learn how to determine whether the author's purpose is to entertain, inform, or persuade.
- Learn how to summarize short articles.

Entertain, Inform, or Persuade?

Most writers create a story, essay, article, or poem with at least one **general purpose** in mind. Because most writers do not directly state their general purpose, readers must use indirect clues to determine it. We can identify the general purpose by asking "Why did the author write this?" or "What did the author want to accomplish?" Usually, this purpose will fall into one of three broad categories: to entertain, to inform, or to persuade.

To Entertain

Highlight or underline several words that define each bold-printed term.

An author whose purpose is to **entertain** will tell a story or describe someone or something in an interesting way. A piece of writing meant to entertain will often make an appeal to readers' imagination or sense of humor. If the writing is humorous, the author might say things in an exaggerated fashion or use understatement. Witty, unusual, dramatic, or exciting stories usually have entertainment as their purpose. A romance, suspense, or mystery novel is usually meant to entertain. Writing meant to entertain may be either fiction or nonfiction. The following is an example of a paragraph whose purpose is to entertain:

> 1. I assume you are on the Internet. If you are not, then pardon my French, but *vous êtes un big loser.* Today EVERYBODY is on the Internet, including the primitive Mud People of the Amazon rain forest. In the old days, when the Mud People needed food, they had to manually throw spears at wild boars, whereas today they simply get on the Internet, go to www.spearaboar.com and click their mouse a few times (the Mud People use actual mice). Within three business days, a large box (containing a live boar) is delivered to them by a UPS driver, whom they eat.
>
> (Dave Barry, *Dave Barry Is Not Taking This Sitting Down*, 2000).

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To Inform

An author whose purpose is to **inform** will explain something to readers or provide them with knowledge they did not possess before. Ordinarily, the material will be presented in an objective, unemotional fashion. Authors who write textbooks presenting factual material usually have this purpose in mind. Encyclopedias, research studies, and articles in newspapers are usually meant to inform. The following is an example of a paragraph whose purpose is to inform:

> 2. In the United States, the most "wired" nation in the world, only 65 percent of Americans have Internet access at home. In many developing countries almost no one has Internet access. According to a recent report by the United Nations, 88 percent of all Internet users live in industrialized countries. One of the major barriers to Internet use in developing countries is the cost. In 1999 it cost $10.50 an hour to use the Internet in the African nation of Chad, where the average annual income was $187. The Web is also largely limited to people who read English, since 80 percent of the world's websites are in English. Another barrier in many countries is that there is no way to log on. Consider that in the industrialized nations there are about 50 phone lines for every 100 people, while developing nations average 1.4 phone lines per 100 people. According to the United Nations, half the world's population has yet to make a phone call, much less log on to the Internet.
>
> (Ralph E. Hanson, *Mass Communication*, 1/e, 2005)

To Persuade

Finally, the author's purpose may be to **persuade.** Persuasion goes beyond merely entertaining or providing information. This kind of writing tries to change readers' opinions by appealing to their emotions or intellect. If the author is making an emotional argument, vivid descriptive passages may be used to manipulate readers' feelings. If the author is making an appeal to intelligence, a rational or logical argument may be used. Political literature is a common example of writing meant to persuade. While articles in newspapers are usually meant to inform, newspaper editorials ordinarily have persuasion as their purpose. The following is an example of a paragraph whose purpose is to persuade:

> **POP-UPS AND SPAM: THE EVIL TWINS OF INTERNET ADVERTISING**
>
> 3. Suppose you are doing online research when all of a sudden an ad appears: Order DVDs by mail! You close that one but another pops up: Find low fares! Get rid of that and there is another: Lower your mortgage rates! Click to close it and there is another. And another. Pretty soon you are doing the cyber equivalent of swatting flies as you try to get rid of those intrusive pop-up and pop-under ads. Pop-up ads are bad enough, but they pale in comparison to spam. The Internet is literally stuffed full of junk e-mail for low-cost prescription drugs, debt consolidation plans, schemes that will make you a millionaire in only six months, and various treatments to enlarge certain body parts. What, if anything, can you do about it? The ultimate solution might be a legal one. It's time for Congress to pass legislation to create a national Do-Not-Spam list that resembles the Do-Not-Call list that limited telemarketers.
>
> (Joseph R. Dominick, *The Dynamics of Mass Communication*, 8/e, 2005). Reprinted with permission.

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General and Specific Purposes

To determine whether the author's general purpose is to entertain, inform, or persuade, look for clues in the title, in headings and subheadings, and in the introduction or conclusion. Also, pay attention to the source of the article.

Authors also take into account their **audience**—those they are writing for—when they choose their general purpose. Writers of fiction usually want to entertain readers by creating interesting characters and stories. If an author writes an article for a wellness magazine, the general purpose probably will be to provide information promoting good health. If an author writes a letter to solicit campaign contributions for a political candidate, the general purpose will be to persuade, because the author is trying to persuade people to give money.

In addition to a general purpose, authors usually have a **specific purpose,** which gives more information about the article than the general purpose does. Take the previous "wellness" example. The general purpose is to "inform." The specific purpose might be "to inform people about foods that protect against cancer."

Multiple Purposes

Sometimes an author may have more than one purpose in mind. For instance, an author might want to both entertain and persuade. Or the author might write an entertaining article that also provides information about something important. When an author has more than one purpose in mind, usually one of the author's purposes will be primary. To determine the author's primary purpose, first identify the main idea and the key details that support the idea. Then note the source of the article or passage. Often the publication that the article or passage appears in will help you identify the author's primary purpose. Finally, note the author's choice of words. Is the vocabulary neutral and unbiased? Is it meant to influence your judgment in some way? These steps should help you identify the author's primary purpose.

Read the paragraph below and identify the writer's topic, main idea, and general and specific purposes.

4. One of the reasons that occupational stress has been receiving so much attention lately is that businesses are genuinely beginning to care about employee welfare. You don't buy that? Well, how about this? Work stress is costing businesses billions of dollars. Sounds more plausible doesn't it? It is estimated by the International Labor Organization that stress on the job costs businesses over $200 billion per year. These costs include salaries for sick days, costs of hospitalization and outpatient care, and costs related to decreased productivity. Other stress-related factors are catching the eyes of business leaders. For example, health benefit costs to employers have increased dramatically. Employees trained over a long period of time, at great cost, may break down when stressed on the job. They may make poor decisions, miss days of work, begin abusing alcohol and other drugs, or die and have to be replaced by other workers who need training. All of this is costly. These effects of occupational stress have caused companies to give high priority to stress management programs.

(Jerrold S. Greenberg, *Comprehensive Stress Management*, 8/e, 2004)

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Topic: occupational stress

Main idea: businesses giving high priority to stress management programs because of the high costs of employee occupational stress

General purpose: to inform

Specific purpose: informing readers about why businesses are paying attention to employee stress

The following exercises will give you some practice in determining an author's general purpose.

Directions: Label each sentence according to its general purpose: to inform (I), to entertain (E), or to persuade (P).

_____ 1. I have been thinking a lot about food lately. This is because I am not getting any. My wife, you see, recently put me on a diet. It is an interesting diet of her own devising that essentially allows me to eat anything I want so long as it contains no fat, cholesterol, sodium, calories, and isn't tasty. In order to keep me from starving altogether, she went to the grocery store and bought everything that had "bran" in its title. I am not sure, but I believe I had bran cutlets for dinner last night. I am very depressed.

(Bill Bryson, *I'm a Stranger Here Myself*, 1999)

_____ 2. Most sharks are harmless—at least to humans. Actually we threaten the survival of sharks more than they threaten us. They reproduce slowly, and their numbers are already being depleted by overfishing in many areas. This attitude toward sharks may be shortsighted, because they play an important role in marine communities. Some people catch shark only for the shark's fins or jaws. Others practice shark hunting for sport, leaving the meat to waste. A magnificent predator, the shark may soon be exterminated by humans, the fiercest predator of them all.

(Peter Castro and Michael E. Huber, "Sharks," 2007)

_____ 3. The idea of a family consisting of a wage-earning husband and a wife who stays at home has largely given way to the dual-income household. Among married people between the ages of 25 and 34, 92 percent of the men and 75 percent of the women are in the labor force. Why has there been such a rise in the number of dual-income couples? A major factor is economic need. In 2003, the median income for households with both partners employed was 99 percent more than in households in which only one person was working outside the home. Of course, because of such work-related costs as child care, not all of a family's second wage is genuine additional income.

(Richard T. Schaefer, *Sociology*, 10/e, 2007)

Directions: Read each of the following paragraphs to determine if the author's primary purpose is to entertain, persuade, or inform. Indicate the clues that enabled

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you to make your decision. In the space provided, write the directly stated or implied main idea.

1. Most crimes are committed in large urban areas rather than in small cities, suburbs, or rural areas. National Crime Victimization Survey data tell us the safest place to be is at home, although we are likely to be victimized when we are in familiar territory. In 2004, only one-quarter of violent crimes took place near or at the victim's home. Almost three-quarters of violent crimes occurred within five miles of home. Common locations for violent crimes are streets other than those near the victim's home (15 percent), at school (14 percent), or at a commercial establishment (8 percent).

   (Freda Adler et al., *Criminology*, 6/e, 2007)

   Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

   Main idea: _____

2. You know how when you buy your pants, there's a piece of paper in one of the pockets that says "inspected by #47." Who ARE these people anyway? Has anyone out there met one of these inspectors? What do they inspect? I mean seriously, if someone bends over and their pants rip, should we say, "Oh no! Who inspected that? Number 63? Whew. That was close. Mine were done by number 34." If there was a problem, what are you supposed to do? Call up the manufacturer and say, "Hello. I hate to be the one to break it to you, but you know number 63? She just isn't going to cut it anymore."

   (Tom Mather, *The Cheeseburger Philosophy*, 1996)

   Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

   _____

   Main idea: _____

3. Child labor laws prohibit a 13-year-old from punching a cash register for 40 hours a week, but that same child can labor for 40 hours or more inside a gym or an ice skating rink without drawing the slightest glance from the government. The U.S. government requires the licensing of plumbers. It demands that even the tiniest coffee shop adhere to a fastidious health code. It scrutinizes the advertising claims on packages of low-fat snack food. But it never asks a coach, who holds the lives of his young pupils in his hands, to pass a minimum safety and skills test. Coaches in this country need no license to coach children, even in a high-injury sport like elite gymnastics.

   (Joan Ryan, *Little Girls in Pretty Boxes*, 1995)

   Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

   _____

   Main idea: _____

4. Alcohol abuse by college students usually takes the form of a drinking pattern called *binge drinking*. Binge drinking is defined as the consumption of five drinks in a row. One large study of more than 17,000 students on 89 campuses found that 49.7 percent of students binged. The strongest predictors for binging were living in a fraternity or sorority, adopting a party-centered lifestyle, and engaging in other risky behavior. The study also suggested that many college students began binge drinking in high school.

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(Wayne A. Payne, Dale B. Hahn, and Ellen B. Lucas, *Understanding Your Health*, 10/e, 2009)

Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

Main idea: _____

5. Tina was found dead last week—her neck broken by the jaws of a steel trap. I didn't know Tina. But John and Rachel Williamson knew her, and so did their children, Tyrone and Vanessa. Tina had been a beloved member of their family for 10 years. She was a Samoyed—a handsome, intelligent dog, pure white with soft, dark eyes. When she died she was only 200 yards from her back door. Tina had gone out to play that morning as usual, but this time she found something *un*usual—an odd-shaped box with delicious-smelling food inside. She put her head inside the box to get at the food. When she did, the trap closed and Tina was killed. Unless we crack down on illegal trapping within town property, this tragedy will be repeated. The next time it might be *your* family dog. Or your pet cat. Or your child.

Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

_____

Main idea: _____

_____

6. To keep an adequate supply of pennies in circulation, the U.S. Mint creates approximately 12 billion new pennies each year. The cost of manufacturing these new pennies is .66 of a cent apiece, which adds up to approximately $80 million a year. According to Treasury officials, when you add on storage and handling expenses, it costs the U.S. government more than a penny to transact a penny's worth of business.

Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

_____

Main idea: _____

7. As we wait for the plane to climb to the jump altitude of 12,000 feet, my mind races with a frenzied jumble of thoughts: "Okay, this is the moment you've been waiting for. It's going to be great. Am I really going to jump out of an airplane from 12,000 feet? What if something goes wrong? Can I still back out? Come on now, don't worry. It'll be fine." My palms are sweating and my heart is pounding so hard I think it may burst. "Get ready," yells the instructor. As I jump into the blue, I wonder, "What am I doing here?" The blast of air resistance blows me backward like a leaf at the mercy of the autumn wind. In about ten seconds my body levels out and accelerates to a speed of 120 miles an hour. The air supports my body like an invisible flying carpet. Any fears or doubts I had are gone in the exhilaration of free flight. Every nerve in my body is alive with sensation; yet I am overcome by a peaceful feeling and the sense that I am one with the sky.

(Stephen E. Lucas, *The Art of Public Speaking*, 9/e, 2007)

Purpose: _____ Clues: _____

Main idea: _____

The articles presented in the next section all deal, directly or indirectly, with the world of work. Read each article noting the purpose and then answer the questions.

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STUDY TECHNIQUE FOR WRITING SUMMARIES

In your reading and English classes, you will be called upon to write summaries. **Summarizing** simply means restating the main ideas of a reading in your own words. Because many supporting details are omitted, a summary is much shorter than the original on which it is based. When you write summaries, you need to present the main ideas in order of importance in an objective fashion. Keep in mind that you are reporting the author's viewpoints and not your own. When writing a summary, you never write something like "I feel" or "I think" or "it seems to me." Instead, you always write only the author's opinions. In a summary, it is always the *author* who feels, thinks, or believes.

It takes practice to learn how to write a good summary. However, since we have now learned how to identify directly stated main ideas and how to state implied ones, we are ready to begin learning how to write a summary of a short article. You just read an article by Walter S. Minot titled "Students Who Push Burgers." This is a relatively easy article to summarize because the author presents his main ideas in a logical sequence. Try to locate the directly stated main ideas. Because not all of the main ideas are stated directly, you will have to come up with several implied main ideas.

In order to identify the key supporting details, try to answer as many of the question words (*who, what, where, when, why,* and *how*) about the topic as possible.

Summarizing an Article

Directions:

1. Provide answers to *who, what, where, when, why,* and *how.* (Not all of these question words will apply to every article.)

   Who: _____

   What: _____

   Where: _____

   When: _____

   Why: _____

   How: _____

2. List four to five main ideas from the article, paraphrasing each main idea. The overall main idea of the article is: Student employment is a major cause of the decline in American education.

   1st main idea: _____

   _____

   2nd main idea: _____

   _____

   3rd main idea: _____

   _____

   4th main idea: _____

   _____

   5th main idea: _____

   _____

3. Write at least a half-page summary of the article. Be sure to include the information from numbers 1 and 2 in your summary. Your completed summary should contain no trivia (useless information) and should not be redundant (give information more than once). Remember to present the information in an organized way. After writing your summary, compare your version to the student sample in the Appendices.

Exercise 3: Understanding an Author's Purpose

Directions: Label each paragraph according to its general purpose: to inform (I), to entertain (E), or to persuade (P).

_____ 1. Since earliest times the fragrances of certain plants, owing to their essential oils, have been valued as a source of perfumes. It is difficult to pinpoint when people first began using plant fragrances to scent their bodies, but by 5,000 years ago the Egyptians were skilled

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perfumers, producing fragrant oils that were used by both men and women to anoint their hair and bodies. Fragrances were also used as incense to fumigate homes and temples in the belief that these aromas could ward off evil and disease. In fact, our very word *perfume* comes from the Latin *per* meaning through and *fumus* meaning smoke, possibly referring to an early use of perfumes as incense.

(Estelle Levetin and Karen McMahon, "Alluring Scents," 2008)

_____ 2. The images are vivid and appalling. Emaciated children with haunting eyes and distended stomachs, and too weak to cry, stare at us from news photos and television screens. Throughout the world, the problems of poverty and undernutrition are widespread and growing. The majority of undernourished people live in Asia. However, the largest increases in numbers of chronically hungry people occur in eastern Africa, particularly in Ethiopia, Sudan, Rwanda, Burundi, Sierra Leone, Kenya, Somalia, Eritrea, and Tanzania. Their eyes haunt us. If undernutrition is to be eradicated, the world's nations must examine the problem and assume responsibility. Life is not necessarily fair, but the aim of civilization should be to make it more so. The world has both enough food and the technical expertise to end hunger. What is lacking is the political will and cooperation to do so. It is time for leaders of rich and poor nations alike to come to an agreement on the best possible means to serve all of the world's citizens.

(Gordon Wardlaw, "Undernutrition throughout the World," 2007)

_____ 3. Are you lost in Cyberspace? You went away for three days and returned to find 1,892 messages in your mailbox. You just came out of the computer room and your dog is barking at you as if you were a stranger. You just missed your daughter's soccer game, your son's piano recital, or your best friend's wedding because you were traveling the information superhighway. Your family thinks you moved out a year ago.

(Nancy E. Willard, "Get a Life," 1997)

_____ 4. U.S. society strongly supports marriage, and about nine out of ten people at some point "tie the knot." But many of today's marriages unravel. By 2003, almost four in ten marriages were ending in divorce. Ours is the highest divorce rate in the world. At greatest risk of divorce are young couples—especially those who marry after a brief courtship, have little money, and have yet to mature emotionally. The chance of divorce also rises if a couple marries after an unexpected pregnancy or if one or both partners have substance abuse problems. People whose parents divorced also have a higher divorce rate themselves. Finally, people who are not religious are more likely to divorce than those who have strong religious beliefs.

(John J. Macionis, *Society*, 8/e, 2006)

_____ 5. How would you describe the behavior of Bruce Damon, who held up the Mutual Federal Savings Bank near Brockton, Massachusetts? Using a gun, Damon demanded $40 million. When the teller explained that the bank kept only $40,000 on the premises, he said, "Okay, $40,000." Now get this: He demanded not cash, but a check!

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You can imagine the ending. He was arrested a short time later when he tried to deposit the check into his account in another bank. Way to go, Bruce! Not very smart!

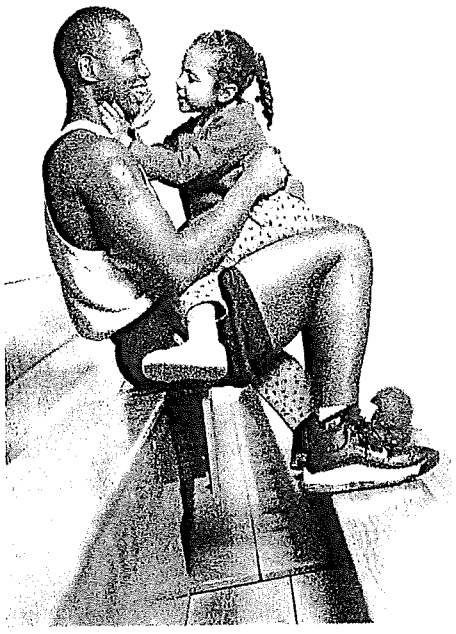
(Hamilton Gregory, "Incompetent Criminals," 2005)

_____ 6. Something must be done about high school dropouts. A student who drops out of high school not only hurts himself or herself, but the decision to leave high school before graduation also has harmful consequences for society. Dropping out of high school does not guarantee poverty, but dropouts do have to scramble harder to start a career—if they ever have one. Society suffers when many young people do not finish school. Dropouts are more likely to end up on welfare, to be unemployed, and to become involved with drugs, crime, and delinquency. In addition, the loss of taxable income burdens the public treasury. Fortunately, with a strong commitment by government, educators, and parents, it is possible to prevent dropping out. We can help millions of young people to have a brighter future. Doing nothing is a national tragedy.

(Diane E. Papalia, et al., "Dropping Out of High School," 2007)

Reading to Determine the Author's Purpose

READING



Olivia

"There've been nights when I've been so tired, I've been ready to quit on papers. But then I look in on Olivia sleeping, and turn right around and go back to my paper. I can't imagine a life without her."

TUNING IN TO READING The following story is about Wil Smith, a graduate of Bowdoin College in Maine. While attending college, Wil had full custody of his four-year-old daughter Olivia. He juggled his Bowdoin classes with parenting, playing basketball, and serving in the Naval Reserve. Mel Allen, senior editor at *Yankee Magazine*, met Wil Smith last fall and wrote a letter to Olivia about Wil. As you read this story, notice the obstacles that Wil managed to overcome. Are any of you trying to raise a child by yourself? What kinds of difficulties do you experience?

BIO-SKETCH Mel Allen has been senior features editor for *Yankee Magazine* since 1979. A former Peace Corps volunteer in Colombia, Mel became a fourth-grade teacher in Maine before publishing his first magazine story in 1977. As the father of two sons, he was especially moved by Wil's devotion to his daughter. "Wil's story is one of the most inspirational I have ever covered," Mel says.

NOTES ON VOCABULARY

pickup a game in which whoever shows up can play. In *pickup* games, there are no established teams.

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Internet Activity

Several Web sites offer useful information on parenting. The first two sites listed below are sponsored by physician groups, while the other sites are commercial. Find an article of interest to you, and describe the author's general and specific purposes.

www.aap.org (American Academy of Pediatrics)
www.kidshealth.org (Nemours Foundation)
parenting.ivillage.com (Scroll down.)
www.parentandchildonline.com (*Scholastic Magazine*)

REVIEW TEST 4: Topics, Main Ideas, Details, and Purpose

Multiple Choice

Directions: Read each passage. Then for each item, write the letter corresponding to the best answer.

A. If our business enterprises are to be as flexible and innovative at all levels as they need to be, our youngsters must be prepared to work with and through other people. While there will always be a need for a certain number of solo practitioners, the more usual requirement will be that combinations of individual skills are greater than their sums. Most of the important work will be done by groups, rather than by individual experts. . . . Young people must be taught how to work constructively together. Instead of emphasizing individual achievement and competition, the emphasis in the classroom should be on group performance. Students need to learn how to seek and accept criticism from their peers, to solicit help, and to give credit to others, where appropriate. They must also learn to negotiate—to articulate their own needs, to discern what others need and see things from others' perspectives, and to discover mutually beneficial outcomes.

(Robert Reich, "Dick and Jane Meet the New Economy," 1989)

_____ 1. The main idea expressed in this passage is that
   a. most of the work in the future will be done by individuals working alone.
   b. there are advantages and disadvantages to working collectively.
   c. many students are capable of learning to work together productively.
   d. young people need to be taught how to work together productively so that our business enterprises can successfully meet new challenges.

_____ 2. The author's primary purpose is to
   a. convince us of the necessity of emphasizing group activities in our educational systems.
   b. explain the dynamics of a business enterprise.
   c. entertain us with an interesting anecdote concerning the world of business.
   d. inform us of problems students are likely to face in the near future.

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_____ 3. The examples of seeking and accepting criticism, soliciting help, and giving appropriate credit were used to illustrate
a. skills students need to develop in order to work individually.
b. skills students need to develop in order to work cooperatively.
c. requirements of a top-notch school system.
d. the complexity of a business organization.

_____ 4. The best title for the paragraph would be
a. "Group Dynamics in Action."
b. "Cooperative Learning."
c. "The Solo Practitioner."
d. "Group Learning and Business."

B. In the same way that doctors, janitors, lawyers, and industrial workers develop unique ways of looking at and responding to their work environment, so too do police officers. Police officers are often viewed as suspicious and authoritative. Police work is potentially dangerous, so officers need to be constantly aware of what is happening around them. They are frequently warned about what happens to officers who are too trusting. They learn about the many officers who have died in the line of duty because they did not exercise proper caution. On the street, they need to stay alert for signals that crimes may be in progress: an unfamiliar noise, someone "checking into" an alleyway, a secret exchange of goods. The working environment also demands that officers gain immediate control of potentially dangerous situations. They are routinely called on to demonstrate authority. Uniforms, badges, nightsticks, and guns signify authority—but officers soon learn that this authority is often challenged by a hostile public.

(Freda Adler, Gerhard O. W. Mueller, and William S. Laufer, *Criminal Justice*, 5/e, 2009)

_____ 5. The best title for this paragraph would be
a. "Jobs."
b. "The Outlook of Police Officers."
c. "The World of Work."
d. "Becoming a Police Officer."

_____ 6. All of the following were given as reasons for the effect of police work on an officer's outlook *except* for which?
a. a belief that courts are too lenient on criminals
b. a realization of what happens to officers when they are too trusting
c. the need to constantly monitor a situation
d. the need to assert authority

Written Assignment

Directions: Choose one of the following:

1. What kind of work gives you the most satisfaction? What kind of work do you find least rewarding? Write a paragraph discussing your answers.
2. Write a paragraph describing your job history. Explain why you liked or disliked your previous jobs. What did each of your previous jobs teach you about what you want to do as a future career?

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TOPICS, MAIN IDEAS & SUPPORTING DETAILS

LAN 100 | WRITING SKILLS

Paragraph Structure

How ideas develop in a clear academic paragraph

A strong paragraph presents one main idea and develops it with related supporting details and examples.

Paragraph Part	Example	Purpose
Main Idea	**Studying abroad can significantly improve students' cultural awareness.**	Introduces the paragraph's primary focus and tells the reader what will be discussed.
Supporting Detail 1	Living in a foreign country exposes students to new traditions and ways of life.	Provides the first key point that directly supports the main idea.
Minor Supporting Detail 1	For example, they may experience local festivals and cuisine that are different from their home culture.	Adds a specific example or piece of evidence.
Supporting Detail 2	Students also interact with people from diverse backgrounds in academic and social settings.	Adds another important point and develops the paragraph further.
Minor Supporting Detail 2	Group projects or international clubs allow them to learn about various perspectives.	Provides evidence or an example for Supporting Detail 2.
Concluding Sentence	**By embracing these experiences, students develop a broader understanding of the world and greater respect for cultural differences.**	Returns to the main idea, summarises the development and gives closure.

The Complete Paragraph

Studying abroad can significantly improve students' cultural awareness. Living in a foreign country exposes students to new traditions and ways of life. *For example, they may experience local festivals and cuisine that are different from their home culture.* Students also interact with people from diverse backgrounds in academic and social settings. *Group projects or international clubs allow them to learn about various perspectives.* **By embracing these experiences, students develop a broader understanding of the world and greater respect for cultural differences.**

Remember

- Every sentence should relate to the main idea.
- Supporting details explain the main idea.
- Minor details give examples, evidence or explanation.

Basic Pattern

- Main idea
- Supporting detail + minor detail
- Supporting detail + minor detail
- Concluding sentence

LAN 100 General Advanced English
Instructor: Helen Stavrou

Paragraph Writing Activity

Use the following main idea sentences to write a well-developed paragraph. Be sure to firstly think of 2 Supporting details which you will further develop when you write your paragraph. For at least one of the supporting details, provide a minor supporting detail also.

1. Being a student at the University of Cyprus is a lot of fun.

SD. _____

mSD._____

SD._____

mSD._____

2. Being a student at the University of Cyprus is a lot of hard work.

SD._____

mSD._____

SD._____

mSD._____

3. Living alone for the first time is a life-changing experience.

SD._____

mSD._____

SD._____

mSD._____

4. Falling in love can have wonderful effects on your health.

SD._____

mSD._____

SD._____

mSD._____

5. Breaking-up can have disastrous effects on your health.

SD._____

mSD._____

SD._____

mSD._____

Annotated Academic Paragraph

A paragraph is a small, organised unit of meaning. Each sentence has a job.

The Benefits of Joining University Clubs

Topic sentence

Joining university clubs helps students become more confident and connected to campus life.

↓

Explanation

Clubs allow students to meet new people, practise communication skills and develop interests outside the classroom.

↓

Example

For example, a first-year student who joins the debating society can improve public speaking while making new friends.

↓

Closing sentence

As a result, joining a club can make the university experience more enjoyable and rewarding.

1. Topic sentence

States the paragraph's main idea.

2. Explanation

Develops and clarifies the main idea.

3. Example

Shows or supports the idea with a specific case.

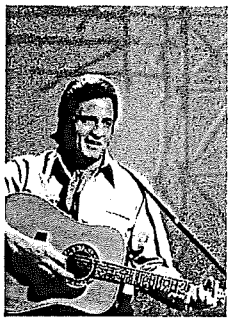
4. Closing sentence

Completes the point and gives the paragraph a clear ending.

Quick check: Every supporting sentence should connect directly to the topic sentence. If it does not, it probably does not belong in the paragraph.

CHAPTER 2

Topics, Main Ideas, and Details



CHAPTER PREVIEW

In this chapter, you will

- Learn how to distinguish between general ideas and specific details.
- Learn how to identify the topic of a paragraph.
- Learn how to locate the stated main idea of a paragraph.
- Learn how to diagram a paragraph by identifying its main idea sentence and key details.
- Become familiar with paraphrasing.
- Learn how to formulate implied main ideas.

Description of Topics, Main Ideas, and Details

Write your own definition for each boldfaced term. Use your own words.

topic or subject:

_____

_____

main idea:

_____

_____

details:

_____

_____

Most paragraphs are about a particular **topic** or **subject.** The topic is usually a single word or phrase and is often the noun that is mentioned most frequently in a paragraph. We can identify the topic by asking ourselves "What is this all about?" or "Who is this all about?"

Paragraphs are supposed to be organized around a **main idea,** with all sentences supporting this main idea, or key point. The main idea can be identified by asking "What key point does the author want me to know about the topic?"

The main idea may be directly stated in a paragraph, usually, but not always, in the first or last sentence, or it can be implied. When trying to find a main idea that is directly stated, it helps to remember that you are looking for a general statement, not a specific one. When main ideas are implied, you, the reader, are responsible for coming up with a general statement that unites the author's key details. This general statement should be no more than one sentence long.

While all paragraphs have a topic, not all paragraphs have main ideas. Some background or descriptive paragraphs, which are meant to set the tone or mood of a piece of writing, may not have any main idea at all.

Details are supporting sentences that reinforce the main idea. While the main idea is a general statement, supporting details provide specific information such as facts, examples, or reasons that explain or elaborate on the main idea. Details answer the question words about the topic: *who, what, where, when, why,* and *how.*

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Baby Blues

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As an illustration of the difference between main ideas and details, study the *Baby Blues* cartoon. In it, Darryl provides Wanda with the main idea of the phone conversation but is unable to provide her with any of the supporting details.

major supporting details:

Those supporting sentences that directly reinforce the main idea are called **major supporting details,** and those sentences that serve only to reinforce the major supporting details are called **minor supporting details.** To gain an understanding of how main ideas and major and minor supporting details work in a paragraph, read the following paragraph on posture as body language and study the outline.

minor supporting details:

> 1. Posture often indicates feelings of tension or relaxation. We take relaxed postures in non-threatening situations and tighten up in threatening situations. Based on this observation, we can tell a good deal about how others feel simply by watching how tense or loose they seem to be. For example, watching tenseness is a way of detecting status differences. The lower-status person is generally the more rigid, tense-appearing one, whereas the higher status person is more relaxed. This is the kind of situation that often happens when an employee sits ramrod straight while the boss leans back in her chair. The same principle applies to social situations, where it's often possible to tell who's uncomfortable by looking at pictures. Often you'll see someone laughing and talking as if he were perfectly at home, but his posture almost shouts nervousness. Some people never relax, and their posture shows it.
>
> (Ronald B. Adler, Russell F. Proctor II, and Neil Towne, *Looking Out, Looking In,* 11/e, 2005)

In the outline, MI refers to the main idea, MSD to major supporting details, and msd to minor supporting details.

I. Posture often indicates feelings of tension or relaxation. (MI)
  A. Person displays relaxed posture when not threatened. (MSD)
  B. Person displays tense posture when feeling threatened. (MSD)
  C. Tension or relaxation in posture may indicate status. (MSD)
    1. Tense-appearing person has low status. (msd)
    2. Relaxed-appearing person has high status. (msd)
  D. Posture indicates who's comfortable in a social setting. (MSD)

In the following example, the general topic is sensitivity to nonverbal communication. The format is fairly typical of information presented in college textbooks.

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The main idea is given in the first sentence of the paragraph. The sentences following the main idea are all meant to serve as examples illustrating it. The last sentence concludes the paragraph and reinforces the main idea.

2. Cultural diversity in the workplace has created a need for greater sensitivity among managers and employees regarding people's use of nonverbal communication. For example, white Americans define eye contact in the course of a conversation as showing respect. But many Latinos do not, and many Americans of Asian ancestry deem eye contact with an employer to be exceedingly disrespectful behavior. Potential conflicts may arise when white supervisors consider Hispanic or Asian employees furtive or rude for casting their eyes about the room. Multicultural training programs seek to teach employers and employees to look beyond their culture-bound notions about what constitutes "proper" and "improper" behavior.

(Michael Hughes and Carolyn J. Kroehler, *Sociology*, 7/e, 2005)

You may have experienced difficulty finding the main ideas in these two sample paragraphs. But don't be discouraged. This chapter will give you the skills you need to readily find main ideas and supporting details.

Distinguishing between General and Specific

In order to be able to recognize a main idea, you must be able to determine the difference between something that is general and something that is specific. Remember, a main idea is a general statement that is supported by specific details. In the first example below, a car is something that is general because there are more specific kinds of cars. A sedan would be one specific kind of car, and a convertible would be another. In the second example, tree is the broad category. An ash tree is a specific kind of tree, as is an elm tree.

Car	Tree
sedan	ash
convertible	elm

Directions: Give two specific terms for each general category.

Example:

Professional baseball teams
Los Angeles Dodgers
New York Yankees

1. Wild animals
   _____
   _____

2. Countries
   _____
   _____

3. Weekly magazines
   _____
   _____

4. Universities
   _____
   _____

5. College courses
   _____
   _____

6. U.S. presidents
   _____
   _____

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Directions: Give a general term that covers the specific items.

Example:

Jazz musicians
Louis Armstrong
Wynton Marsalis
Miles Davis

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
Aleve	Picasso	*Spider-Man*
Bayer	Van Gogh	*Avatar*
Excedrin	Monet	*Pirates of the Caribbean*

Directions: A general or main idea sentence is given to you. Working in a group, try to come up with two sentences that support the main idea. Your sentences should provide specific details by giving reasons or examples.

Example: Many people do not use antibiotics properly.

a. They stop taking the antibiotic when they start feeling better.

b. They pass them around to their friends like candy.

1. Children today don't treat their parents with much respect.

   a. They _____

   b. They _____

2. Young boys are more interested in active, aggressive play than little girls.

   a. Boys play _____

   b. Girls play _____

3. In the last 10 years, a new kind of father has emerged.

   a. Fathers now _____

   b. Fathers now _____

4. For a student in the United States, school is just like a job.

   a. Students have to _____

   b. Students have to _____

5. Holding a part-time job can benefit students.

   a. They learn _____

   b. They learn _____

6. People are more isolated from their neighbors today than they were 50 years ago.

   a. They no longer _____

   b. They no longer _____

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7. The traditional family (husband as breadwinner, wife as homemaker) has all but disappeared.

   a. Today _____

   b. Today _____

Now apply what you have learned about general and specific to help you identify the topic of a paragraph. A good topic is comprehensive because it covers all of the ideas mentioned in the paragraph. Sometimes it helps to think of the topic as a title for the paragraph.

Directions: For each paragraph, determine the best topic and put a T on the line. Put a G on the line of the topic that is too general or broad and an S on the line of the topic that is too specific.

1. There is no doubt that advertisers have zeroed in on the child audience. The last few years have seen the growth of kid-specific media: Nikelodeon, websites, kid-oriented magazines, movie tie-ins, and even hamburger wrappers. From 1993 to 1999, advertising in these media increased more than 50 percent, to $1.5 billion per year. Part of the reason behind this increase is the fact that kids have become important factors in family buying decisions. First, they have more money to spend. The under-14 set gets allowances, earns money, and receives gifts to the tune of about $20 billion per year. In addition, kids probably influence another $200 billion worth of shopping decisions. Second, the increase in single-parent families and dual-career families means that kids are now making some of the purchasing decisions that were once left to Mom and Dad. It is not surprising, then, to find that companies are intensifying their efforts to reach this market segment.

   (Joseph R. Dominick, *The Dynamics of Mass Communication*, 8/e, 2005)

   Example:

   G a. Audiences (This is too broad—it covers all types of audiences, not just child audiences.)

   S b. A 50 percent increase in child advertising (This provides one specific detail from the paragraph.)

   T c. Advertisers target child audiences (This covers all the ideas in the paragraph.)

2. Which sex is healthier: women or men? We know that women have a higher life expectancy than men and lower death rates throughout life. Women's greater longevity has been attributed to genetic protection given by the second X chromosome (which men do not have). However, factors such as men's greater propensity for risk taking and their preference for meat and potatoes rather than fruits and vegetables, also may play a part. Despite their longer life, women are more likely than men to report being in fair or poor health, go to doctors or seek outpatient or emergency room care more often, are more likely to seek treatment for minor illnesses, and report more unexplained symptoms. Men are *less* likely to seek professional help for health problems, but they have longer hospital stays, and their health problems are more likely to be chronic and life-threatening. Women's greater tendency to seek medical care does not

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necessarily mean that they are in worse health than men, nor that they are imagining ailments or are preoccupied with illness. They may simply be more health conscious. Men may feel that illness is not "masculine," and seeking help means a loss of control. Research suggests that a man is least likely to seek help when he perceives a health problem as a threat to his self-esteem or if he believes his male peers would look down on him. It may well be that the better care women take of themselves helps them live longer than men.

(Diane E. Papalia, Sally Wendkos Olds, and Ruth Duskin Feldman, *Human Development*, 10/e, 2007)

_____ a. Men and women

_____ b. Which sex is healthier?

_____ c. Men and longer hospital stays

3. Engineers and inventors often appropriate their best ideas directly from the natural world. Perhaps the best example of this is the development of Velcro fasteners. Today, Velcro has hundreds of uses in diapers, running shoes, space suits, even in sealing the chambers of artificial hearts. But it all started in 1948, when George de Mestral, a Swiss hiker, observed the manner in which cockleburs clung to clothing and thought that a fastener could be designed using the pattern. Cockleburs have up to several hundred curved prickles that function in seed dispersal. These tiny prickles tenaciously hook onto clothing or the fur of animals and are thus transported to new areas. De Mestral envisioned a fastener with thousands of tiny hooks, mimicking the cocklebur prickles on one side, and on the other side thousands of tiny eyes for the hooks to lock onto. It took 10 years to perfect the original concept of the "locking tape" that has become Velcro, and is so common in modern life.

(Estelle Levetin and Karen McMahon, *Plants and Society*, 5/e, 2008)

_____ a. Velcro use in diapers and shoes

_____ b. Inventions

_____ c. The development of Velcro

4. Women absorb and metabolize alcohol differently than men do. A woman cannot metabolize much alcohol in the cells that line her stomach. Women also have less body water in which to dilute the alcohol than do men. So, when a man and a woman of similar size drink equal amounts of alcohol, a larger proportion of the alcohol reaches and remains in the woman's bloodstream. Overall, women develop alcohol-related ailments such as cirrhosis of the liver more rapidly than men do with the same alcohol consumption habits.

(Gordon Wardlaw, *Contemporary Nutrition*, 6/e, 2007)

_____ a. Alcohol

_____ b. The development of cirrhosis of the liver in women

_____ c. Gender differences in alcohol effects

5. Ethnocentrism is the belief that our own group or culture—whatever it may be—is superior to all other groups or cultures. If you were born and raised in the United States, you may find it strange that most people in India regard the cow as a sacred animal and forgo using it as a source of food. On the other hand, if you were born and raised in India, you might well be shocked at the use of cows in the United States for food, clothing, and other consumer goods. If you are a Christian, you most likely think of Sunday as the "normal" day of

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10. The voice can be used to produce a wide range of nonverbal behaviors such as sounds that are not words, laughter, pauses, silence, breathing patterns, and voice qualities. Laughter is an almost universal sign of happiness and good feelings. Pauses during a conversation can convey a variety of meanings, including confusion, concentration, thoughtful reflection, anger, nervousness, or suspense. The way you breathe often reflects your emotional state. Breathing quickly and loudly might signal arousal, physical exertion, or anxiety, whereas breathing slowly might communicate that one is relaxed or tired.

(Bethami A. Dobkin and Roger C. Pace, *Communication in a Changing World*, 2006)

Main idea: _____

A. Objects and possessions can be forms of nonverbal communication.
B. Culture affects the treatment of space.
C. Reasons for wearing a veil (hijab) when out in public vary among Muslim women.
D. The voice itself can be used to communicate nonverbally.
E. How people dress affects how others respond to them.
F. Sometimes people deliberately use nonverbal cues to send specific messages.
G. Humans mark and defend their territory by communicating with objects or signs.
H. Culture plays a big role in determining what smells people consider pleasant and what smells they find repugnant.
I. Countries around the world have different gestures for friendly greetings.
J. Colors can have varying meanings in different cultures.

Directions: Now locate the topic of each paragraph and the main idea sentence. The main idea can be identified by asking, "What key point does the author want me to know about the topic?"

1. Physical motions and gestures provide signals. The "preening behavior" that accompanies courtship is a good illustration. Women frequently stroke their hair, check their makeup, rearrange their clothes, or push the hair away from the face. Men may adjust their hair, tug at their tie, straighten their clothes, or pull up their socks. These are signals that say, "I'm interested in you. Notice me. I'm an attractive person."

   Topic: _____

   Main idea: _____

2. Students who sit in the front rows of a classroom tend to be the most interested, those in the rear are more prone to mischievous activities, and students on the aisles are primarily concerned with quick departures. As you can see, the way we employ social and personal space also contains messages.

   Topic: _____

   Main idea: _____

3. Through physical contact such as touch, we convey our feelings to one another. However, touch can also constitute an invasion of privacy, and it can become a symbol of power when people want to make power differences visible. For example, a high-status person might take the liberty of patting a

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low-status person on the back or shoulder, something that is deemed inappropriate for the subordinate.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

(James W. Vander Zanden, *Sociology*, 4/e, 1996)

4. Gestures that mean approval in the United States may have different meanings in other countries. The "thumbs up" sign, which means "good work" or "go ahead" in the United States and most of western Europe, is a vulgar insult in Greece. The circle formed with the thumb and first finger that means OK in the United States is obscene in southern Italy and can mean you're worth nothing in France and Belgium. And in Japan the circle gesture is associated with money.

(Kitty O. Locker and Donna S. Kienzler, *Business and Administrative Communication*, 8/e, 2008)

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

5. Even the gestures for such basic messages as "yes" and "no," "hello" and "good-bye" are culturally based. In the United States people nod their heads up and down to signal "yes" and shake them back and forth to signal "no." In Thailand the same actions have exactly the opposite meaning! To take another example, the North American "good-bye" wave is interpreted in many parts of Europe and South America as the motion for "no," while the Italian and Greek gestures for "good-bye" is the same as the U.S. signal for "come here."

(Stephen E. Lucas, *The Art of Public Speaking*, 9/e, 2007)

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

Varying Positions for Main Ideas

In previous exercises, we saw that the main idea in a paragraph is frequently located at either the beginning or the end of the paragraph. However, the main idea also may appear in other locations within a paragraph, such as in the middle, or at both the beginning and the end. Wherever the main idea is located, it must be supported by details. Most authors provide examples, illustrations, major points, reasons, or facts and statistics to develop their main idea. While a main idea can be either directly stated somewhere in the paragraph or implied, supporting details are always directly stated. The ability to recognize supporting details is of crucial importance in the reading process. Locating supporting details will tell you whether you have correctly identified the main idea.

Paragraph Diagrams

For those of you who are visual learners, graphic organizers may be helpful. The following diagrams, a type of graphic organizer, show the development of a para-

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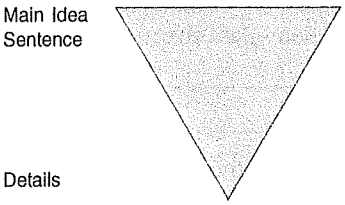
graph by indicating the position of the main idea and supporting details. The topic of each of the following paragraphs is the healing power of laughter.

(Brent Q. Hafen et al., *Mind/Body Health,* 1996)

Directions: After reading the explanation for each type of paragraph, write several key supporting details on the line provided.

1. Laughter as medicine is probably as old as humankind. One of the earliest written accounts recognizing the healing power of humor is found in the Bible, in which King Solomon remarked that a "merry heart doeth good like medicine" (Proverbs 17:22). Sixteenth-century educator Richard Mulcater prescribed laughter for those afflicted with head colds and melancholy; a favorite "cure" was being tickled in the armpits. The famous seventeenth-century physician Thomas Sydenham said that "the arrival of a good clown exercises more beneficial influence upon the health of a town than twenty donkeys laden with drugs."



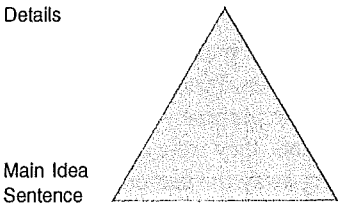
In paragraph 1, the main idea is stated in the first sentence. The supporting details are a series of examples illustrating the main idea. A diagram of this type of paragraph would be a triangle with the point aiming downward. The main idea is represented by the horizontal line at the top.

Supporting detail: _____

Supporting detail: _____

_____

2. Some researchers have found that a humorous outlook on life can have far-reaching benefits such as enhancing self-esteem and promoting creativity. Others suggest that humor improves negotiating and decision-making skills. Still others have found that a healthy sense of humor helps maintain a balanced outlook, improves performance, and bestows a feeling of power. At the very least, humor helps to relieve stress and improves coping abilities. As you can see, a sense of humor has tremendous psychological benefits.

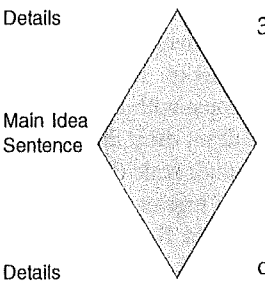


In paragraph 2, the author gives examples at the beginning and uses the main point to draw a conclusion. A diagram for this type of paragraph places the main idea at the bottom of the triangle.

Supporting detail: _____

Supporting detail: _____

3. Laughter requires no special training. It requires no special equipment. You don't have to do it at the gym or on the track or on a Nautilus machine. Laughter is one of the best exercises around. It improves your digestion, stimulates your central nervous system, improves and tones the cardiovascular system, thereby providing what some experts have called "a total inner body workout."



In paragraph 3, the author begins with reasons explaining why laughter is one of the best exercises, states the main idea, and then concludes with additional reasons. Because the main idea is in the middle, the diagram resembles a diamond.

Supporting detail: _____

Supporting detail: _____

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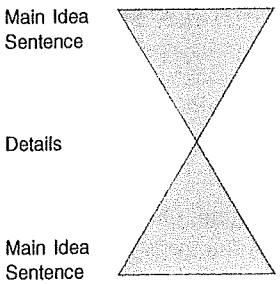
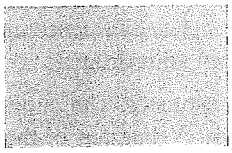


4. A sense of humor can give us a sense of power. Anatoly Sharansky, the Russian human rights advocate, was confined for nine years in Soviet prisons. The Soviet police constantly threatened Sharansky with the *rastrel* (firing squad). Sharansky started to win the war against fear with humor. He started joking about the firing squad and talking about it on a daily basis. "You make jokes fifteen to twenty times," Sharansky remembers, "and the word becomes like any other word." Humor can turn any situation around and give us a feeling of power over our circumstances.

In paragraph 4, the author begins with the main idea, provides a detailed illustration of it, and concludes with a restatement of the main idea. A diagram of this type of paragraph would have an hour-glass shape.

Supporting detail: _____

Supporting detail: _____



5. In a study by University of Maryland psychologist Alice Isen, she split volunteers into two groups. One either watched a math film or did a monotonous exercise; the other group watched a clip of funny television "bloopers" or received candy.

In paragraph 5, the main idea is not stated in any specific sentence. Instead, all of the sentences are working together to create a word picture in your mind of an experiment in progress. Because no one sentence is clearly the main idea, a diagram of this paragraph might resemble a square or a rectangle.

Directions: For additional practice, identify the main idea in each paragraph below. Then draw a diagram of the paragraph and list the supporting details.

1. Humor has been used across the span of cultures to make people feel better. A number of American Indian tribes—the Zunis, Crees, Pueblos, and Hopis among them—had ceremonial clowns whose sole purpose was to provide humor for their tribesmen. According to accounts, they were called in "to entertain and heal the sick with hilarity, frightening away the demons of ill health."

It takes 17 muscles to smile, 43 muscles to frown.

Diagram: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

Supporting detail: _____

_____

2. A sense of humor can actually promote good health by strengthening the immune system. Researchers subjected volunteers to a set of "hassles," situations known to invoke stress. The researchers found that people with a low sense of humor reacted strongly to the hassles causing a significant drop in their ability to withstand disease. Those who rated high on the humor scale demonstrated a strengthened immune function, even when subjected to hassles and stressors. It appears that people who tend to have a humorous outlook have greater immunity against a variety of diseases as well as increased ability to fight off infection.

Diagram: _____

Main idea: _____

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Supporting details: _____

_____

3. There are strong gender differences in laughter. Research shows that while both sexes laugh a lot, females laugh more. In male–female conversations, females laugh 126 percent more than their male counterparts. But across cultures, from early childhood on, men seem to be the main instigators of humor. Think back to your high school class clown—most likely he was a male. And so women tend to do the most laughing while males tend to do the most laugh-getting. The gender pattern of everyday laughter also suggests why there are more male than female comedians.

(Brent Q. Hafen et al., *Mind/Body Health*, 1996)

Diagram: _____

Main idea: _____

Supporting details: _____

_____

4. Humor can be used inappropriately and actually cause distress. Anyone who has seen the hurt and puzzled expression on another's face in response to an ironic remark, or remembers how she or he may have felt as an object of a joke, has witnessed humor's power to cause distress. Because humor's effects are not always predictable, experts recommend that humor be used carefully when helping someone else with stress so as not to make the situation worse. However, once consideration is given to the potential negative effects of humor and they are judged to be minimal, don't hesitate to use this approach when you think it would be helpful.

(Jerrold S. Greenberg, *Comprehensive Stress Management*, 8/e, 2004)

Diagram: _____

Main idea: _____

Supporting detail: _____

"He deserves paradise who makes his companions laugh."
—The Koran

5. Pain reduction is one of laughter's promising benefits. Rosemary Cogan, a professor of psychology at Texas Tech University, found that subjects who laughed at a Lily Tomlin video or underwent a relaxation procedure tolerated more discomfort than other subjects. James Rotton, a professor at Florida International University, reported that orthopedic surgery patients who watched comedy videos requested fewer aspirin and tranquilizers than the group that viewed dramas. It appears that humor may help alleviate intense pain.

(Robert Provine, "The Science of Laughter," 2000)

Diagram: _____

Main idea: _____

Supporting details: _____

_____

_____

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Directions: The main idea sentence appears at different locations in the following paragraphs. Write the letter of the main idea sentence on the line. Then draw a diagram of the paragraph and list the supporting details.

1. (a) American males may feel uncomfortable when Middle Eastern heads of state greet the U.S. president with a kiss on the cheek. (b) A German student, accustomed to speaking rarely to "Herr Professor," considers it strange that at American colleges most faculty office doors are open and students stop by freely. (c) An Iranian student on her first visit to an American McDonald's restaurant fumbles around in her paper bag looking for the eating utensils until she sees the other customers eating their French fries with, of all things, their hands. (d) In many areas of the globe, your best manners and my best manners may be exceedingly offensive to people of different nationalities and may cause us to make a serious breach of etiquette. (e) Foreigners visiting Japan often struggle to master the rules of the social game—when to take their shoes off, how to pour the tea, when to give and open gifts, how to act toward someone higher or lower in the social hierarchy.

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting details: _____

   _____

2. (a) Cultures also vary in their norms for personal expressiveness and time. (b) To someone from a relatively formal northern European culture, a person whose roots are in an expressive Mediterranean culture may seem "warm, charming, inefficient, and time-wasting." (c) To the Mediterranean person, the northern European may seem "efficient, cold, and over concerned with time." (d) Latin American business executives who arrive late for a dinner engagement may be mystified by how obsessed their American counterparts are with punctuality.

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting details: _____

3. (a) Adults maintain more distance from each other than children. (b) Men keep more distance from one another than do women. (c) Cultures near the equator prefer less space and more touching and hugging. (d) Thus the British and Scandinavians prefer more distance than the French and Arabs; North Americans prefer more space than Latin Americans. (e) As you can see, individuals and groups differ in their need for personal space.

   (David G. Myers, *Social Psychology*, 9/e, 2008)

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting detail: _____

4. (a) Once in Mexico I raised my hand to a certain height to indicate how tall a child was. (b) My hosts began to laugh. (c) It turned out that Mexicans have a more complicated system of hand gestures to indicate height: one for people, a second for animals, and a third for plants. (d) What had amused them was that I had ignorantly used the plant gesture to indicate the child's height.

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting detail: _____

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5. (a) To get along in another culture, then, it is important to learn the gestures of that culture. (b) If you don't, you will not only fail to achieve the simplicity of communication that gestures allow but you will also miss much of what is happening, run the risk of appearing foolish, and possibly offend people. (c) In some cultures, for example, you would provoke deep offense if you were to offer food or a gift with your left hand, because the left hand is reserved for dirty tasks, such as wiping after going to the bathroom.

(James M. Henslin, *Essentials of Sociology*, 7/e, 2007)

Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting details: _____

6. (a) When Big Boy opened a restaurant in Bangkok, it quickly became popular with European and American tourists, but the local Thais refused to eat there. (b) Instead they placed gifts of rice and incense at the feet of the Big Boy statue (a chubby boy holding a hamburger) because it reminded them of Buddha. (c) In Japan, customers were forced to tiptoe around a logo painted on the floor at the entrance to an Athlete's Foot store because in Japan, it is considered taboo to step on a crest. (d) And, in Brazil, a donut shop failed because consumers felt the hole meant they were being cheated or shortchanged. (e) As these examples illustrate, many businesspeople engaged in international trade underestimate the importance of social and cultural differences.

(O. C. Ferrell, Geoffrey Hirt, and Linda Ferrell, *Business*, 5/e, 2006)

Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting details: _____

7. (a) Coor's slogan "Turn it loose" was translated into Spanish where it was read as "Suffer from diarrhea." (b) Colgate introduced Cue toothpaste in France, only to discover that Cue is a French pornographic magazine. (c) Translated into Chinese, Pepsi's "Come alive with the Pepsi generation" became "Pepsi brings back your ancestors from the grave." (d) Clairol introduced the Mist Stick curling iron in Germany where "mist" is German slang for manure. (e) These examples underscore that firms that want to market a product globally and reach consumers of varying cultures need to become thoroughly acquainted with the language, customs, prejudices, and tastes of the intended market.

Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting details: _____

8. (a) Even numbers have different meanings in different countries. (b) Marketers should avoid using the number four when addressing Chinese, Korean, and Japanese consumers. (c) Although advertising that says "four times the savings" would probably appeal to American consumers, it would not appeal to an Asian audience because four is the number for death in Asian numerology.

Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting details: _____

9. (a) Westerners consider direct eye contact important, but many cultures see it as a personal affront, conveying a lack of respect. (b) In Japan, for example, when shaking hands, bowing, and especially when talking, it is important to glance only occasionally into the other person's face. (c) One's gaze should instead focus on fingertips, desk tops, and carpets. (d) In the words of one

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American electronics representative, "Always keep your shoes shined in Tokyo. (e) You can bet a lot of Japanese you meet will have their eyes on them."

(David H. Olson and John DeFrain, *Marriage and Families*, 5/e, 2006)

Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting details: _____

10. (a) In New York City, the party invitation may say 9:00 P.M., but nobody would think of showing up before 9:30 P.M. (b) In Salt Lake City, guests are expected to show up on time, or perhaps even a bit early. (c) Consider your own experience. (d) In school, some instructors begin and end class punctually, while others are more casual. (e) With some people you feel comfortable talking for hours in person or on the phone, while with others time seems to be precious and not "wasted." (f) As you can see, even within a culture, rules of time vary.

(Ronald B. Adler, Russell F. Proctor II, and Neil Towne, *Looking Out, Looking In*, 11/e, 2005)

Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting details: _____

Internet Activity

To discover more about nonverbal communication, visit the following Web site sponsored by the University of California at Santa Cruz:

http://nonverbal.ucsc.edu/

You can test your skill at "reading" samples of nonverbal communication in the areas of gestures and personal space. Write a short paragraph explaining what you learned.

Directions: In the following passages from Kitty Locker's *Business and Administrative Communication*, locate the topic of each paragraph and the main idea sentence, and write them on the designated lines. One supporting detail has been omitted from each paragraph. Look at the supporting details list at the end of the exercise, match each one to its correct paragraph, and then enter the paragraph number on the line.

1. In the United States smiling varies from region to region. Thirty years ago, Ray Birdwhistell found that "middle-class individuals" from Ohio, Indiana, and Illinois smiled more than did people from Massachusetts, New Hampshire, and Maine, who in turn smiled more than did western New Yorkers. People from cities in southern and border states—Atlanta, Louisville, Memphis, and Nashville—smiled most of all. Students from other countries who come to U.S. universities may be disconcerted by the American tendency to smile at strangers—until they realize that the smiles don't "mean" anything.

   Topic: _____

   Main idea: _____

2. Repeated studies have shown that older people are healthier both mentally and physically if they are touched. It is well-documented that babies need to be touched to grow and thrive. Touch, while necessary for optimum health, can communicate many messages. A person who dislikes touch may seem unfriendly to someone who's used to touching. A toucher may seem overly familiar to

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someone who dislikes touch. Studies in the United States have shown that touch is interpreted as power: more powerful people touch less powerful people.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

3. People who don't know each other well may feel more comfortable with each other if a piece of furniture separates them. For example, a group may work better sitting around a table than just sitting in a circle. Lecterns and desks can be used as barricades to protect oneself from other people. One professor normally walked among his students as he lectured. But if anyone asked a question he was uncomfortable with, he retreated behind the lectern before answering it. Spatial arrangements mean different things within a culture and between cultures. In the United States, the size, placement, and privacy of one's office connotes status. Large corner offices have the highest status. An individual office with a door that closes connotes more status than a desk in a common area. Japanese firms, however, see private offices as "inappropriate and inefficient," reports Robert Christopher. Only the very highest executives and directors have private offices in the traditional Japanese company, and even they will also have desks in the common area.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

4. People in many cultures want to establish a personal relationship before they decide whether to do business with each other. For example, to do business in Mexico, you need to develop a personal relationship. Tell me about you as a person. That's very important. Then I tell you about me, and we do this sometimes not just one time, but several times. Then I will trust you and I will value your qualities. Then I will like to work with you.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

5. Many North Americans measure time in five-minute blocks. Someone who's five minutes late to an appointment or a job interview feels compelled to apologize. If the executive or interviewer is running half an hour late, the caller expects to be told about the likely delay upon arriving. Some people won't be able to wait that long and will need to reschedule their appointments. But in other cultures, 15 minutes or half an hour may be the smallest block of time. To someone who mentally measures time in 15-minute blocks, being 45 minutes late is no worse than being 15 minutes late to someone who is conscious of smaller units. Different cultures also have different lead times. In some countries, you need to schedule important meetings at least two weeks in advance. In other countries, not only are people not booked up so far in advance, but a date two weeks into the future may be forgotten. Various cultures mentally measure time differently.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

6. Symbols (clothing, colors, and age) carry nonverbal meanings that vary from culture to culture. In North America, certain styles and colors of clothing are

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considered more "professional" and more "credible." In Japan, clothing denotes not only status but also occupational group. Students wear uniforms. Workers wear different clothes when they are on strike than they do when they are working. In the United States, youth is valued. Some men as well as some women color their hair and even have face-lifts to look as youthful as possible. In Japan, younger people defer to older people. Americans attempting to negotiate in Japan are usually taken more seriously if at least one member of the team is noticeably gray-haired.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

7. Height connotes status in many parts of the world. Executive offices are usually on the top floors; the underlings work below. Even being tall can help a person succeed. Studies have shown that employers are more willing to hire men over 6 feet tall than shorter men with the same credentials. In one study, every extra inch of height brought in an extra $1,300 a year.

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

8. Differences in eye contact can lead to miscommunication in the multicultural workplace. For example, North American whites see eye contact as a sign of honesty. But in many cultures, dropped eyes are a sign of appropriate deference to a superior. Puerto Rican children are taught not to meet the eyes of adults, and in Korea, prolonged eye contact is considered rude. The lower-ranking person is expected to look down first. Arab men in laboratory experiments looked at each other more than did two American men or two Englishmen. Eye contact is so important that Arabs dislike talking to someone wearing dark glasses or while walking side by side. It is considered impolite not to face someone directly. In Muslim countries, women and men are not supposed to make eye contact.

(Kitty O. Locker and Donna S. Kienzler, *Business and Administrative Communication*, 8/e, 2008)

Topic: _____

Main idea: _____

_____

(See directions on page 94.)

_____ In Arab countries, appointments are scheduled only three or four days in advance.

_____ In North America, a person sitting at the head of a table is generally assumed to be the group's leader.

_____ North Americans who believe that "time is money" are often frustrated in negotiations with people who place more emphasis on personal relationships.

_____ Company badges indicate rank within the organization.

_____ Superiors may feel that subordinates are being disrespectful when they look down, but the subordinate is being fully respectful—according to the norms of his or her culture.

_____ When the toucher had higher status than the recipient, both men and women liked being touched.

_____ Some scholars speculate that northerners may distrust the sincerity of southerners who smile a lot (like former President Jimmy Carter).

_____ Studies of real-world executives and graduates have shown that taller men make more money.

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Review Test 1: Topics, Main Ideas, and Details

Directions: Each of the following groups contains a series of related statements: One of the statements gives a topic, another gives a main idea, and the rest give supporting details. Identify the role of each statement in the space provided using the following abbreviations: **T** for Topic, **MI** for Main Idea, and **SD** for Supporting Detail.

Group 1

_____ a. A four-leaf clover means good luck.

_____ b. Red roses convey passionate love.

_____ c. The symbolic meaning of plants.

_____ d. Even today, several plants have symbolic meanings.

_____ e. An olive branch indicates peace.

Group 2

_____ a. Red indicates passion.

_____ b. White indicates sympathy.

_____ c. The meaning of floral colors.

_____ d. Floral colors also can communicate feelings.

_____ e. The color orange signifies friendship.

Group 3

_____ a. In the 1870s, an ardent suitor might have sent his beloved a bouquet of flowers that expressed a complete message.

_____ b. The symbolism of flowers reached its peak during the Victorian era, when almost every flower and plant had a special meaning.

_____ c. A bouquet of forget-me-nots conveyed the sentiment "remember me."

_____ d. A bouquet of jonquils, white roses, and ferns indicated that a suitor desired a return of affection, was worthy of his intended's love, and was fascinated by her.

_____ e. The "language" of flowers.

Group 4

_____ a. In 1875, in Switzerland, Daniel Peter and Henri Nestle created milk chocolate by adding condensed milk to chocolate liquor.

_____ b. In the 1890s, the first candy bar was created by adding nuts, fruits, caramels, and other ingredients to the chocolate liquor.

_____ c. For the love of chocolate.

_____ d. There have been many changes in chocolate candy since it was created in 1847.

_____ e. Milton Hershey modified the Peter process by adding whole milk.

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Group 5

_____ a. Food of the gods.

_____ b. According to Aztec mythology, the god Quetzalcoatl gave cacao beans to the Aztec people.

_____ c. The beans were later offered as gifts to the gods.

_____ d. The cacao tree, the source of chocolate, has long been cultivated by native peoples of Central and South America for religious purposes.

_____ e. The beans also were used to make a beverage consumed by priests on ceremonial occasions.

Group 6

_____ a. Originally chocolate candy bars were promoted as health foods.

_____ b. A high energy treat.

_____ c. In World War I, candy bars were given to the soldiers as a source of quick energy.

_____ d. In the 1920s, many candy bars claimed to aid the digestion and had names like Vegetable Sandwich.

(Estelle Levetin and Karen McMahon, *Plants and Society*, 5/e, 2008)

Review Test 2: Topics, Main Ideas, and Details

Directions: The following group contains a series of related statements: One of the statements gives a topic, another gives a main idea, and four give supporting details. Identify the role of each statement in the space provided using the following abbreviations: **T** for Topic, **MI** for Main Idea, and **SD** for Supporting Detail.

Group 1

_____ a. Between 9 and 12 months of age, for example, Maika pointed to things to show that she wanted an object, nodded her head to mean *yes*, and shook her head to mean *no*.

_____ b. Babies develop a rich repertoire of nonverbal gestures before saying their first words.

_____ c. At 13 months, she was using representational gestures such as holding up her arms to show that she wanted to be picked up, or holding an empty cup to her mouth to show that she wanted a drink.

_____ d. Symbolic gestures of babies.

(Diane E. Papalia, Sally Wendkos Olds, and Ruth Duskin Feldman, *Human Development*, 10/e, 2007)

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Group 2

_____ a. Demonstration of affection.

_____ b. For example, middle-class Brazilians teach their male and female children to kiss every adult relative they ever see.

_____ c. While females continue kissing throughout their lives, Brazilian men greet each other with a hearty handshake and a traditional male hug.

_____ d. Brazilians do not fear demonstrations of physical contact and affection.

(Conrad Phillip Kottak, Anthropology, 12/e, 2008)

Group 3

_____ a. In a suit brought by New Jersey importer, John Nix, tomatoes were legally declared vegetables in 1893 by the U.S. Supreme Court.

_____ b. The Spanish conquistadors introduced the tomato to Europe, where it was first known as the "Apple of Peru."

_____ c. What is a fruit?

_____ d. Later it was known as *pomo doro*, golden apple in Italy, and *pomme d'amour*, love apple (it was believed by many to be an aphrodisiac) in France.

_____ e. Tomatoes, one of the most common, popular, and versatile "vegetables," is technically a fruit.

_____ f. Justice Horace Gray said that although tomatoes are considered to be the fruits of the vine, they are usually served at dinner, and not, like fruits, generally as dessert.

(Estelle Levetin and Karen McMahon, *Plants and Society*, 5/e, 2008)

Review Test 3: Topics, Main Ideas, and Details

Directions: The main idea sentence appears at different locations in the following paragraphs. Write the letter of the main idea sentence on the line. Then draw a diagram of the paragraph and list the supporting details by letter.

1. (a) Americans eat oysters but not snails. (b) The French eat snails but not locusts. (c) The Zulus eat locusts but not fish. (d) The Jews eat fish but not pork. (e) The Hindus eat pork but not beef. (f) The Russians eat beef but not snakes. (g) The Chinese eat snakes but not people. (h) The Jalé of New Guinea find people delicious. (i) The diversity of our customs and expressive behavior suggests that much of our behavior is socially programmed, not hardwired.

   (David G. Myers, *Social Psychology*, 9/e, 2008)

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting details: _____

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2. (a) Most North Americans value "fairness." (b) "You're not playing fair" is a sharp criticism calling for changed behavior. (c) In some countries, however, people expect certain groups to receive preferential treatment. (d) Most North Americans accept competition and believe that it produces better performance. (e) The Japanese, however, believe that competition leads to disharmony. (f) U.S. business people believe that success is based on individual achievement and is open to anyone who excels. (g) However, in England and in France, success is more obviously linked to social class. (h) Many people in the United States value individualism, but other countries may value the group. (i) In traditional classrooms, U.S. students are expected to complete assignments alone; if they get much help from anyone else, they're "cheating." (j) In Japan, in contrast, groups routinely work together to solve problems. (k) It appears that values and beliefs, often unconscious, affect our response to people and situations.

   (Kitty O. Locker and Donna S. Kienzler, *Business and Administrative Communication*, 8/e, 2008)

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting details: _____

3. (a) The world's cultures have strikingly different notions about displays of affection and about matters of personal space. (b) "Don't touch me." (c) "Take your hands off me." (d) Such statements are not uncommon in North America, but they are virtually never heard in Brazil. (e) Brazilians like to be touched more than North Americans do. (f) When North Americans talk, walk, and dance, they maintain a certain distance from others—their personal space. (g) Brazilians, who maintain less physical distance, interpret this as a sign of coldness. (h) When conversing with a North American, the Brazilian moves in as the North American retreats. (i) Cocktail parties in international meeting places such as the United Nations can resemble an elaborate insect mating ritual as diplomats from different cultures advance, withdraw, and sidestep. (j) How people show affection and respect personal space varies greatly from culture to culture.

   (Conrad Phillip Kottak, *Anthropology*, 13/e, 2009)

   Main idea sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

   Supporting details: _____

Paraphrasing

In this section, you will learn how to **paraphrase.** When you paraphrase something, you express the author's meaning in your own words. Often you will substitute synonyms for some words, but you may leave key words the same. The ability to paraphrase is important when you are trying to formulate an implied main idea.

Example: "The man who most vividly realizes a difficulty is the man most likely to overcome it." (Joseph Farrell)

Paraphrase: The man who clearly recognizes a problem is the one likely to solve it.

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3. In what ways are the advice of Tran Thi Nga and that of Aesop the same?

Implied Main Ideas

Not all main ideas are directly stated. Sometimes you have to look closely at the details the author has provided in order to determine the main idea. Read the following paragraph from *The Art of Public Speaking* by Stephen Lucas and try to identify the implied main idea.

1. It had been a long day at the office, and the going-home traffic was bumper to bumper. By the time Jason Whitehawk pulled his late-model car into the driveway at home, he was exhausted. As he trudged into the house, he routinely asked his wife, "How did things go with you at work today?"

"Oh, pretty well," she replied, "except for the attack by space aliens in the morning and the outbreak of bubonic plague in the afternoon."

Jason nodded his head as he made his way toward the sofa. "That's nice," he said. "At least someone had a good day. Mine was awful."

(Stephen E. Lucas, *The Art of Public Speaking*, 7/e, 2001)

The topic of this paragraph is listening. The implied main idea is that sometimes without really listening, people give the appearance of being interested in what someone is saying.

In the next example, the topic could be parenting or child-rearing patterns. In order to formulate the main idea, we must mention the three categories of parents.

"Train a child in a way he should go, and when he is old, he will never depart from it."

— Proverbs 12:4

2. Authoritarian parents are rigid and punitive and value unquestioning obedience from their children. They have strict standards and discourage expressions of disagreement. Permissive parents give their children lax or inconsistent direction and, although warm, require little of them. Authoritative parents are firm, setting limits for their children. As the children get older, these parents try to reason with and explain things to them. They also set clear goals and encourage their children's independence.

(Robert S. Feldman, *Understanding Psychology*, 8/e, 2008)

From the details presented, we can conclude that each parent's child-rearing style is likely to have a different effect. Our implied main idea should be stated something like this:

Main idea: Three different parenting styles—authoritarian, permissive, and authoritative—shape children in different ways.

Determining an implied main idea is simply reducing all of the key information contained in the paragraph to one sentence.

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TRANSITION WORDS & PATTERNS OF ORGANISATION

LAN 100 | READING AND WRITING SKILLS

Transition Words & Paragraph Development

How writers organise and connect ideas

Transition words show relationships between ideas within sentences and paragraphs. They can also help readers identify supporting details and recognise a writer's pattern of organisation.

Exposition

In expository writing, the writer explains or gives information about a subject. To support the main idea, the writer uses different **methods of paragraph development**, also called **patterns of organisation**. Transition words often provide clues to the pattern being used.

Example	**Cause and Effect**	**Steps in a Process**
Comparison	**Contrast**	**Definition**
Classification / Division	**Chronological Order**	**Enumeration / Listing**

How to identify the pattern

- Look for repeated transition words and phrases.
- Ask how the supporting details relate to the main idea.
- Notice whether the writer is giving examples, explaining causes, comparing ideas, defining a term or arranging events.
- A paragraph may combine more than one pattern; identify the main pattern.

Transition words are clues, but meaning is more important than any single word.

LAN 100 | REFERENCE TABLE

Patterns of Organisation

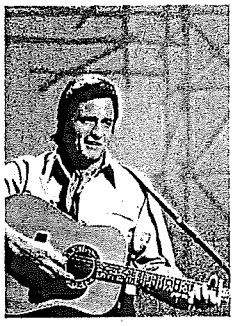
Meaning, common signal words and simple examples

Pattern	What the writer does	Common signal words	Simple example
1. Example	Gives details or illustrations to explain a statement and make a point clearer.	for example, for instance, to illustrate	Examples of healthy snacks
2. Cause and Effect	Explains why something happens and the results that follow.	because, due to, as a result, therefore, a consequence of	Smoking can lead to illness.
3. Steps in a Process	Presents a series of actions carried out in a definite order.	first, second, next, after, finally	Following a recipe
4. Comparison	Shows how two or more things are similar.	similarly, likewise, both, in comparison	Similarities between identical twins
5. Contrast	Shows how two or more things are different.	however, in contrast, but, although, on the other hand	Differences between fraternal twins
6. Definition	Explains the meaning of a word, phrase or concept.	means, is defined as, refers to, is called, originates from	Glossophobia means fear of public speaking.
7. Classification / Division	Separates information into groups or categories according to shared features.	classify, categorise, divide, group, separate, break down	Sorting laundry by colour or item
8. Chronological Order	Arranges events according to the time in which they occurred.	at 7 a.m., first, then, later, during, days, weeks, years	A morning routine
9. Enumeration / Listing	Lists information without a necessary order.	first, second, third; numbers, letters, bullets, asterisks	A supermarket list

Combination: A writer may combine any of these patterns within the same paragraph or text.

CHAPTER 4

Transition Words and Patterns of Organization



CHAPTER PREVIEW

In this chapter, you will

Learn about transition words and phrases.

Learn about patterns of paragraph organization.

Learn about relationships within and between sentences.

Introduction to Transition Words and Patterns of Organization

Writers ordinarily try to write so that their thoughts flow smoothly and logically. They try to connect one idea with another in such a way that readers can easily understand what they are saying. They connect their ideas by means of **transition words.** In Latin, the prefix *trans* means "across." Transition words enable the author to carry you from one place in your reading "across" to another.

In your reading it is important to pay close attention to these transition words. These special words help show the relationships between ideas within sentences and ideas within paragraphs. Good drivers learn to closely watch the road ahead, using signposts or markers to make their trips easier and safer. Good readers learn to use the author's transition words, which signal what is ahead.

Look at the sentences below. The addition of a transition word signaling a contrast makes a big difference in our ability to understand Tom's situation.

1. Tom was very eager to leave for college. The thought of leaving familiar surroundings filled him with dread.
2. Tom was very eager to leave for college. **However,** the thought of leaving familiar surroundings filled him with dread.

The first example doesn't really make a lot of sense. If Tom is so eager to leave, why is he filled with dread? The addition of the transition word makes the situation clear in the second example. Although Tom wants to leave for college, he is understandably reluctant to give up his safe and comfortable surroundings.

Now look at these two sentences:

1. Karla did poorly in her English classes. She decided to switch her major to communication.
2. **Because** Karla did poorly in her English classes, she decided to switch her major to communication.

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The first example makes us guess at the relationship between the two sentences. The addition of the transition word clarifies this relationship.

Following are two more examples. Study the two sentences. Which one is easier to read and understand?

1. Bill did everything he could think of to get a good grade in chemistry. He always attended class, did all of his homework assignments, and studied long hours. He hired a tutor.
2. Bill did everything he could think of to get a good grade in chemistry. He always attended class, did all of his homework assignments, and studied long hours. **In addition,** he hired a tutor.

The transition words *in addition* make the author's meaning easier to understand.

Now look at the next example.

1. Mary did not like to go to the dentist to have her teeth cleaned. She went anyway because she knew that it would be better for her in the long run.
2. **Although** Mary did not like to go to the dentist to have her teeth cleaned, she went anyway because she knew that it would be better for her in the long run.

The transition word *although* helps clarify the relationship between the two thoughts.

Words that can be used to show **classification or division (categories):**

break down	combine	lump
categorize	divide	split
class and subclass	group	type
classify	kind	

Words that can be used to show **cause-and-effect** relationships:

as a consequence	due to	resulting
as a result	for	since
because	for this reason	so
begin	hence	then
bring about	lead to	therefore
consequently	reaction	thus

Words that can be used to show **comparison:**

all	both	like
and	in comparison	likewise
as	just as	similarly

Words that can be used to show **contrast:**

although	in contrast	on the other hand
but	in opposition	rather than
despite	instead	though
even so	nevertheless	unlike
however	on the contrary	yet

continued

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Words that can be used to show **steps in a process:**

after	finally	process
afterward	first, second, third	step
at this point	next	then
at this stage	now	

Words that can be used to show **examples:**

for example	specifically	to illustrate
for instance	such as	
in particular	to demonstrate	

Words that can be used to **define:**

derives from	is described by	refers to
is called	means	term or concept
is defined as	originates from	

Words that can be used to show **chronological order:**

after	first, second, third	next
at last	finally	seasons
before	following	soon
currently	in a year, month, day	then
during	in the meantime	until

Words and symbols that can be used to show **listing (enumeration):**

follow, following	bullets(•)	functions
first, second, third	asterisks(*)	characteristics
colon (:)	numbers (1, 2, 3)	in addition
also	letters (a, b, c)	next, finally

Words that can be used to show **spatial order:**

above	front	on top
below	left	right
beyond	near	underneath
center	next to	

Words that can be used to show **addition:**

again	further	as well as
also	furthermore	besides
and	in addition	too
another	moreover	

The following transition words are often used in presenting an argument.

Words that can be used to show **summary and conclusion:**

finally	in short	therefore
hence	in summary	thus
in brief	overall	to conclude
in conclusion	so	to sum up

continued

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Words that can be used to show **reversal:**

granted that	nevertheless	unlike
instead	still	yet

Words that can be used to show **emphasis:**

as indicated	it's important	to repeat
as noted	once again	truly
certainly	to emphasize	unquestionably
here again	to remember	without a doubt

Words that can be used to show **concession:**

although	even though
despite	in spite of

Note: While lists of transition words are helpful, the groupings of the words given in this section are not perfect, and many of these words may be placed in more than one category. The only way to truly determine the function of a transition word is by studying the context of the sentence and the paragraph.

Directions: In the following sentences, provide an appropriate transition word. If you need help, use the transition words chart. Be sure your completed sentence makes sense.

1. (contrast) _____ he was failing all of his classes, he still had a positive attitude about school.
2. (cause) _____ she worked so many hours at her job, she had no time left for a social life.
3. We can (classification or division) _____ parents into two categories: those who are willing to use physical punishment on their children and those who are not.
4. Aggression is (definition) _____ any physical or verbal behavior that is directly intended to hurt someone.
5. (example) _____ a slap, a punch, and even a direct insult are all considered forms of aggression.
6. Suppose your boss insults you; (steps in a process) _____ you go home and yell at your wife, _____ she yells at your son, _____ he kicks his baby sister, _____ she pulls the dog's tail, and _____ the dog bites the mail carrier.
7. In the winter months of (months of the year in order) _____, _____, and _____, assaults are at an all-time low. In the hotter seasons of _____, _____, and _____, violent crimes are more likely to occur.

Writers organize their supporting sentences and ideas in ways called **patterns of organization.** The most common kinds of patterns of organization are

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f. definition
g. chronological order
h. listing
i. spatial order

_____ 1. The Birth Process
_____ 2. History of Prisons in America
_____ 3. The Prison Experience: Men vs. Women
_____ 4. Space Planning Considerations in Interior Design
_____ 5. Examples of Major Life Changes and Daily Hassles
_____ 6. How Living Things Are Classified
_____ 7. The Causes of the Civil War
_____ 8. What Are the Major Categories of Rock-Forming Minerals?
_____ 9. The Following Are Some Tips on Handling a Stalker
_____ 10. The Definition of Sport
_____ 11. Comparing Cultural Variation within Societies
_____ 12. Types of Crime
_____ 13. Physiological Effects of Caffeine
_____ 14. The History of Plants and Medicine

Directions: Identify the dominant pattern of organization for each paragraph. You may look at the transition words chart if necessary.

1. Quick French Onion Soup (serves 4–6)
In medium fry pan, first saute onion in butter until golden and tender, about 15 minutes. Next, stir in flour. Then add remaining ingredients. Simmer uncovered at least 20 minutes, stirring occasionally. Serve piping hot. For a final touch, if desired, top with melba toast and shredded Gruyere cheese.

_____

Transition Words: _____

2. In ancient Rome, whenever a man wished to be elected to a public office, he canvassed for votes wearing a white robe or toga. The purpose of this was to enable the populace to easily recognize him. The Latin word for white is *candidus*, so the potential official came to be known as a *candidatus*, which means "a person clothed in white." From this derivation comes our English word *candidate*.

_____

Transition Words: _____

3. If you were a child growing up in the 50s and you used the f-word, there would probably have been at least a discussion, and more than likely, a bar of soap would have been put to good use. In contrast, today this word is uttered routinely just about everywhere. Kids hear the word riding the bus to

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school, in class, in the lyrics of many songs, and on regular network TV. In the 50s, profanity was a shocking rarity. But, in the 2000s, profanity has become part of our language. Some psychologists even say using curse words is healthy because it allows us to express our deepest emotions. Young people of today are so used to hearing the f-word that many linguists predict it will end up meaning as little as the standard curse word of the 50s, "hell."

Transition Words: _____

4. One hundred years ago, no one "exercised" because their daily life was strenuous enough. As a direct result of the many labor-saving devices we have today, the typical American's weight is rising. Most Americans don't participate in athletics, and many hire others to do their routine home-maintenance chores. Thus, they get almost no vigorous exercise. The most exercise many get is changing the channel on the remote control. The sad consequence of becoming a sedentary, TV-watching nation is that one in three adults is currently overweight.

Transition Words: _____

5. The Ripley's Museum in Orlando, Florida, is apparently the place to go for those seeking to start a family. In late 1994, two ebony fertility statues were placed in the office lobby. Three employees immediately became pregnant after rubbing the belly of the statue. In another instance, three wives of office personnel all became pregnant despite the fact one was using birth-control pills. In another example, eight women who visited the office became pregnant, including a woman who accidentally bumped into the statue while delivering a package. One Texas woman with five daughters recently came to make the pilgrimage in the hope of having a son. She's convinced the "reproductive magic" will work for her.

Transition Words: _____

6. In a study of workaholics, those people who work too much, Marilyn Machlowitz found that workaholics exhibited the following characteristics:

   1. Tend to be intense and energetic,
   2. Sleep less than most people,
   3. Have difficulty taking vacations,
   4. Spend most of their waking time working,
   5. Frequently eat while they work,
   6. Prefer work to play,
   7. Work hard at making the most of their time,
   8. Tend to blur the distinction between work and play,
   9. Can and do work anywhere and everywhere.

   (Jerrold S. Greenberg, *Comprehensive Stress Management*, 8/e, 2004)

Transition Words: _____

7. Consider the gender differences market researchers observe when studying the food preferences of men and women. Women eat more fruit. On the other hand, men are more likely to eat meat. As one food writer put it, "Boy food

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doesn't grow. It is hunted or killed." Men are more likely to eat Frosted Flakes or Corn Pops, but women prefer multigrain cereals. Men are big root beer drinkers, but women account for the bulk of sales of bottled water.

(Michael R. Solomon, *Consumer Behavior*, 6/e, 2004)

Transition Words: _____

Directions: Choose the correct pattern of organization by noting the transition words.

1. As the "global village" expands and Americans are exposed to an ever-greater variety of cultures and traditions, we find ourselves increasingly joining in the rituals of many ethnic groups and nations. Perhaps the most obvious example is St. Patrick's Day. On every 17th of March, a sea of green engulfs the streets, offices, retail establishments, and bars of all fifty states—and many "wearers o' the green" have not a trace of Irish in their background. Cinco de Mayo ("the fifth of May") is an example of a Mexican-American holiday just now coming into its own. The celebration commemorates Mexico's defeat of the French in the battle of Puebla in 1862. Cinco de Mayo is drawing ever-larger crowds of non-Hispanics who enjoy sharing traditional foods like tamales, roasted corn, and other ethnic specialties, and who love to sway to the beat of mariachi, ranchera, and banda music. Street vendors can't keep up with the demand for spicy Mexican food—and the taps flow freely with Dos Equis, Corona, and other popular Mexican beers.

   (Wayne A. Payne and Dale B. Hahn, *Understanding Your Health*, 6/e, 2000)

   Transition Words: _____

2. If you want to break the caffeine habit, the following steps may help you to achieve your goal. First, gradually switch from regular to decaffeinated coffee by mixing them before brewing, or substitute decaffeinated instant coffee for some of the caffeinated instant you drink. Then, increase the decaffeinated proportion each day while using more low-fat milk in your coffee to reduce the amount of caffeinated beverage you consume. Next, switch little by little to smaller cups from larger mugs and glasses. If your favorite mug is a comfort to you, don't discard it, but fill it with a caffeine-free beverage. Change your daily routine by taking a walk instead of your usual coffee break. At this stage, if you find your coffee paraphernalia to be a temptation, get rid of those mugs, pots, filters, and grinders. If you get enough sleep, exercise regularly, and follow a healthy diet, you'll be less reliant on the artificial "pep" that caffeine provides.

   (Wayne A. Payne and Dale B. Hahn, *Understanding Your Health*, 6/e, 2000)

   Transition Words: _____

3. Many of us experience anger and frustration at one time or another, but for some people these feelings represent a pervasive, characteristic set of personality traits defined as the Type A behavior pattern. Type A individuals are

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described by experts as being competitive, aggressive, and hostile, both verbally and nonverbally—especially when interrupted while trying to complete a task. They exhibit a driven quality regarding their work and show a constant sense of urgency about time.

(Robert S. Feldman, *Understanding Psychology*, 8/e, 2008)

Transition Words: _____

4. On a more general level, the Internet has brought us both positive and negative consequences. On the one hand, it entertains us, informs us, links us with friends and family, provides us with the world's greatest reference library, and stimulates commerce. On the other hand, it opens up whole new areas of concern: identity theft, fraud, deceptive advertising, pornography, and invasion of privacy.

(Joseph R. Dominick, *The Dynamics of Mass Communication*, 8/e, 2005)

Transition Words: _____

5. Because you are always the "author" of your dreams, it is not surprising that you often play a leading role. Thus, you have an active role in nearly three-fourths of your dreams, and you are absent from your own dreams only 10 percent of the time. About half of the other characters in your dreams are friends, acquaintances, or family members. The other half are people you do not know or cannot recognize—or are animals.

(Benjamin B. Lahey, *Psychology*, 8/e, 2004)

Transition Words: _____

6. How many times have you asked yourself questions such as "Am I as smart as Jill?" "Is Bob better-looking than I am?" or "Is my taste as good as Carmen's?" We gain self-knowledge by comparing ourselves with others. We are more likely to compare ourselves with others who are similar to us. We develop more accurate self-perceptions by comparing ourselves with people in communities similar to where we live, with people who have similar family backgrounds, and with people of the same sex or sexual orientation.

(John W. Santrock, *Psychology*, 7/e, 2003)

Transition Words: _____

7. If you're a traditional age student, ask some older students what they ate when they were growing up. You're likely to hear about American favorites that include meatloaf, mashed potatoes and gravy, chicken pot pie, hearty beef stew, and homemade fudge layer cake. Back then big meals served "family style," featuring red meat and lots of side dishes—plus a rich dessert—were considered healthy, as well as essential for growing, active children. Today, in contrast, our food focus is firmly on ethnic dishes, with their novel flavors and textures, their exotic spices, their alluringly foreign names. Unlike the meals of the past, ethnic cuisines feature generous servings of vegetables, with just a bit of fish, meat, or poultry, plus spices for flavor. Dishes are often cooked with heart-healthy olive oil instead of

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REVIEW TEST 5: Main Idea, Details, Purpose, Transitions, and Patterns of Organization

Directions: Each of the following paragraphs related to aggressive behavior was adapted from commonly used psychology textbooks. Read each passage. Then choose the best answer for each item.

A. Psychologists define *aggression* as physical or verbal behavior intended to hurt someone. Throughout the world, hunting, fighting, and warring are primarily men's activities. In surveys, men admit to more aggression than women do. In laboratory experiments, men exhibit more physical aggression by administering what they believe are hurtful shocks. In Canada, the male-to-female arrest rate is 7 to 1 for murder and 6 to 1 for assault. In the United States, it is 9 to 1 for murder and 4 to 1 for assault. Across the world murder rates vary. Yet in all regions, men are roughly 20 times more likely to murder men than women are to murder women. However, in less violent forms of aggression—say, slapping a family member or verbally attacking someone—women are no less aggressive than men.

(David G. Myers, *Social Psychology*, 7/e, 2002)

_____ 1. In the first sentence of this paragraph, the author uses a(n)
   a. cause-and-effect relationship.
   b. definition.
   c. example.
   d. contrast.

_____ 2. The body of the paragraph is organized to
   a. make a contrast.
   b. show steps in a process.
   c. show events in chronological order.
   d. give a definition.

_____ 3. The last sentence of the paragraph is written to
   a. define what was described above it.
   b. show a cause-and-effect relationship.
   c. show steps in a process.
   d. show a contrast with the body of the paragraph.

B. It is a warm evening. Tired and thirsty after two hours of studying, you borrow some change from a friend and head for the nearest soft-drink machine. As the machine devours the change, you can almost taste the cold, refreshing cola. But when you push the button, nothing happens. You push it again. Then you flip the coin return button. Still nothing. Again, you hit the buttons. You slam them. And finally you shake and whack the machine. You stomp back to your studies empty-handed and shortchanged. Should your roommate beware? Are you now more likely to say or do something hurtful?

(David G. Myers, *Social Psychology*, 9/e, 2008)

_____ 4. The author has written this paragraph using which method?
   a. definition
   b. comparison
   c. classification
   d. chronological order

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_____ 5. The example of the student and the vending machine was used to illustrate
a. the difficulties of a student's life.
b. the relationship between frustration and aggression.
c. the problems with vending machines.
d. the wide variety of things that can go wrong in a day.

C. One of the first psychological theories of aggression, the popular frustration–aggression theory, says that a person who has suffered frustration is more likely to do or say something harmful. "Frustration always leads to some form of aggression," said John Dollard and his colleagues. *Frustration* is anything (such as the malfunctioning vending machine) that blocks our attaining a goal. Frustration grows when our motivation to achieve a goal is very strong, when we expected satisfaction, and when the blocking is complete.

(David G. Myers, *Social Psychology*, 9/e, 2008)

_____ 6. The main purpose of this paragraph is to
a. entertain.
b. inform or explain.
c. persuade.
d. criticize.

_____ 7. Which of the following best describes the organizational pattern of this paragraph?
a. definition and explanation
b. examples and classification
c. comparison and contrast
d. classification and division

D. Our aggressive energy need not explode directly against its source. We learn to inhibit direct retaliation, especially when others might disapprove of us or punish us; instead we displace our hostilities to safer targets. Displacement occurs in the old anecdote about a man who, because he is humiliated by his boss, berates his wife, who yells at their son, who kicks the dog, which bites the mail carrier.

(David G. Myers, *Social Psychology*, 9/e, 2008)

_____ 8. The author in the last sentence of this paragraph uses which of the following?
a. comparison
b. classification
c. cause and effect
d. definition

E. What kinds of stimuli act as aggressive cues? They can range from the most obvious, such as the presence of weapons, to the subtlest, such as the mere mention of the name of an individual who has behaved violently in the past. For example, in one experiment, angered subjects were more aggressive when in the presence of a rifle and a revolver than in a similar situation in which no guns were present. It appears, then, that frustration does lead to aggression, at least when aggressive cues are present.

(Robert S. Feldman, *Understanding Psychology*, 8/e, 2008)

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_____ 9. Which of the following does the author *not* use in this paragraph?
a. an example
b. a contrast
c. a definition
d. a cause-and-effect statement

_____ 10. The main idea expressed in this passage is that
a. frustration can more easily lead to aggression when aggressive cues are present.
b. aggressive cues can be subtle or obvious.
c. people behave more aggressively when in the presence of weapons.
d. psychologists don't know what kind of stimuli act as aggressive cues.

Chapter Summary and Review

In this chapter, you learned about the patterns of organization that authors use. You also learned to recognize transition words and phrases. Based on the material in Chapter 4, answer the following.

Short Answer

Directions: List three or four transition words that signal the following patterns of paragraph organization.

1. Comparison _____
2. Cause and effect _____
3. Chronological order _____
4. Classification _____

Vocabulary in Context

Directions: Choose one of the following words to complete the sentences below. Use each word only once.

chronological conclusion contrast definitions examples

5. When you write a paper for class, you may want to give specific _____ that illustrate your point.
6. On a history test, you might be asked to place the major events leading up to World War II in _____ order.
7. A speaker at a graduation ceremony usually ends the speech with a(n) _____.
8. When minor league baseball players make it to the Major Leagues for the first time, they are sometimes surprised at the huge _____ between how the game is played in the major and minor leagues.
9. Sometimes authors of textbooks will give _____ for unusual words that they use.

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Providing Transitions

ACTIVITY 10

In the spaces provided, add appropriate transitions to tie together the sentences and ideas in the following essay. Draw from the words given in the boxes above the paragraphs. Use each word only once.

Annoying People

President Richard Nixon used to keep an enemies list of all the people he didn't especially like. I'm ashamed to confess it, but I, too, have an enemies list—a mental one. On this list are all the people I would gladly live without, the ones who cause my blood pressure to rise to the boiling point. The top three places on the list go to people with annoying nervous habits, people who talk in movie theaters, and people who talk on cell phones while driving.

For example	First of all	Another	However

_____, there are the people with annoying nervous habits. _____, there are the ones who make faces. When in deep thought, they twitch, squint, and frown, and they can be a real distraction when I'm trying to concentrate during an exam. _____ type of nervous character makes useless designs. These people bend paper clips into abstract sculptures or string the clips into necklaces as they talk. _____, neither of these groups is as bad as the people who make noises. These individuals, when they are feeling uncomfortable, bite their fingernails or crack their knuckles. If they have a pencil in their hands, they tap it rhythmically against whatever surface is handy—a desk, a book, a head. Lacking a pencil to play with, they jingle the loose change or keys in their pockets. These people make me wish I were hard of hearing.

On the contrary	Then	As a result	After	Second

A _____ category of people I would gladly do away with is the ones who talk in movie theaters. These people are not content to sit back, relax, and enjoy the film they have paid to see. _____, they feel

continued

compelled to comment loudly on everything from the hero's hairstyle to the appropriateness of the background music. _____, no one hears a word of any dialogue except theirs. _____ these people have been in the theater for a while, their interest in the movie may fade. _____ they will start discussing other things, and the people around them will be treated to an instant replay of the latest family scandal or soap-opera episode. These stories may be entertaining, but they don't belong in a movie theater.

In addition	But	Last of all

_____, there are the people who talk on the phone while they're driving. One of the things that irritates me about them is the way they seem to be showing off. They're saying, "Look at me! I'm so important I have to make phone calls in my car." _____, such behavior is just plain dangerous. Instead of concentrating on adjusting carefully to ever-changing traffic conditions, they're weaving all over the road or getting much too close to the car in front of them as they gossip with a friend, make an appointment with a doctor, or order a pizza.

So long as murder remains illegal, the nervous twitchers, movie talkers, and cell-phone users of the world are safe from me. _____ if ever I am granted the power of life or death, these people had better think twice about annoying me. They might not have long to live.

Identifying Transitions and Other Connecting Words

ACTIVITY 11

The following sentences use connecting words to help tie ideas together. The connecting words you are to identify are set off in italics. In the space, write T for *transition,* RW for *repeated word,* S for *synonym,* or P for *pronoun.*

_____ 1. The Statue of Liberty stands watch in New York Harbor. In *her* right hand she holds the torch of freedom.

_____ 2. Plants like poinsettias and mistletoe are pretty. *They* are also poisonous.

_____ 3. A strip of strong cloth can be used as an emergency fan-belt replacement. *In addition,* a roll of duct tape can be used to patch a leaky hose temporarily.

Gap Fill Exercise: The Importance of Using AI Wisely at University

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate linking words from the box. Each word can only be used once.

Linking Words:

finally, because, however, therefore, in addition, as a result, for example, moreover, on the other hand, while

---

Text:

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become an essential tool for students in modern universities. (1) _____, it can help with tasks like research, organizing schedules, and even generating ideas for assignments. (2) _____, it is important to use AI responsibly to avoid over-reliance on technology.

AI tools can provide valuable support (3) _____ they save time and simplify complex tasks. (4) _____, they can help students access a wealth of information quickly and efficiently. (5) _____, there are risks associated with improper use of AI. (6) _____ AI can assist in generating content, students must ensure they are not plagiarizing or neglecting critical thinking.

(7) _____, relying too heavily on AI might limit a student's ability to develop their own ideas. (8) _____, universities emphasize the importance of balancing AI usage with independent learning. (9) _____, tools like plagiarism checkers and citation generators can help students maintain academic integrity. (10) _____, using AI wisely ensures that students benefit from technology while still developing their personal skills.

HANDOUT

1. In one paragraph, explain to a friend, 3 differences and 3 similarities between being a high school student and a university student.

2. You were going to visit a friend in Athens during the Easter break but you have just been fired from your part-time job and will therefore not have enough money to make the trip. Write a one paragraph e-mail to your friend explaining the reason why you can't go.

3. Your best friend who is studying in England wants to impress his/her girlfriend/boyfriend by making him/her your famous omelet. Write an e-mail explaining your recipe to him/her step-by-step.

4. You are on holidays in Italy but you have run out of money. Write your parents a one paragraph email which will convince them of all the reasons you need them to send you more money.

5. A French friend of yours who is starting to learn English calls you and asks you the meaning of the following words. You are not at home and therefore cannot look them up in a dictionary but will do your best to explain them over the phone. Write down what you would say for each of the following words: 'claustrophobia,' 'bulimia,' 'agoraphobia,' 'arachnophobia.'

6. You suddenly experience terrible stomach pains and frequent vomiting so you rush to the doctor. He tells you to very carefully describe exactly what you have eaten since getting up this morning. He wants you to state what you ate and when you ate it. Write down what you would say in about a paragraph.

7. Your mother calls you and tells you that she will be home in 15minutes to drop off your sister before going to the supermarket. She needs to you to go through the kitchen cupboards and the fridge and prepare a shopping list of all the things that have run out. Prepare a shopping list to give her when she gets home.

8. Your family has decided to donate some things to charity. Your mother asked that everyone in the family find at least 5 things (clothes, books, toys etc) that they are willing to give. Your job is to collect these items and separate them into different boxes. What type of labels would you put on each box so as to help the people at the charity decide who to give them to?

MODES OF DISCOURSE/ RHETORICAL MODES

LAN 100 | READING AND WRITING SKILLS

Modes of Discourse

Four basic kinds of writing

A mode of discourse is the main way a writer presents and develops ideas.

1. Narration

Narration tells a story or shares an experience.

- may be true or imaginary
- usually follows chronological order
- includes characters and a setting
- may contain dialogue
- often uses informal speech, expressions and contractions

Usual purpose: to entertain

2. Description

Description creates a verbal picture of a person, place, object, idea or feeling.

- emphasises vivid details
- appeals to the senses
- uses rich vocabulary and adjectives
- may use imagery, similes and metaphors
- helps the reader imagine the subject clearly

Usual purpose: to entertain or inform

3. Exposition

Exposition explains or gives information about a subject.

- informative and factual
- uses examples, definitions, comparisons and statistics
- has an objective or neutral tone
- does not clearly show the author's personal position
- usually uses formal language

Usual purpose: to inform

4. Persuasion

Persuasion argues a position and tries to influence the reader.

- presents a clear point of view
- uses logical or emotional arguments
- may include facts, research and expert opinion
- uses subjective language
- often includes words such as *should*, *must* and *need to*

Usual purpose: to persuade

Combination of Modes

Combination	Primary Mode
Narration + Description	Narration
Exposition + Persuasion	Persuasion
Narration + Persuasion	Persuasion

When a text contains persuasion, persuasion is usually the primary mode because the writer's main aim is to influence the reader.

LAN 100 | SAME TOPIC, DIFFERENT MODE

Writing About Hawaii

How the mode changes the way a topic is presented

Narration - tells a story

While on our honeymoon on the island of Oahu, my husband and I became lost in a densely wooded area. We had been searching for a breathtaking waterfall that local people had recommended, but we must have taken a wrong turn. After hours of walking, we were exhausted, hungry and thirsty. Luckily, we finally came across a small isolated house and knocked on the door.

Description - paints a picture

The waterfall was breathtaking. Water cascaded down the mountain like the long hair of a mermaid. The heavy sound of the falling water filled the air, and white foam swirled into the crystal-clear blue-green water below.

Exposition - explains or informs

Hawaii is an island state in the Pacific Ocean, approximately 2,000 miles from the U.S. mainland. It is the only U.S. state outside North America, the only state made up entirely of islands and the only state located in the tropics. Hawaii consists of numerous volcanic islands that form the Hawaiian archipelago.

Persuasion - argues or convinces

You should choose Hawaii for your next holiday.

- breathtaking scenery and beautiful beaches
- opportunities to experience Hawaiian culture
- activities such as surfing, parasailing and paragliding
- excellent food and memorable experiences

To identify the mode, ask: Is the writer telling a story, creating a picture, explaining information or trying to convince me?

Salvation - by Langston Hughes

I was saved from sin when I was going on thirteen. But not ready saved. It happened like this. There was a big revival at my Auntie Reed's church. Every night for weeks there had been so much preaching, singing, praying and shouting, and some very hardened sinners had been brought to Christ and the membership of the Church had grown by leaps and bounds. Then, just before the revival ended, they held a special meeting for children, "to bring the young lambs to the fold." My aunt spoke of it for days ahead. That night I was escorted to the front row and placed on the moumer's bench with all the other young sinners, who had not yet been brought to Jesus.

1. This is the first paragraph of a longer text. What do you think the rest of the text would be about? What clues allow you to make this assumption?
2. What do you feel could be the aim of the T speaker?
3. Are events presented in chronological order?
4. Underline any transition words within the passage.

A Wom Path - by Eudora Welty

She wore a dark striped dress reaching down to her shoetops, and an equally long apron of bleached sugar sacks, with a full pocket all neat and tidy, but every time she took a step she might have fallen over her shoelaces, which dragged from her unlaced shoes. She looked straight ahead. Her eyes were blue with age. Her skin had a pattern all of its own of numberless branching wrinkles and as a though a whole little tree stood in the middle of her forehead. Under the red rag her hair came down on her neck in the frailest of ringlets, still black, and with an odor like copper.

1. How does this passage differ to the one above?
2. What does the writer give emphasis to?
3. is there an appeal to any of your senses as a reader?

Cystic Fibrosis - by Frank Deford

Cystic Fibrosis is, notwithstanding its name, a disease primarily of the lungs. It has nothing to do with cysts. It was not identified as a distinct clinical entity until the mid-thirties, and not until some years later was the full pathology comprehended. Inexplicably, the disease attacks not only the lungs but other disparate parts of the body such as the pancreas; the major digestive organ.

1. What do you think the author wants to do in this passage?
2. What type of things would you expect to find later on in the passage?
3. Where do you think you might find such a text?

What is Poverty?-Jo Goodwin Parker

I have come out of my despair to tell you this. Remember I did not come from another place or another time. Others like me are all around you. Look at us with an angry heart, anger that will help you help me. Anger that will let you tell of me. The poor are always silent. Can you be silent too?

1. Are you as the reader being asked to notice something?
2. Are you being asked to take some form of action?

Working with longer texts:

1. Night terrors are a less common, but perhaps even more upsetting nocturnal experience than nightmares. The individual awakens suddenly in a state of panic, sometimes screaming, and usually with no clear recollection of an accompanying dream. A sense of calm usually returns within a few minutes, but these are terrifying experiences. Unlike nightmares, they do not occur during REM sleep but occur during the deepest phases of non-REM sleep. Night terrors are most common in preschool-age children, but sometimes adults experience them.

---

2. The film *Hard Target* is not worth seeing and should be avoided at all costs. It isn't even worth reviewing in my view. All the action scenes are copies of scenes used in other films. In between these lackluster (dull) eruptions of shoddily choreographed mayhem, there is nothing-nothing at all. The director has no story to tell plus there are many mistakes made in the choreography of certain fight scenes. Better to give this film a miss!

---

3. Larry suddenly woke up from a deep sleep. The sun was dazzling hid half-open eyes, and he couldn't figure out what time it was. The door to his room was closed; the house was in silence. He slowly got out of his bed and approached the bench right next to the window. For a moment, he thought he heard a tapping sound coming from the attic. Then again, he heard the sound, only this time it seems to be somewhere closer. He looked outside the window and saw a man going by the left side of the road. On seeing Larry, the man approached his garden's fence and whistled. At this point, Larry recognized Nick and waved his hand. He quickly got dressed and was about to go down and open the gate, but again he heard someone murmuring in the other part of the house. Larry decided to go up to the attic to see if the sound was coming from there.....

---

4. On one corner of my dresser sits a smiling toy clown on a tiny unicycle—a gift I received last Christmas from a close friend. The clown's short yellow hair, made of yarn, covers its ears but is parted above the eyes. The blue eyes are outlined in black with thin, dark lashes flowing from the brows. It has cherry-red cheeks, nose, and lips, and its broad grin disappears into the wide, white ruffle around its neck. The clown wears a fluffy, two-tone nylon costume. The left side of the outfit is light blue, and the right side is red. The two colors merge in a dark line that runs down the center of the small outfit. Surrounding its ankles and disguising its long black shoes are big pink bows. The white spokes on the wheels of the unicycle gather in the center and expand to the black tire so that the wheel somewhat resembles the inner half of a grapefruit. The clown and unicycle together stand about a foot high.

Label the following according to the mode of writing/mode of discourse used: narration, description, exposition, persuasion

1. Her heart was a waterfall of overflowing emotion as she picked up her newborn baby for the first time. His eyelashes were long and dark and they curled slightly at the ends. A tear escaped from the corner of her eye and slid slowly down her rosy cheeks.

_____

2. Parents should never ever allow their children to ride in cars without a seatbelt on.

_____

3. One in four students suffers from stress. Stress is often caused by having too much to do in a short space of time. Dr. John Smith reports that the rate of stress related heart problems is increasing.

_____

4. It happened so long ago that it's difficult to remember. I'm sure it was during the winter of 1988 when we went to Italy together on holiday. It all started when Tim decided to visit Venice. He convinced Ann to go with him so the two of them could see the sights together. On their second day in Venice Ann started to suffer from severe headaches.
.....

_____

LAN 100 General Advanced English
Instructor: Helen Stavrou

Group Activity: Narration

Student names:_____

A lifesaving act of kindness

As a young boy growing up in a poor neighborhood in Thailand, I remember a series of events which changed my life forever. Since then, those events have had a major impact on how I live my daily life.

It all began when I was 9. At that time, my mother became ill and was in constant need of medical supplies which we simply couldn't afford. _____

30 years later_____

As soon as I realized who the patient was I _____

Every day, I make sure that I remember that act of kindness

LISTENING SKILLS

LAN 100 Listening Skills Guide

Understanding Global and Selective Listening (CEFR B2)

In LAN 100 you will complete two different kinds of listening tasks.

Global Comprehension	Selective Comprehension
Understand the overall message.	Find specific information.
Listen for the big picture.	Listen for key details.
Main idea, purpose, audience.	Names, numbers, examples, facts.
Don't panic if you miss a word.	Pay attention to precise information.

Typical Global Questions

- Who is the speaker talking to?
- What is the main purpose?
- What is the overall message?
- Which title is best?
- Which summary is best?

Typical Selective Questions

- What example is given?
- Which strategy is recommended?
- What fact is mentioned?
- What happens first?
- Which statement is correct?

Top Tips

✓ Read questions first.
✓ Underline key words.
✓ Predict the information you need.
✓ Keep listening if you miss an answer.
✓ Remember: each recording is played twice.

Remember: Global = the whole picture. Selective = the important details.

Core idea: Global listening asks, "What is this recording mainly doing?" Selective listening asks, "What exact information did I hear?"

Global Listening

Listen for the overall meaning of the recording.

- Who is the intended audience?
- What is the speaker's main purpose?
- What is the central message?
- What is the speaker's attitude or tone?
- What type of recording is this?
- How is the talk organised?
- Which summary or title fits best?

Strategy: Do not chase every word. Follow the big picture and the relationship between ideas.

Selective Listening

Listen for particular details that answer a focused question.

- Facts and examples
- Numbers and statistics
- Reasons and causes
- Effects and consequences
- Comparisons
- Recommendations
- Definitions and supporting evidence

Strategy: Predict the type of answer you need before listening: a number, reason, example, place or result.

Preview the questions **Predict the answer type**

Listen for signposts **Confirm after the second play**

Quick Comparison

Global Example

Question: What is the speaker mainly trying to do?

You listen for: the overall purpose across the whole recording.

Selective Example

Question: According to the speaker, what percentage increased?

You listen for: one precise factual detail.

Sort the Question Type

Can You Now...?

- ☐ distinguish global from selective questions;
- ☐ identify audience, purpose and main message;
- ☐ listen for numbers, examples and reasons;
- ☐ predict the kind of answer required;
- ☐ avoid focusing on every word;
- ☐ use the second play to confirm answers.

UNIVERSITY OF CYPRUS • LANGUAGE CENTRE

LAN 100

Mock Listening Test — Global Comprehension

Introduction to Academic English
CEFR B2 • Practice Listening Assessment

Student A4 Print Edition v1.0

Candidate Information

Semester: _____

Date: _____

Student Name: _____

Student ID: _____

Section: _____

Instructor: _____

Assessment Information

Recording	BEAT Boredom With These SIMPLE Hacks
Listening focus	Global Comprehension
Level	CEFR B2
Questions	10 multiple-choice items
Playback	The recording will be played twice.
Response format	Choose one answer: A, B, C or D.

Instructions

1. Read Questions 1–10 before the recording begins.
2. Choose **ONE** answer for each question.
3. Mark your answers while listening.
4. Check your answers during the second playback.
5. Answer every question.

MOCK AUDIO 1 • GLOBAL COMPREHENSION

Questions 1–5

Recording: BEAT Boredom With These SIMPLE Hacks

Level: CEFR B2

Playback: Twice

Response: Choose ONE answer

1 **Who is the recording mainly intended for?**

- ○ **A** Researchers studying the history of creativity.
- ○ **B** People who quickly turn to digital entertainment whenever they feel bored.
- ○ **C** Employers trying to increase staff working hours.
- ○ **D** Parents looking for educational television programmes.

2 **What is the main purpose of the recording?**

- ○ **A** To explain why creative people should work continuously.
- ○ **B** To compare several scientific theories about attention.
- ○ **C** To persuade people to remove technology permanently from their lives.
- ○ **D** To show how accepting and using boredom can improve creativity, focus and discipline.

3 **What central idea does the speaker introduce about boredom?**

- ○ **A** It can act as a mental reset that allows new ideas to develop.
- ○ **B** It is mainly a sign that a task has no value.
- ○ **C** It should be replaced with more demanding work.
- ○ **D** It affects creative people less than other people.

4 **Why does the speaker mention Newton and Einstein?**

- ○ **A** To show that scientific work requires expensive equipment.
- ○ **B** To argue that famous thinkers avoided ordinary daily activities.
- ○ **C** To illustrate that important ideas can emerge during quiet thought and daydreaming.
- ○ **D** To prove that people were more intelligent before smartphones existed.

5 **What is the main idea behind the "intentional boredom" method?**

- ○ **A** Complete an unpleasant task as quickly as possible.
- ○ **B** Allow a short period of emptiness so the mind begins producing ideas and solutions.
- ○ **C** Replace digital entertainment with a difficult mental exercise.
- ○ **D** Plan every free moment before boredom begins.

MOCK AUDIO 1 • GLOBAL COMPREHENSION

Questions 6–10

Recording: BEAT Boredom With These SIMPLE Hacks

Level: CEFR B2

Playback: Twice

Response: Choose ONE answer

6 **How does the speaker present "active boredom"?**

- ○ **A** As doing simple, low-pressure activities that leave room for ideas to appear.
- ○ **B** As exercising intensely whenever concentration decreases.
- ○ **C** As completing several useful tasks at the same time.
- ○ **D** As learning a new skill during every break.

7 **Why does the speaker recommend doing nothing before beginning a task?**

- ○ **A** To decide whether the task is really necessary.
- ○ **B** To recover physically from previous work.
- ○ **C** To make the task feel shorter than it actually is.
- ○ **D** To reduce the desire for quick rewards and make focused work more appealing.

8 **What broader point is made through the idea of "microresistance"?**

- ○ **A** Self-discipline depends mainly on completing major challenges.
- ○ **B** People should avoid all enjoyable activities until work is complete.
- ○ **C** Resisting small temptations can gradually strengthen willpower for more difficult situations.
- ○ **D** Digital habits can only be changed through strict long-term plans.

9 **What final practical challenge does the speaker give the listener?**

- ○ **A** Spend thirty minutes doing an analogue activity instead of turning to a screen.
- ○ **B** Practise sitting completely still for an hour every day.
- ○ **C** Replace all entertainment with creative work for one week.
- ○ **D** Write down every moment of boredom for a month.

10 **Which statement best summarises the speaker's overall message?**

- ○ **A** Boredom is useful only when people have an important decision to make.
- ○ **B** Accepting boredom instead of immediately escaping it can develop creativity, concentration and self-control.
- ○ **C** The best way to become productive is to remove all periods of inactivity.
- ○ **D** Creative thinking depends mainly on avoiding routine tasks.

Student Answer Sheet

Student Name: _____

Student ID: _____

Section: _____

Instructor: _____

Question	A	B	C	D
1	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	☐	☐	☐	☐

Final check: Make sure you have selected one answer for every question.

UNIVERSITY OF CYPRUS • LANGUAGE CENTRE

LAN 100

Mock Listening Test

Audio 2 — Selective Comprehension
CEFR B2 • Practice Assessment

Student Test Booklet • Compact A4 Print Edition

Candidate Information

Semester: _____

Date: _____

Student Name: _____

Student ID: _____

Section: _____

Instructor: _____

Assessment Information

Recording	Four Mind Exercises for Positive Thinking
Listening focus	Selective Comprehension
Questions	10 multiple-choice items
Playback	The recording will be played twice.
Response format	Choose one answer (A, B, C or D).

Instructions

1. Read all questions before the recording begins.
2. Choose **ONE** answer for each question.
3. Listen for specific information, examples and research findings.
4. Mark answers in the booklet while listening.
5. Transfer final answers to the answer sheet.
6. Answer every question.

MOCK AUDIO 2 • SELECTIVE COMPREHENSION

Questions 1–5

Recording: Four Mind Exercises for Positive Thinking

Listening focus: Selective Comprehension

Playback: Twice

Response: Choose ONE answer

1 **According to the speaker, what should a person write in a gratitude journal?**

- ◯ **A** Three things they are thankful for.
- ◯ **B** A detailed record of every daily problem.
- ◯ **C** A list of goals for the following month.
- ◯ **D** One positive quotation from a famous person.

2 **What did Dr Robert A. Emmons' studies find about people who kept gratitude journals?**

- ◯ **A** They became more successful at work but less physically active.
- ◯ **B** They experienced less stress only when they wrote every morning.
- ◯ **C** They became more sociable but reported no health changes.
- ◯ **D** They reported greater life satisfaction, fewer symptoms of depression and better physical health.

3 **Which small experiences did one study participant begin to appreciate?**

- ◯ **A** A warm cup of coffee and a beautiful sunset.
- ◯ **B** Completing difficult work and receiving praise.
- ◯ **C** Spending money and travelling abroad.
- ◯ **D** Exercising and meeting new people.

4 **How does the speaker describe positive affirmations?**

- ◯ **A** Scientific reports that explain personality.
- ◯ **B** Questions used to identify negative habits.
- ◯ **C** Personalised mantras that can change a person's mindset.
- ◯ **D** Written plans for solving practical problems.

5 **Which affirmation does the speaker give as an example before a difficult task?**

- ◯ **A** I always achieve everything immediately.
- ◯ **B** I am capable and confident.
- ◯ **C** I never make mistakes under pressure.
- ◯ **D** I am more talented than other people.

MOCK AUDIO 2 • SELECTIVE COMPREHENSION

Questions 6–10

Recording: Four Mind Exercises for Positive Thinking

Listening focus: Selective Comprehension

Playback: Twice

Response: Choose ONE answer

6 **According to research from the University of Oxford, mindfulness meditation may...**

- ◯ **A** improve memory without affecting emotions.
- ◯ **B** remove all negative thoughts permanently.
- ◯ **C** work only when practised in a group.
- ◯ **D** increase wellbeing and reduce symptoms of anxiety and depression.

7 **What did participants who practised mindfulness meditation daily report?**

- ◯ **A** They needed less sleep and worked for longer hours.
- ◯ **B** They became more interested in scientific research.
- ◯ **C** They felt more present, enjoyed positive moments and coped better with stress.
- ◯ **D** They avoided difficult situations more successfully.

8 **Which action is suggested for creating a more positive environment at home?**

- ◯ **A** Filling the space with uplifting art, inspirational quotations or soothing colours.
- ◯ **B** Removing all decorations and keeping rooms completely plain.
- ◯ **C** Listening only to educational programmes throughout the day.
- ◯ **D** Avoiding contact with friends while practising the exercises.

9 **What is the speaker's call to action near the end of the recording?**

- ◯ **A** Research every exercise before attempting any of them.
- ◯ **B** Wait until negative thoughts disappear before beginning.
- ◯ **C** Practise all four exercises only once each week.
- ◯ **D** Choose one exercise or try them all, and practise consistently.

10 **What does the speaker clarify in the final part of the recording?**

- ◯ **A** Positive thinking means ignoring every unpleasant experience.
- ◯ **B** The aim is a healthier balance in thinking, not constant unrealistic cheerfulness.
- ◯ **C** Only naturally optimistic people can benefit from the exercises.
- ◯ **D** Mental wellbeing depends mainly on the people around us.

Student Answer Sheet

Student Name: _____

Student ID: _____

Section: _____

Instructor: _____

Q	A	B	C	D
1	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	☐	☐	☐	☐

Final check: Make sure one answer is marked for every question.

ACADEMIC WRITING

Writing Like a University Student

Good academic writing is a process. Strong writers do not expect a perfect first draft. They develop, organise and improve their ideas step by step.

The writing journey

1. **Understand the task**
   Identify the topic, purpose, audience, length and required format.
2. **Generate ideas**
   Brainstorm relevant points, examples and evidence.
3. **Plan and organise**
   Group related ideas and decide the clearest order.
4. **Write the first draft**
   Focus on communicating your ideas clearly.
5. **Revise**
   Improve content, organisation and clarity.
6. **Edit and proofread**
   Check grammar, vocabulary, spelling, punctuation and formatting.

> **Key idea:** Writing becomes easier when you separate the stages. Plan first, draft next, revise ideas, and edit language last.

BEFORE YOU WRITE

Understand and Plan

Understand the task

- ☐ What am I writing?
- ☐ What is my purpose?
- ☐ Who will read it?
- ☐ How long should it be?
- ☐ What must I include?
- ☐ Which style or register should I use?

Plan the response

- ☐ Generate several possible ideas.
- ☐ Select the strongest and most relevant ideas.
- ☐ Group similar ideas together.
- ☐ Decide the order of the paragraphs.
- ☐ Prepare a short outline.

Example: Brainstorming

Question: Should university students use artificial intelligence tools for learning?

Using AI for Learning

Possible benefits
- explains difficult ideas
- saves time
- offers extra practice

Possible risks
- incorrect information
- overdependence
- academic integrity concerns

Common mistake: Starting to write immediately.
Better: Spend five minutes planning. A clear plan usually saves time later.

A simple outline

Introduction: Introduce the issue and give the main position.

Body paragraph 1: Present one main idea with explanation and example.

Body paragraph 2: Present another main idea with explanation and example.

Conclusion: Summarise the main point and finish clearly.

WRITING THE FIRST DRAFT

Write Clearly, Then Improve

Use your outline as a guide. Write one paragraph at a time and concentrate first on meaning and organisation.

Focus on first

- ☐ clear ideas
- ☐ logical order
- ☐ one main idea per paragraph
- ☐ relevant explanation and examples
- ☐ connections between ideas

Improve later

- ☐ grammar
- ☐ word choice
- ☐ spelling
- ☐ punctuation
- ☐ formatting

A useful paragraph pattern

Topic sentence
State the main idea of the paragraph.

Explanation
Develop the idea and explain why it is important.

Example or evidence
Support the idea with a relevant example, fact or reason.

Closing or linking sentence
Complete the point or connect it to the next idea.

Remember: A first draft is not a final product. Its purpose is to place your ideas on the page so that you can improve them.

Common mistake: Stopping every sentence to correct small language errors.
Better: Complete the draft first. Edit after your ideas and organisation are clear.

IMPROVING YOUR WORK

Revise Before You Edit

Revising and editing are different. Revision improves the **content and organisation**. Editing improves the **language and accuracy**.

Revising	Editing
• answer the question fully • improve the main ideas • reorganise paragraphs • remove irrelevant information • add explanation or examples • improve clarity and flow	• correct grammar • check word choice • correct spelling • correct punctuation • check sentence structure • check formatting

Revision questions

- ☐ Have I answered the exact question?
- ☐ Does every paragraph have one clear main idea?
- ☐ Does every sentence support the paragraph?
- ☐ Are my ideas in a logical order?
- ☐ Have I explained and supported my ideas?
- ☐ Have I used transitions to connect ideas?

Editing questions

- ☐ Are my sentences complete and clear?
- ☐ Are verb forms and tenses accurate?
- ☐ Have I used appropriate academic vocabulary?
- ☐ Are spelling and punctuation correct?
- ☐ Have I checked names, numbers and formatting?

> **Helpful strategy:** Read your work aloud slowly. You will often hear missing words, repeated ideas and unclear sentences.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Academic Writer's Checklist

Task

- ☐ I answered the question.
- ☐ I followed the instructions.
- ☐ I stayed focused on the topic.
- ☐ I included the required information.

Organisation

- ☐ My introduction is clear.
- ☐ Each paragraph has one main idea.
- ☐ My ideas follow a logical order.
- ☐ My conclusion finishes effectively.

Support and cohesion

- ☐ I explained my main ideas.
- ☐ I included relevant examples.
- ☐ I used transitions appropriately.
- ☐ I removed unrelated information.

Language and presentation

- ☐ My language is clear and appropriate.
- ☐ I checked grammar and vocabulary.
- ☐ I corrected spelling and punctuation.
- ☐ I checked formatting and presentation.

Habits of successful academic writers

- They plan before writing.
- They write one paragraph at a time.
- They revise ideas before editing language.
- They proofread carefully.
- They use feedback to improve.
- They understand that good writing develops through practice.

> **Final question: If I were the reader, would I understand my ideas clearly?**

Annotated Five-Paragraph Essay

A visual model showing how each part of an academic essay works.

Annotation key

- Hook
- Thesis statement
- Topic sentence
- Explanation / example
- Closing sentence
- Conclusion move

Should University Students Use Artificial Intelligence for Learning?

HOOK Artificial intelligence is becoming an increasingly visible part of university life. BACKGROUND Many students now use AI tools to explain difficult concepts, organise ideas and revise for exams. THESIS Although AI can be a valuable learning tool, students should use it responsibly while continuing to develop their own academic skills.

TOPIC SENTENCE One important advantage of AI is that it can improve students' understanding. EXPLANATION Students can ask questions and receive simple explanations whenever they need help. EXAMPLE For example, a biology student can ask AI to explain a complex process before attending a lecture. CLOSING Used carefully, AI can therefore support learning and increase confidence.

TOPIC SENTENCE AI can also help students study more efficiently. EXPLANATION It can generate practice questions, suggest ways to organise notes and provide quick feedback on basic language problems. EXAMPLE For instance, a student preparing for a history test could use AI to create a short quiz based on their own lecture notes. CLOSING These uses can save time and make independent revision more focused.

TOPIC SENTENCE However, students should not depend completely on AI. EXPLANATION If learners simply copy answers, they may stop developing critical thinking and problem-solving skills. EXAMPLE For example, submitting AI-generated work without understanding it can lead to poor learning and academic misconduct. CLOSING Students should therefore use AI as a learning assistant rather than a replacement for their own thinking.

RESTATE THESIS AI offers many benefits when it is used responsibly. SUMMARY It can improve understanding and make revision more efficient, but students must continue thinking independently. FINAL THOUGHT Students who combine technology with genuine effort are more likely to become confident and successful university learners.

Why this essay works

- Clear position
- Three body paragraphs
- One main idea per paragraph
- Relevant examples
- Logical progression
- Effective conclusion

Structure at a glance

Introduction → Body 1 → Body 2 → Body 3 → Conclusion

Version A - Student Edition

Introductions & Conclusions

How essays begin clearly and end effectively

An introduction prepares the reader for the essay. **A conclusion** brings the essay to a clear and effective end.

Purpose of an Introductory Paragraph

1. Attract the reader's attention.	**2.** Supply necessary background information.
3. Present a clear thesis statement.	**4.** Indicate the essay's direction or plan of development.

Introduction Technique	What the writer does	Short example
1. General to Narrow	Begins broadly and gradually moves towards the thesis.	Technology affects almost every area of modern life. At university, it has transformed how students study, communicate and submit work.
2. Opposite View	Begins with an idea opposite to the position that will be developed.	Many people believe online learning is less effective than classroom learning. However, it can offer valuable flexibility and access.
3. Importance	Explains why the topic matters to the reader.	Time management is essential because it affects students' grades, stress levels and personal wellbeing.
4. Anecdote	Uses a brief incident or story to gain the reader's interest.	On my first day at university, I arrived late, entered the wrong room and sat through half of a chemistry lecture.
5. Quotation	Begins with a relevant quotation.	"Education is the passport to the future." This idea remains relevant in a rapidly changing world.

Purpose of a Concluding Paragraph

Remind the reader of the thesis or central message.	**Bring the essay to an end** and leave a final impression.

Conclusion Technique	What the writer does	Short example
1. Summary + Final Thought	Restates the main points and ends with a final comment.	In conclusion, exercise improves physical and mental health. Making time for it is an investment in long-term wellbeing.
2. Quotation	Ends with a relevant, thought-provoking quotation.	As the saying reminds us, "The journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step."
3. Prediction / Recommendation	Predicts a future result or recommends action.	Universities should provide more quiet study spaces to help students work effectively.

Version A - Student Edition

Titles & Useful Transitions

Helping the reader follow your ideas

A title is a brief summary of what a paper is about. It should be clear, focused and connected to the main topic.

Effective Titles

- clearly show the topic
- are brief but specific
- use capital letters for the important words
- do not need quotation marks or underlining

Avoid

- very broad one-word titles
- titles that do not match the essay
- full sentences when a shorter phrase is clearer
- unnecessary punctuation

Topic	Weak title	Stronger title
Changes in a hometown	Changes	Some Welcome Changes
Difficulty getting a permit	Permits	The Hassles of Getting a Permit
Reasons for choosing a career	Money	It Is Not Just About Money

Useful Transition Words

Sequence:
first of all, second, next, after, then, finally, last of all

Addition:
in addition, another, furthermore, also

Example:
for example, for instance, to illustrate

Contrast:
however, but, on the contrary, in contrast

Cause and Effect:
because, therefore, as a result, consequently

Conclusion:
in conclusion, overall, to sum up, finally

Choose a transition because it expresses the correct relationship between ideas - not simply because it sounds formal.

Remember

Introduction	Conclusion	Title	Transition
Introduces the topic and thesis.	Restates the central idea and gives closure.	Briefly identifies the paper's focus.	Shows how one idea connects to another.

Version A - Student Edition

Introductions, Conclusions & Titles

Recognition practice

Exercise 1: Introduction Techniques

A General to Narrow **B** Opposite View **C** Importance **D** Anecdote **E** Quotation

1. University life has changed dramatically over the past twenty years. Today, digital technology plays an essential role in learning.
Answer: _____

2. Many people believe that social media only causes problems. However, it can also support learning when used carefully.
Answer: _____

3. Time management affects every university student because it influences academic performance and personal wellbeing.
Answer: _____

4. During my first week at university, I entered the wrong lecture hall and stayed there for twenty minutes before I noticed.
Answer: _____

5. "Education is the passport to the future." This idea is especially relevant to students preparing for a changing workplace.
Answer: _____

Exercise 2: Conclusion Techniques

S Summary + Final Thought **Q** Quotation **P** Prediction / Recommendation

1. In conclusion, regular exercise improves both physical and mental health. Developing healthy habits now can support students throughout their lives.
Answer: _____

2. As Nelson Mandela observed, "Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world."
Answer: _____

3. Universities should continue investing in student support services so that more students can succeed.
Answer: _____

4. Overall, volunteering benefits both students and the wider community, making it a valuable part of university life.
Answer: _____

5. If students develop strong study habits now, they are likely to achieve greater academic success in the future.
Answer: _____

Exercise 3: Choose the Best Title

1. A paragraph about coping with homesickness at university
A. Homes B. University C. Coping with Homesickness at University
Answer: _____

2. A paragraph about the advantages and challenges of studying abroad
A. Travel B. Studying Abroad: Challenges and Benefits C. Students
Answer: _____

3. A paragraph about regular exercise and health
A. Exercise B. Healthy Living Through Regular Exercise C. Running
Answer: _____

4. A paragraph about managing money as a student
A. Money B. Student Life C. Managing Money at University
Answer: _____

Exercise 4: Choose the Best Transition

1. _____, university students should read all assignment instructions carefully.
A. However B. First of all C. On the contrary
Answer: _____

2. The weather was terrible. _____, the football match was cancelled.
A. For example B. As a result C. Similarly
Answer: _____

3. Many students enjoy group work. _____, others prefer to study alone.
A. However B. Therefore C. For example
Answer: _____

4. Some students volunteer regularly. _____, they develop valuable communication skills.
A. As a result B. On the contrary C. Likewise
Answer: _____

5. Many fruits contain vitamins. _____, oranges are rich in vitamin C.
A. For example B. However C. Therefore
Answer: _____

6. The course is demanding. _____, it is also extremely rewarding.
A. In addition B. However C. As a result
Answer: _____

Exercise 5: True or False

1. An introduction should attract the reader's attention. Answer: _____

2. A quotation can be used to begin an essay. Answer: _____

3. However usually introduces contrast. Answer: _____

4. A good title should clearly show the topic. Answer: _____

5. A conclusion should introduce several completely new ideas. Answer: _____

6. Persuasive essays may end with a recommendation. Answer: _____

ORAL PRESENTATION GUIDELINES

LAN 100 Oral Presentation – 10%

My Future Goals: Academic & Personal Ambitions

For this assessment, you will give a short **individual presentation to the class** about four goals or ambitions for your future.

Your four goals must include:

- **Academic Goal** – something you would like to achieve in your studies
- **Career Goal** – something you would like to achieve in your future career
- **Hobby / Interest Goal** – something you would like to learn, develop or experience
- **Free Choice Goal** – any other meaningful future ambition

What do I need to do?

Prepare a short PowerPoint presentation in which you introduce and explain your four future goals.

For **each goal**, you must include three things:

1. Your ambition

Clearly state what you would like to achieve.

For example:

I would like to complete a PhD in Environmental Engineering.

2. Your explanation

Explain your goal in your own words.

You might explain:

- why this goal is important to you
- what interests you about it
- what you hope to achieve
- how you might work towards it

3. One researched piece of information

Find **one useful and relevant piece of information** connected to your goal from a reliable source.

For example:

If your goal is to complete a PhD, you could:

- identify a university offering an appropriate PhD programme
- explain what the programme focuses on
- mention an entry requirement or research area

If your goal is to run a marathon, you could give information about:

- a particular marathon
- where and when it takes place
- its distance or entry requirements

If your goal is to learn photography, you could identify:

- a recognised course or programme
- a professional organisation
- a qualification or training opportunity

Your researched information should **add something informative to your presentation**, rather than simply repeat your personal goal.

Sources and APA Referencing

You must provide a source for **each piece of researched information**.

Your sources should be reliable. Appropriate sources may include:

- university websites
- professional organisations
- government websites
- recognised institutions or companies
- reputable news or information websites

You must use **APA 7th edition referencing**.

On the slide where you use researched information, include a short **APA-style in-text citation**.

For example:

(University of Melbourne, 2026)

At the end of your PowerPoint, include a final **References** slide containing the full APA reference for each source you used.

For example:

University of Melbourne. (2026). *Doctor of Philosophy – Engineering and Information Technology*. URL

For help with APA referencing, use:

APA Style – Reference Examples
https://apastyle.apa.org/style-grammar-guidelines/references/examples

Do **not** use ChatGPT or another AI tool as the source of your factual information. Locate and cite the **original source**.

Your PowerPoint

Your presentation should normally contain:

1. **Title Slide**
2. **Academic Goal**
3. **Career Goal**
4. **Hobby / Interest Goal**
5. **Free Choice Goal**
6. **References**

Keep your slides **simple, clear and visual**.

You may include:

- photographs
- images
- maps
- logos
- short headings
- keywords
- brief bullet points
- relevant facts or statistics

Do **not** put your complete speech on your slides.

Your PowerPoint should support your presentation.

You should be the presenter – not the slides.

During the Presentation

You will present **standing at the front of the class**.

Your presentation should be approximately **4–5 minutes**.

You should:

- speak clearly and at an appropriate pace
- introduce and explain all four goals
- explain your ideas rather than simply read them
- use your PowerPoint to support what you are saying
- use your own words
- make appropriate eye contact with your audience
- show that you understand the researched information you have included

You may use **small prompt cards or brief notes**, but you should not read a prepared speech.

Using AI and Other Digital Tools

You may use AI or other digital tools during your preparation to help you:

- brainstorm possible ideas
- identify questions you could research
- organise your presentation
- check vocabulary or grammar
- improve the visual organisation of your slides

However, AI must **not replace your own speaking, thinking or understanding.**

You are responsible for:

- checking that your information is accurate
- locating the original source
- referencing your sources correctly in APA style
- deciding what information to include
- explaining the information in your own words
- understanding everything that appears on your slides

Your presentation will be assessed on **what you can communicate and explain yourself in class**, not on how sophisticated your written slides are.

Assessment

Oral Presentation: 10% of your LAN 100 grade

You will be assessed using five criteria:

1. Content & Development – 2 marks

Four clear and meaningful goals are presented and appropriately explained.

2. Organisation & PowerPoint – 2 marks

The presentation is logically organised and the slides are clear, relevant and effective.

3. Spoken Language – 2 marks

Appropriate B2-level vocabulary and grammar are used, with sufficiently clear pronunciation.

4. Delivery & Communication – 2 marks

The student speaks clearly, maintains appropriate contact with the audience and avoids excessive reading.

5. Research & Explanation – 2 marks

Relevant researched information is included, sources are appropriately referenced in **APA style**, and the student can explain the information in their own words.

Total: 10 marks

Remember

This is an **oral presentation**, not a PowerPoint-reading task.

Your slides show the audience the key information.

You explain the story behind them.

Effective Presentation Delivery

A strong presentation is not only about **what** you say. It is also about **how** you communicate it.

Your goal: look prepared, sound clear and connect with the audience.

1. Where and how should I stand?

DO	AVOID
• Stand upright but relaxed. • Keep your shoulders open and your hands free. • Face the audience, not the screen. • Keep a stable position when you are explaining an important point.	• Hiding behind a desk or lectern. • Rocking from foot to foot. • Folding your arms tightly. • Turning your back to the audience for long periods.

2. Facial expression and body language

Your face and body communicate at the same time as your words. Expressions and gestures can show interest, confidence and enthusiasm. They should support your meaning, not compete with it.

Facial expression	Let your face match the idea you are communicating. A positive goal can be presented with warmth and energy.
Hands and gestures	Use natural gestures to emphasise ideas, show size or direction, and make your explanation easier to follow.
Posture	An open, balanced posture usually appears more confident than a closed or tense posture.

Source note: Adapted from Lynn Meade, *Advanced Public Speaking*, section 2.3, "Delivery Advice: Managing Eye Contact, Movement, and Gestures," LibreTexts version, CC BY 4.0.

Eye Contact, Voice & Movement

3. Eye contact: speak to people, not to the screen

Eye contact helps create a sense of connection. Look at different people or different parts of the room as you speak. Do not stare at one person, look over everyone's heads, or keep your eyes on your notes.

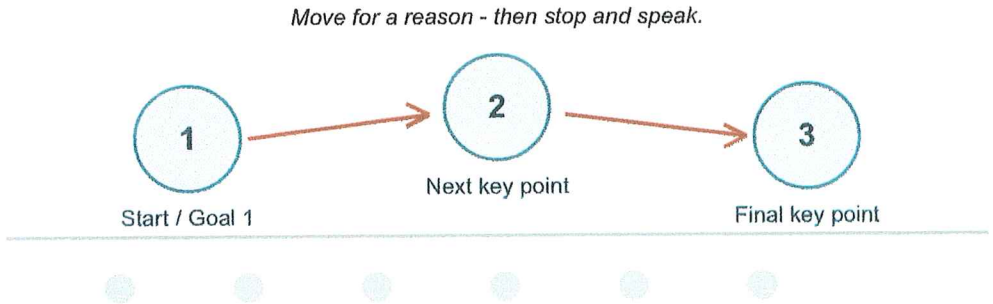
A useful habit	Look down briefly at a cue card or slide prompt, find your next idea, then look up and explain it to the audience.

4. Use your voice for impact

Volume	Speak loudly enough for the back of the room to hear you. Project your voice - do not shout.
Pace	Do not rush. Slow down for important information and allow the audience time to follow.
Clarity	Pronounce words clearly. Avoid mumbling or swallowing the ends of words.
Pauses	A short pause can help you breathe, organise your next idea and emphasise an important point.
Variety	A presentation should not sound flat. Natural changes in emphasis, pace and tone help maintain attention.
Fillers	Try to reduce repeated "um", "er", "like" or "you know". A short silent pause is usually stronger.

5. Move with a purpose

You do not need to stay frozen in one place, but movement should look intentional. Take a few steps when you change to a new goal or key point, then stop and speak. Avoid constant pacing or wandering.



Source note: Adapted from Lynn Meade, *Advanced Public Speaking*, sections 2.3 and 2.5, LibreTexts versions, CC BY 4.0.

PowerPoint: Support the Speaker

PowerPoint is a **visual aid**. It should help the audience understand and remember your message. It should not contain the speech itself.

GOOD: simple + visual

One clear idea

- keywords
- large text
- relevant visual

AVOID: text-heavy

My academic goal is to study for a PhD because I have always been interested in research and I think it will help me develop my knowledge and career. I found a programme which includes several areas of research and I would like to apply after completing my Master's degree. The university website also explains the entry requirements and research...

6. Keep slides simple

Use	Avoid
• short headings	• complete paragraphs
• keywords and brief bullet points	• your entire speech on screen
• large, easy-to-read text	• tiny text
• useful photos, maps, diagrams or charts	• decorative images with no purpose
• enough empty space	• too many colours or animations
• consistent design	• crowded slides

7. Connect the slide to your audience

- Introduce the slide: tell the audience what they should notice.
- Refer to an image, fact or key word briefly, then return your attention to the audience.
- Do not turn around and read from the projected screen.
- Rehearse with your slides so you already know what comes next.
- If a slide contains researched information, explain it in your own words and show the source.

Remember: the audience should spend more time looking at you than reading your slides.

Source note: Adapted from Sheila Kasperek, "Why Use Visual Aids?" and "Putting It Together: Creating and Using Presentation Aids," in *Public Speaking: Silence Your Doubt, Amplify Your Voice*. These sections are licensed CC BY 4.0.

Before You Present: Rehearse & Check

Good delivery is a skill. The more you practise the complete presentation - standing, speaking and using your slides - the more natural it becomes.

A simple rehearsal routine

1	**Practise once for content**	Can I explain every goal and researched fact in my own words?
2	**Practise standing up**	Where will I stand? Are my hands and posture relaxed?
3	**Practise with the PowerPoint**	Can I move through the slides without turning my back or reading them?
4	**Record one practice**	Is my voice clear? Am I rushing? Do I use eye contact and natural expression?
5	**Practise to time**	Can I finish comfortably within the required presentation time?

Presentation-day checklist

- ■ I know the main idea I want to communicate on every slide.
- ■ I can explain my researched information without reading it.
- ■ I will face the audience and use eye contact.
- ■ I will stand upright and use natural facial expressions and gestures.
- ■ I will speak loudly and clearly, at a comfortable pace.
- ■ I will move only when it helps signal a new point or transition.
- ■ My slides are simple, readable and not overloaded with text.
- ■ I have rehearsed the presentation with my PowerPoint.

Sources & licence information

Meade, L. (2022). *Advanced Public Speaking*: 2.3 Delivery Advice - Managing Eye Contact, Movement, and Gestures; and 2.5 Why Your Voice is the Most Important Part of Your Speech. Social Sci LibreTexts. https://socialsci.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Communication/Public_Speaking/Advanced_Public_Speaking_(Meade)
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Adaptation note: These LAN 100 notes have been rewritten, shortened and reorganised for B2-level classroom use. No third-party images from the source texts have been reproduced.

VOCABULARY BUILDING

University of Cyprus
The Language Center
Instructor: Helen Stavrou

Vocabulary Building: Prefixes that Express Negativity and Reversal

Some prefixes (letter groups added before a root word that change the root's meaning) have to do with negation or reversal. For example, placing the prefix ***dis*** in front of the root word ***approve*** creates the word ***disapprove,*** changing the word to a negative one. Placing the prefix ***dis*** on the root word ***arm*** crates the word ***disarm,*** reversing the root's meaning.

Here are some clues for using ***il, im, & ir:***

- Use ***il*** with words beginning with ***l***
- Use ***im*** with words beginning with ***b, m, & p***
- Use ***ir*** with words beginning with ***r***

Here are some prefixes that express negativity or reversal:

a, counter, de, dis, non, il, im, in, ir, un

Change the following words into the opposite by using one of the prefixes above (you can use a prefix more than once):

1. arm – *disarm*
2. active- _____
3. expensive- _____
4. logical- _____
5. violent- _____
6. regulate- _____
7. pleasant- _____
8. proper- _____
9. regular- _____
10. polite- _____
11. decisive- _____
12. movable- _____
13. possible- _____
14. rational- _____
15. legitimate- _____

Activity: Look up the meanings of the following words using the AWL in the part of speech indicated. Write one of the definitions of the word that fits the meanings given in the previous exercise.

https://www.eapfoundation.com/vocab/academic/awllists/

1. arm (verb)
2. active (adj.)
3. expensive (adj.)
4. logical (adj.)
5. violent (adj.)
6. regulate (verb)
7. pleasant (adj.)
8. proper (adj.)
9. regular (adj.)
10. polite (adj.)
11. decisive (adj.)
12. movable (adj.)
13. possible (adj.)
14. rational (adj.)
15. legitimate (adj.)

MATCH THE PREFIX WITH THE NUMBER

TEAM NAME: _____

PREFIX	ANSWER	NUMBER
1. tetra	_____	a. one
2. hex	_____	b. one
3. dec	_____	c. two
4. tri	_____	d. two
5. bi	_____	e. two
6. quad	_____	f. three
7. oct	_____	g. four
8. uni	_____	h. four
9. sept	_____	i. five
10. pent	_____	j. five
11. duo	_____	k. six
12. hept	_____	l. six
13. sex	_____	m. seven
14. di	_____	n. seven
15. mono	_____	o. eight
16. nov	_____	p. nine
17 quint	_____	q. ten

EXTRA POINT IF YOU MATCH THE FOLLOWING CORRECTLY:

1. ped	_____	a. side
2. lat	_____	b. foot
3. pod	_____	c. foot

VOCABULARY WORDS

1. biped- an animal with 2 feet such as a bird
2. tripod- something that has 3 feet such as a stand for a camera
3. quadruped- an animal with four feet such as a dog
4. unicorn- a mythical animal with one horn
5. unison- an instance of sounding the same note at the same time
6. monolog(ue)- one person speaking without anyone responding
7. unilateral- one-sided e.g. a unilateral decision
8. bilateral- two-sided e.g. a bilateral agreement
9. dual- two of a kind
10. duel- a formal combat with weapons fought between 2 people in the presence of witnesses
11. duet- a musical composition written for 2 people to perform simultaneously
12. duo- two musical performers; a pair e.g. Batman and Robin
13. trio- three people in a group
14. quartet- four people in a group e.g. a jazz quartet has 4 musicians
15. quintuplets- 5 children of the same mother born at one time
16. sextuplets- 6 children of the same mother born at one time
17. septuplets- 7 children of the same mother born at one time
18. hexagon- a six-sided figure
19. octagon- an eight-sided figure
20. decade- a 10 year period
21. biathlon- two events, usually sporting
22. triathlon- an endurance race combining 3 consecutive events usually swimming, bicycling and running
23. heptathlon- an athletic contest for women that requires participants to take part in 7 different events: 100-meter hurdles, shot put, high jump, 200 meter dash, long jump, javelin throw, and 800 meter run.
24. decathlon- an athletic contest in which each contestant takes part in 10 different events: 100 meter dash, 400 meter dash, long jump, 16 pound shot put, high jump, 110 meter hurdles, discus throw, pole vault, javelin throw and 1500 meter run
25. sexagenarian- a person in their 60's
26. septuagenarian- a person in their 70's
27. octogenarian- a person in their 80's
28. nonagenarian- a person in their 90's

1. The opening act of the Shakespearean play featured a(n) _____ spoken by one of the actors.

2. A kangaroo is considered to be a(n) _____ because it has two feet.

3. Together, John, Paul, George and Ringo formed the Beatles, the famous musical _____ of the 60's.

4. Carlos has _____ citizenship; he has legal rights in both Spain and the United States.

5. The Roaring Twenties was a(n) _____ of jalopies, flappers and jazz.

6. At the football game, the crowd yelled in _____, "Defense, defense, defense!"

7. Dogs, cats and horses are all examples of _____.

8. In 1987, a historic _____ agreement was reached between Ronald Reagan of the US and Mikhail Gorbachev of the Soviet Union.

9. In the _____, Frank placed high in swimming and bicycling but made a poor showing in distance running.

10. A stop sign is called a(n) _____ because it has eight sides.

11. Most adults enter the retirement phase of their life when they are _____.

12. The mother made a(n) _____ decision and told her child to go to bed.

13. The winner of the most challenging _____ is proclaimed "the world's greatest athlete."

14. In an attempt to save his wife's honor, the knight challenged his long-time enemy to a(n) _____ of swords.

15. Batman and Robin are a dynamic crime fighting _____.

16. The camera was placed on a(n) _____ so a group picture could be taken.

17. The _____ of jazz musicians was comprised of the following instruments: saxophone, trombone and piano.

18. In the musical "Grease", Olivia Newton-John and John Travolta sing many _____ together.

19. The woman in labor told the paramedics she was expecting _____; all five of which were boys.

20. If a stop sign had two less sides, it would be in the shape of a(n) _____.

21. If an athlete is taking part in two sporting events, he is engaged in a(n) _____.

22. The _____ was excited the whole family had gotten together to celebrate his 99th birthday.

23. As a healthy _____, I was able to work well into my late seventies in the family business.

24. Jackie Joyner-Kersee won the gold medal in the _____ at the Olympics in 1988 and 1992 by competing in seven different events.

25. Jenny, Jackie, Jill, Julia, Jessica and Joanne are _____ born on March 3rd, 2007.

26. The child held her plush stuffed _____ in her arms as her mother read her the story of a mythical creature with one horn which saved the princess from the evil witch.

27. The happy couple named their _____ after the classic Disney story of Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs: Happy, Sneezy, Grumpy, Sleepy, Dopey, Bashful and Doc.

28. The _____ who had been in a nursing home since he turned 80 died in his sleep at age 85.

The Total Communicator

While You're Talking, What Is Your Body Saying?

1. **More than half of your impact as a speaker depends upon your body language.** You probably have control over the words you speak, but are you sure that you have control over what you are saying with your body language?

2. **Body language comprises gesture, stance, and facial expression.** These are all the more important when all eyes of an audience are upon you. When you are presenting, strong, positive body language becomes an essential tool in helping you build credibility, express your emotions, and connect with your listeners. It also helps your listeners focus more intently on you and what you're saying.

3. The tricky thing about body language is that you are usually unaware of the messages you're conveying nonverbally. When presenters see themselves on videotape, they're often surprised to see that their body language conveyed an entirely different message from the one they had intended. For example, some people actually shake their heads "no" when they say "yes."

4. **Effective body language** supports the message and projects a strong image of the presenter. Audiences respond best to presenters whose bodies are alive and energetic. Audiences appreciate movement when it is meaningful and supportive of the message. The most effective movements are ones that reflect the presenter's personal investment in the message.

5. Anyone can utter a series of words; it is the presenter's personal connection to those words that can bring them to life for the audience. Presenters who care deeply about their material tend to use their entire bodies to support the message. Their gestures are large enough to embrace the room full of people. They stand tall and lean into the audience right from their feet, as if trying to shorten the distance between their message and the ears of the audience. Their faces express their passion while their eyes connect with the audience, focusing on one person at a time.

6. **Gesture.** *Do* use your hands. They don't belong on your hips or in your pockets or folded across your chest either or held behind your back. Use them-to help emphasize a point, to express emotion, to release tension, and to engage your audience.

7. Most people have a gestural vocabulary at their disposal. Anyone can all

think of a gesture that supports words such as "short" or "tall;" however, the gestures of everyday conversation tend to be too small and often too low to use in front of a large audience. Presenters need to scale their gestures to the size of the room. The most effective gestures arise from the shoulder, not the wrist or elbow. Shoulder gestures project better across the distance and release more of the presenter's energy, helping combat any tension that can build in the upper body (particularly under pressure).

8. **Stance.** How you stand in front of the room speaks before open your mouth. Your stance can tell the audience that you're happy, scared, confident, or uncomfortable. Audiences "read" these messages unthinkingly but unfailingly. Stance speaks. A balanced stance with weight even but slightly forward tends to say that the speaker is engaged with the audience. A slumped stance leaning to one side can says the speaker doesn't care.

9. The feet should point straight ahead, not quite shoulder-width apart. When not gesturing, the hands should sit quietly at the sides of the presenter. Letting the hands fall to the sides between gestures projects ease. These moments of stillness between gestures also have the effect of amplifying the gestures. Yes, you can move around, but remember to punctuate that movement with stillness. Constant motion, such as swaying, is a distraction that can annoy your listeners.

10. **Facial expression.** The movements of your eyes, mouth, and facial muscles can build a connection with your audience. Alternatively, they can undermine your every word. Eye focus is the most important element in this process. No part of your facial expression is more important in communicating sincerity and credibility. Nothing else so directly connects you to your listeners-whether in a small gathering or a large group. Effective presenters engage one person at a time, focusing long enough to complete a natural phrase and watch it sink in for a moment. This level of focus can rivet the attention of a room by drawing the eyes of each member of the audience and creating natural pauses between phrases. The pauses not only boost attention, but also contribute significantly to comprehension and retention by allowing the listener time to process the message.

11. The other elements of facial expression can convey the feelings of the presenter, anything from passion for the subject, to depth of concern for the audience. Unfortunately, under the pressure of delivering a group presentation, many people lose their facial expression. Their faces solidify into a grim, stone statue, a thin straight line where the lips meet. Try to unfreeze your face right from the start. For example, when you greet the audience, smile! You won't want to smile throughout the entire presentation, but at least at the appropriate moments. It's only on rare occasions that you may need to be somber and serious throughout.

12 **Bring it all together**

While we all want to believe that it's enough to be natural in front of a room, it isn't really natural to stand up alone in front of a group of people.

It's an odd and unusual thing that creates stress, tension, and stomach troubles. Being natural won't cut it. We need to be bigger, more expressive, and more powerful. It takes extra effort and energy. It also takes skill and practice. With so much depending on communication and communication depending on body language, it's worth getting it right. Work on your body language-gesture, stance, and facial expression-to make the most of every speaking opportunity.

This Issue

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The University of Cyprus
The Language Centre

"The Total Communicator"- worksheet

1. What would you say is the main idea of this article?

2. As speakers, do we always realise what type of body language we are communicating to others?

3. What can the way we stand show about how we are feeling?

4. Is it a good idea to pause (take a short break) while we are presenting? Why? Why not?

5. Is body language something we can improve with practice?

6. Have you noticed any of your own body language which may show that you are feeling nervous or uncomfortable? What sort of things might you do?

Vocabulary in Context

Find ONE word in the passage which means the same as:

1. is made up of (par 2) _____
2. showing, communicating (par 3) _____
3. to say (par 5) _____
4. fight (par 7) _____
5. magnifying, to make bigger (par 9) _____
6. attract, fix, hold (par 10) _____

University of Cyprus
The Language Center
Instructor: Helen Stavrou
LAN 100

Paraphrasing from 'The Total Communicator'

Instructions: Read each phrase taken from the article and choose the answer closest in meaning to the original.

1. 'an essential tool in helping you build credibility' (p.2)
   a) an enormous piece of equipment which helps you with opening doors of opportunity
   b) a vital instrument in assisting you with developing trust
   c) a critical thing in aiding you with creating disbelief

2. 'It also helps your listeners focus more intently on you' (p. 2)
   a) It additionally assists the audience with more constant concentration on you
   b) It makes those listening put their eyes on you constantly
   c) It aids those in the audience with paying attention to important things you say

3. 'Audiences respond best to presenters whose bodies are alive and energetic' (p. 4)
   a) The people watching react more positively to speakers whose movements aren't still but rather lively
   b) Being vivacious will make the people watching laugh
   c) Exciting and active movement enhances oral presentations

4. 'to release tension' (p. 6)
   a) to sit calmly and do zen
   b) to reduce anxiety
   c) to let stress be released

5. 'Constant motion, such as swaying, is a distraction that can annoy listeners' (p.9)

a) Too much motion like a swing makes the audience pay attention less
b) Movement that is like shaking irritates those listening and therefore they do not focus
c) Continuous movement like moving back and forth aggravates the audience and they do not pay attention

6. 'No part of your facial expression is more important in communicating sincerity and credibility.' (p.10)
   a) Your eye contact is the most necessary in conveying honesty and believability
   b) The only thing that is important regarding your face is that you show you are a trustworthy person
   c) The way you look makes all the difference in how the audience will react to you

7. 'Try to unfreeze your face right from the start' (p. 11)
   a) Attempt to relax your expression from the beginning
   b) Make your face look very calm at intervals
   c) You should initially make your appearance seem friendly

8. 'It's an odd and unusual thing that creates stress, tension, and stomach troubles.' (p. 12)
   a) It's a bizarre and extraordinary experience that makes you feel ill
   b) It's a weird and strange phenomenon that produces anxiety, nervousness and gastric issues
   c) Tummy issues will be the direct result of this peculiar speaking syndrome

COMPARISON & CONTRAST WRITING

LAN 100 · Introduction to Academic English

Working with Comparison and Contrast

Instructor: Helen Stavrou

Pair task: Interview your partner about three areas of university student life. Take notes and use your findings to write one well-structured comparison and contrast paragraph.

Step 1 · Interview your partner

Working in pairs, ask your partner as many questions as you can about the following three areas:

1. **First impressions of UCY life**
   What surprised you? What have you enjoyed? What has been difficult?
2. **Preferred teaching style of instructors**
   Do you prefer lectures, discussion, group work, practical activities or detailed explanations?
3. **Overall UCY student workloads**
   How manageable is the workload? What takes the most time? How do you organise your studies?

Step 2 · Take notes

Criterion	My partner	Me	Similar or different?
First impressions of UCY life			
Preferred teaching style			
Overall student workload			

Step 3 · Write Your Paragraph

Use your notes to complete and adapt the model below. Change the wording so that it accurately reflects the similarities and differences you discovered. Add sentences where necessary.

Life as a first-year university student is often as interesting as it is overwhelming. There are many aspects of university life to consider, such as first impressions, preferred teaching styles and overall workload. Not all students experience these things in the same way. My classmate _____ and I share similar viewpoints on some of these issues while differing on others.

With respect to first impressions of UCY life, _____ feels _____. I also _____; however, _____.

When it comes to preferred teaching styles, our viewpoints are the same / very similar / completely different. _____ feels strongly that _____, while I _____.

As far as overall UCY workloads are concerned, there is complete agreement / complete disagreement / some similarity. I personally feel that _____, while _____ believes _____.

Although _____ and I are both first-year students at the same university, our experiences so far are not exactly the same. We share certain similarities with respect to _____ while differing on aspects such as _____. It is clear that every student experiences university life in a unique way.

Useful comparison and contrast transitions

Comparison	just as · similarly · also · as well · both · the same
Contrast	in contrast · different · but · however · on the other hand · while

Before you finish: Check that your paragraph has a clear topic sentence, discusses all three criteria, uses comparison and contrast transitions, and ends with a concluding sentence.

LAN 100 | WRITING SKILLS

Comparison & Contrast Writing

Using the Point-by-Point Method

Comparison and contrast writing examines two subjects to explain meaningful similarities and differences. The aim is not simply to state what is obvious.

Common Topics

- fast food vs home cooking
- online vs face-to-face learning
- living at home vs student accommodation
- lyceum vs university
- printed books vs e-books

Basic Structure

- **Introduction:** optional hook + thesis statement
- **Body:** supporting sentences organised by three criteria
- **Conclusion:** summary, final thought or opinion

The Thesis Statement

The thesis statement clearly states **what two subjects** will be compared and contrasted and names **three criteria**.

Online learning and face-to-face learning can be compared and contrasted in terms of interaction, flexibility and learning experience.

The criteria must appear in the same order in the supporting sentences.

Paragraph Part	Purpose
Hook	Attracts the reader's attention. It is optional in a paragraph.
Thesis Statement	Names the two subjects and the three criteria.
Supporting Sentences	Compare and/or contrast both subjects under each criterion, in order.
Conclusion	Ends the paragraph with a summary, final thought or opinion.

LAN 100 | COMPARISON & CONTRAST

The Point-by-Point Method

The method used in LAN 100

In the Point-by-Point Method, both subjects are discussed together under each criterion.

Thesis Subjects + 3 criteria → **Criterion 1** Compare both subjects → **Criterion 2** Compare both subjects

Criterion 3 Compare both subjects → **Conclusion**

Criterion	Online Learning	Face-to-Face Learning
1. Interaction	Video calls, forums and messages	Direct discussion with classmates and instructors
2. Flexibility	Often more flexible	Usually follows a fixed timetable
3. Learning Experience	Independent and technology-based	Immediate feedback and classroom discussion

Use the Point-by-Point Method in LAN 100.

Alternative: The Block Method

The Block Method discusses everything about Subject A first and then everything about Subject B. You should recognise it, but your LAN 100 examples and practice focus on Point-by-Point.

LAN 100 | POINT-BY-POINT MODEL

Worked Model

Online Learning vs Face-to-Face Learning

Structure: Hook • Thesis • Criterion 1 • Criterion 2 • Criterion 3 • Conclusion

Hook

Many university students now have experience with both online and face-to-face learning.

Thesis Statement

Online learning and face-to-face learning can be compared and contrasted in terms of interaction, flexibility and learning experience.

Criterion 1 - Interaction

Face-to-face classes allow students to communicate directly with classmates and instructors. In contrast, online learning often relies on discussion boards or video calls, which may feel less personal.

Criterion 2 - Flexibility

Online learning offers greater flexibility because students can often study when it is convenient. However, face-to-face classes follow fixed schedules and require students to attend at specific times.

Criterion 3 - Learning Experience

Although both methods can be effective, face-to-face classes may provide a richer learning experience because they encourage discussion and immediate feedback.

Conclusion

Overall, both forms of learning have strengths. The better choice depends on the student's needs and preferred learning style.

Check Your Understanding

Recognition practice only

1. Choose the Best Thesis Statement

a. Compare lyceum and university.

A. Lyceum and university are different.
B. Lyceum and university can be compared and contrasted according to workload, independence and assessment.
C. University is better than lyceum.
Answer: _____

b. Compare printed books and e-books.

A. Books are useful.
B. Printed books and e-books are popular.
C. Printed books and e-books can be compared and contrasted in terms of portability, cost and reading experience.
Answer: _____

2. Choose the Best Three Criteria

Living at home vs student accommodation

A. food, music, weather
B. cost, independence, responsibilities
C. television, travel, hobbies

Answer: _____

3. Choose the Best Transition

Online learning is flexible. _____, face-to-face classes provide more direct interaction.

A. Likewise B. However C. Therefore Answer: _____

Both methods can be effective. _____, students should choose the one that best suits their needs.

A. Therefore B. In contrast C. For example Answer: _____

4. Point-by-Point or Block?

Plan	Point-by-Point	Block
Compare both schools under workload, then schedule, then instructors.	☐	☐
Discuss everything about School A, then everything about School B.	☐	☐
Compare both restaurants under price, food and service.	☐	☐

Point-by-Point Planning Guide

Prepare ideas before writing

Use this planner to organise the two subjects and three criteria in the correct order.

Topic	
Subject A	
Subject B	
Criterion 1	
Criterion 2	
Criterion 3	

Thesis Statement

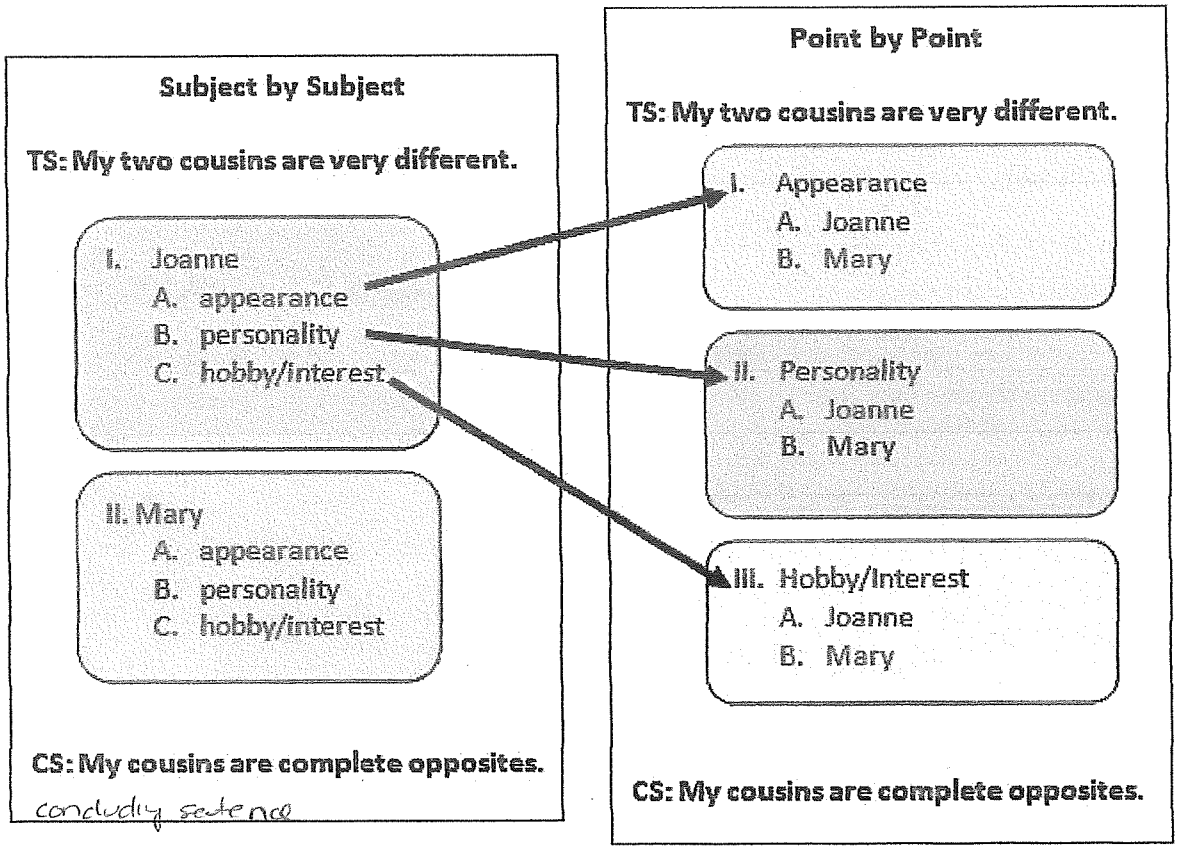
Point-by-Point Notes

Criterion	Subject A	Subject B
1		
2		
3		

Conclusion

☐ Summary and final thought ☐ Quotation ☐ Prediction / recommendation

COMPARISON AND CONTRAST



Compare & Contrast Essay Transition Words

Transitional words and phrases:

- helps papers read more smoothly
- provide logical organization and understandability
- improve the connections and transitions between thoughts

Transitions indicate relations, whether within a sentence, paragraph, or paper.

This list illustrates "relationships" between ideas, followed by words and phrases that can connect them.

Comparison/Similarities Transitions:

also, again, as well as, besides, coupled with, furthermore, in addition, likewise, moreover, similarly, comparatively, correspondingly, identically, similar, moreover,

together with, by the same token

Contrast/Difference Transitions:

contrast, conversely, instead, on one hand, on the other hand, on the contrary, rather, yet, but, however, nevertheless, in contrast

Summarizing Transitions:

after all, all in all, all things considered, briefly, by and large, in any case, in any event, in brief, in conclusion, on the whole, in short, in summary, in the final analysis, in the long run, on balance, to sum up, to summarize, finally, in essence, in other words, in short

Example Transitions:

for example, for instance, for one thing, as an illustration, illustrated with, as an example, in this case, chiefly, especially, for instance, in particular, markedly, namely, particularly, including, specifically, such as

LAN 100
Comparison and Contrast Writing – Useful Phrases
Helen Stavrou

The following phrases can be used when moving from one criterion to another:

- With respect to...
- In relation to...
- As far as....
- Concerning....
- In terms of...
- When considering .....
- When discussing .....
- When it comes to

COMPARISON AND CONTRAST

Compare & Contrast:

2 different university courses **OR** 2 different restaurants

* workload
* class atmosphere
* instructor
* atmosphere
* prices
* taste of food

Choose ONE of the two methods below:

Subject by Subject (Block)

T.S: _____

Introduction

I. Restaurant A OR Course A

1. *Criterion*

2. *Criterion*

3. *Criterion*

II. Restaurant B OR Course B

1. *Criterion*

2. *Criterion*

3. *Criterion*

Conclusion

Point by Point

T.S: _____

Introduction

I. Criterion 1

A. Restaurant or Course

B. Restaurant or Course

II. Criterion 2

A. Restaurant or Course

B. Restaurant or Course

III Criterion 3

A. Restaurant or Course

B. Restaurant or Course

Conclusion

Here are some examples of comparison contrast topics:

Fast food versus home cooking	Online learning versus traditional learning	Real life dating versus online dating
A Chinese restaurant versus an Italian restaurant	Friends versus family	Lyceum versus university

Purpose:

The purpose of writing a comparison contrast paragraph is not to state the obvious but rather to highlight subtle differences or unexpected similarities between two subjects

PARTS of a comparison/ contrast paragraph:

- **The Introduction:** hook + thesis statement
- **The Body:**

  You need supporting sentences.

- **The conclusion:** summary & final thought, quotation, prediction/recommendation/ **opinion**

The Introduction:

The Hook is used to attract the reader's attention. It can be one or more sentences that lead to the thesis statement.

The hook is optional.

The Introduction continued:

The thesis statement is the most important sentence in your paragraph as it clearly states what you will be comparing and/or contrasting.

You should provide 3 criteria in your thesis statement

These 3 criteria should be listed in the order that they will be explained in the supporting sentences of a comparison/contrast paragraph

The Supporting Sentences:

These explain the three criteria in the same order as they are given in the thesis statement.

You should use comparison/contrast transitions within sentences and to also link sentences

The Conclusion

The conclusion can be one sentence if you are writing a comparison/ contrast paragraph.

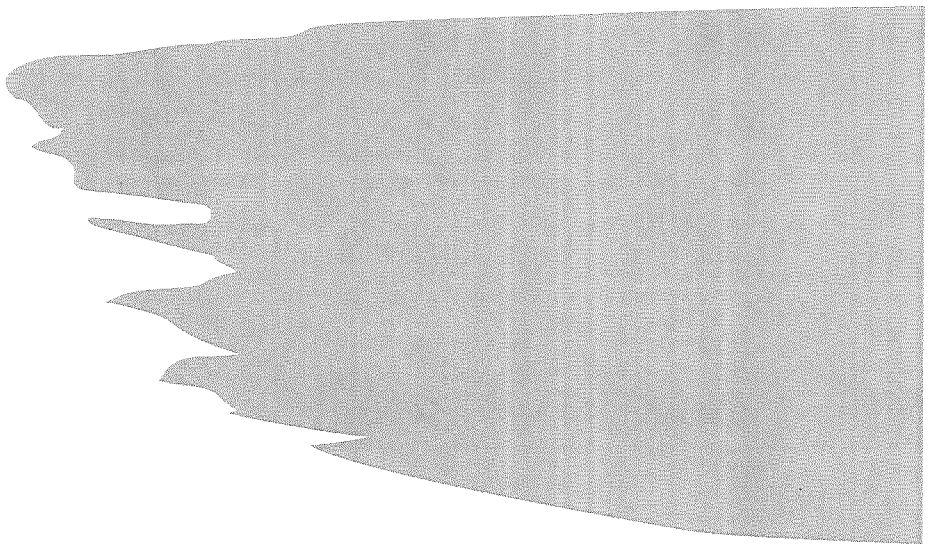
Giving your opinion is a good way to end a comparison/ contrast paragraph

TWO STYLES FOR COMPARISON CONTRAST

- **The Block Style-** organize by the subjects themselves; one then the other. For example, write only about 'oranges' first and then write only about 'apples'

- **The Point-by-Point Style-** organize by individual points, in which you discuss each subject in relation to each point. For example, apples and oranges in terms of taste, season and cooking.

- USE THE POINT-BY-POINT METHOD FOR THE FINAL EXAM WRITING PART!!!



EXAMPLE: Lyceum vs. University using the Point-by-Point Method:

- If you had to write a paragraph comparing and contrasting '**lyceum vs. university**', you would need to think of 3 criteria to mention in your thesis statement that you would then go on to develop in your supporting sentences.

The Introduction:

- **You can begin with a hook which leads into your thesis statement:**

➢ As a university student at present, I can confirm that attending university is very different to attending lyceum. Though there are some similarities, in my experience thus far, there are more differences.

- **Your thesis should mention the 3 criteria you will discuss:**

➢ Lyceum and university can be compared and contrasted according to workloads, schedule, and instructors.

Now you must begin your supporting sentences where each of the 3 criteria will be discussed using the point-by-point method:

Criteria 1: Workloads (explain similarities and/or differences)

Criteria 2: schedule (explain similarities and/ or differences)

Criteria 3: Instructors (explain similarities and/or differences)

The Conclusion:

Now you must end your paragraph with a conclusion:

Based on the above differences and my personal experience, I think university is far better than lyceum. I am happy to be at university because I have more freedom and flexibility.

Some tips:

1. Organize your ideas before you actually write the final version
2. Once you have written your paragraph, proofread for mistakes
3. Do a word count to ensure you are within the requested amount of words and modify if needed
4. Write your completed paragraph neatly in the space provided
5. You can personalize your paragraph depending on the question given

Comparison and Contrast Activity - Point by Point Method

My two favourite places to eat are George's Tavern and Imperial Chinese Restaurant. I visit these places often, especially when I need a night off from cooking! **Although** I love both places equally, there are some **similarities** but also some **differences** between them with respect to atmosphere, price and taste of food. In terms of atmosphere, George's tavern is warm and friendly. It's a great place to kick back and relax, even if you don't feel like getting all dressed up. The service is great, and the servers are always friendly! **In contrast**, Imperial Chinese is a little more sophisticated. You can wear something a little more formal to enjoy a meal here. When it comes to price, most dishes at George's are very reasonable, especially considering the huge servings!! You can easily feed a family of four with around €30 and that usually includes a takeaway box! **Unlike** George's, the dishes served at Imperial are more expensive. Of course, they are served in a much fancier way. **Although** more expensive, it still remains great value for money considering the size of the dishes, **just like** George's. One thing about **both** places which is **similar** is the taste of the food. Regardless of which place I choose to visit; the great taste remains **the same**. All in all, I'd say that whether you choose to visit George's Tavern or Imperial Chinese restaurant, you won't be disappointed.

University of Cyprus
The Language Center
Instructor: Helen Stavrou

COMPARISON CONTRAST REVISION

Instructions: Read each statement carefully and decide if it is true or false based on the information taught thus far about comparison/contrast writing.

1. _____A possible comparison contrast topic could be: online learning versus traditional learning.
2. _____ When writing a comparison contrast paragraph, one should focus more on the similarities between two things rather than the differences.
3. _____ The generally accepted format for a comparison contrast paragraph is: thesis statement, supporting sentences, and conclusion.
4. _____ When writing a comparison contrast paragraph, a hook is mandatory.
5. _____ Hooks are found after the thesis statement.
6. _____ The two things being compared should be mentioned only in the concluding sentence of a comparison contrast paragraph.
7. _____ The thesis statement should contain 3 criteria that will then be analyzed in the supporting sentences.
8. _____ The 3 criteria can be explained in a random order.
9. _____ Transition words should be used in a comparison contrast paragraph.
10. _____ The conclusion of a comparison contrast paragraph should be one sentence.
11. _____ There are two kinds of styles one can use when writing a comparison contrast paragraph.
12. _____ Writing about apples and oranges in terms of taste, season and cooking is an example of the point-by-point style.
13. _____ Providing your personal opinion in a comparison contrast paragraph is a good way to end.
14. _____ It's always a good idea to plan before you write.
15. _____ It's always a good idea to write a rough draft before the final version.
16. _____ It's always a good idea to proofread your work.
17. _____ The requested number of words must be exact.
18. _____ The thesis statement must contain the two items being compared and contrasted and the three criteria those two items will be compared and contrasted about.

LAN 100 Comparison & Contrast Paragraph Writing

***Instructions**: Choose 1 of the clips viewed in today's class and write a Point-by-point comparison and contrast paragraph in response to either of the questions below. Your response should be between 170-200 words.*

Choice 1

***Clip 1** - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fHU0QPF1G3Y&list=WL*
Dog – Man's best friend

QUESTION: Compare & contrast human relationships versus human & pet relationships.

***Main idea**: There are a number of similarities and differences between human relationships and human and pet relationships. Three criteria to be discussed are _____, _____ and _____.*

Choice 2

QUESTION: Compare and contrast the role of a mother with the role of a friend.

***Clip 2** - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FLeFfJ1XuEk&list=WL&index=2*
Olympic Games 2012 – Best Job

***Main idea**: There are a number of ways in which the role of a mother and the role of a friend can be compared and contrasted. Three criteria to be discussed are _____, _____, and _____.*

***Your response should include**:*

A title

***Introduction** (HOOK = technique to get interest + main idea + 3 criteria to be discussed)*

Criterion 1 + comparison/contrast
Criterion 2 + comparison/contrast
Criterion 3 + comparison/contrast

Conclusion

FALL 2024 - LAN 100
Working with Comparison & Contrast
Instructor: Helen Stavrou

Compare and contrast your own test taking habits with those of a classmate in terms of pretest taking, actual exam taking and post exam habits. (170-200words)

Student name:_____

Everyone differs when it comes to test taking preparation since everyone learns in different ways. My friend _____ and I share similarities and differences when it comes to pretest taking habits, actual exam taking habits and post exam taking habits. _____

Word count: _____

COURSE REVISION

CHAPTER 2

Main Ideas and Details

Directions: The main idea sentence appears at different locations in the following paragraphs. Write the letter of the main idea sentence on the line. Then draw a diagram of the paragraph and list several supporting details by letter.

1. (a) Human beings need social relationships; we cannot thrive as solitary creatures. (b) The human species couldn't survive if adults didn't cherish and support each other. (c) It couldn't survive if we didn't form strong mutual attachments with our infants. (d) And it couldn't survive if we didn't create families in which to raise children. (e) Simply put, people need people.

Main Idea Sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting Details: _____

4. (a) At first, love is likely to be characterized by high levels of passion and rapidly increasing intimacy. (b) After a while, passion decreases as we become habituated to it and to the person. (c) All human relationships change over time, and love relationships are no exception. (d) Sometimes intimacy continues to grow at a deeper, less conscious level; at other times, the couple may drift apart. (e) If a more lasting love fails to emerge, the relationship will likely break up, and each person will search for another who will once again ignite his or her passion.

Main Idea Sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting Details: _____

6. (a) A key strategy for effective communication is to use "I" statements that describe how you feel rather than "you" statements to describe how you think another person is acting or feeling. (b) Try thinking of three "you" statements that you would like to make to someone you know, and then translate each one into an "I" statement. (c) For example, "You never do anything to clean up the apartment" could be changed to "I get irritated when I realize that I've been doing most of the housework around the apartment. (d) I'd like to talk about setting up a schedule for sharing the chores." (e) When you use "I" statements, you are taking responsibility for your feelings. (f) "You" statements are often blaming or accusatory and will probably get a defensive or resentful response. (g) The statement "I feel unloved," for example, sends a clearer, less blaming message than the statement "You don't love me."

Main Idea Sentence: _____ Diagram: _____

Supporting Details: _____

CHAPTER 3

Determining an Author's Purpose

_____ 2. **Job-Related Stressors**
In recent surveys, Americans rate their jobs as one of the key sources of stress in their lives. Tight schedules and overtime contribute to time-related pressures. More than one-third of Americans report that they always feel rushed, and nearly half say they would give up a day's pay for a day off. Worries about job performance, salary, and job security are a source of stress for some people. Interactions with bosses, coworkers and customers can also contribute to stress. High levels of job stress are also common for people who are left out of important decisions relating to their jobs. When workers are given the opportunity to shape how their jobs are performed. job satisfaction goes up and stress levels go down.
(p. 41)

_____ 3. **Communicate!**
Learning to say no--whether to extra work or extra play--is an important part of effective time management. If you don't have enough time for something that your friends are pressuring you to do, you need to use assertive communication to maintain control of your own time. Begin by knowing your priorities and believing in your right to decide what you will do. Remain calm in the face of pressure and don't feel guilty about saying no. For example: "I'd like to go to the club with you, but I have to get started on my English paper. I have only this week to work on it, and it's important to me. I'm sorry you don't have anyone else to go with right now--I could go on Friday if you're available then." When you feel your environment is controlling you instead of the other way around, take charge!

CHAPTER 4

Patterns of Organization

Directions: Write the key transition words and the main pattern of organization for each paragraph below.

1. Rude and unthinking drivers set the stage for highway aggression and danger. For instance, the driver behind you is following so closely that you can't see his license plate in your rear view mirror. Or maybe the car in front of you is hogging the passing lane and going slower than the speed limit. A driver in the next lane slips in front of you without using a turn signal. On another road it's more of the same. Someone feels compelled to pull out in front of the last car in a line of traffic rather than wait a fraction of a second for the road to be clear. People run stop signs and stop lights that are long since yellow. And there are those who speed past the line of cars forming for an exit

or lane closure and try to cut in at the front of the line. Add four-letter words, horn honking, and a couple of hand gestures to these examples and you have all of the elements of a daily commute.

Transition words: _____

Main Pattern of Organization: _____

5. The best way to stay out of driving conflicts is to avoid being an aggressive driver yourself. You can do a number of things to reduce your stress and curb the tendency toward aggression. First, allow plenty of time for your trip. We tend to over-schedule our days and not allow enough time to get from one place to the next. Sure, under perfect conditions you could cover X number of miles in X amount of time, but weather, traffic, and road construction are facts of life. At this point, you need to build extra travel time into your schedule so that when you encounter these variables, you won't get angry and possibly aggressive. Then you need to reduce stress by listening to soothing music, improving the comfort of your vehicle, and probably most importantly, understanding that you can't control the traffic--only your reaction to it. If traffic really pushes your buttons, you may want to avoid peak commuting hours. If your company doesn't have a flextime policy, you can go in a little earlier and leave a little later. Finally, if you're still tempted to let another driver have it, imagine that you're being videotaped. How would you behave if the world were watching?

Transition words: _____

Main Pattern of Organization: _____

6. The medical director of the Meyer Friedman Institute in San Francisco has researched the connection between heart disease and stress. Dr. Barton Sparagon refers to "the hurry sickness." This means that "when somebody is in a rush, and another person slows him down, the person with a hurry sickness can get extremely angry." Dr. Sparagon defines hurry sickness as "the disease of an impatient society moving ever faster." Reactions among individuals vary widely from those who "rarely exhibit their hostility to those on the other extreme who have serious impulse control problems," he says.

Transition words: _____

Main Pattern of Organization: _____

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Instructions
First, highlight or underline the MI sentence in each of the paragraphs below. Each paragraph has one supporting detail sentence missing. From the SD sentences below, choose which one is missing from which paragraph and write the letter of your choice clearly in the spaces provided.

1. In the United States smiling varies from region to region. Thirty years ago, Ray Birdwhistell found that "middle-class individuals" from Ohio, Indiana and Illinois smiled more than did people from Massachusetts, New Hampshire, and Maine, who in turn smiled more than did Western New Yorkers. _____ Students from other countries who come to U.S. universities may be **disconcerted** by the American tendency to smile to strangers – until they realize that the smiles don't "mean" anything.

2. _____ It is well-documented that babies need to be touched to grow to **thrive**. Touch, while necessary for optimum health, can communicate many messages. A person who dislikes touch may seem unfriendly to someone who's used to touching. A toucher may seem overly familiar to someone who dislikes touch. Studies in the United States have shown that touch is **interpreted** as power: more powerful people touch less powerful people.

3. People who don't know each other well may feel more comfortable with each other if a piece of furniture separates them. _____ Lecterns and desks can be used as **barricades** to protect oneself from other people. One professor normally walked among his students as he lectured. But if anyone asked a question he was uncomfortable with, he retreated behind the lectern before answering it. Spatial arrangements mean different things within a culture and between cultures. In the United States, the size, placement, and privacy of one's office connotes (signifies) status. Large corner offices have the highest status. An individual office with a door that closes connotes more status than a desk in a common area. Japanese firms, however, see private offices as "inappropriate and inefficient," reports Robert Christopher. Only the very highest executives and directors have private offices in the traditional Japanese company, and even they will also have desks in the common area.

4. People in many cultures want to establish a personal relationship before they decide whether to do business with each other. For example, to do business in Mexico, you need to develop a personal relationship. Tell me about you as a person. That's very important. Then I tell you about me, and we do this sometimes, not just one time, but several times. Then I will trust you and I will value your qualities.

_____

5. Many North Americans measure time in five-minute blocks. Someone who is five minutes late to an appointment or a job interview feels **compelled** to apologize. If the executive or interviewer is running half an hour late, the caller expects to be told about the likely delay upon arriving. Some people won't be able to wait that long and will need to reschedule their appointments. _____
To someone who mentally measure time in 15-minute blocks, being 45 minutes late is no worse than being 15 minutes late to someone who is conscious of smaller units. Different cultures also have different lead times. In some countries, you need to schedule important meetings at least two weeks in advance. In other countries, not only are people not booked up so far in advance, but a date two weeks into the future may be forgotten. Various cultures mentally measure time differently.

6. Symbols (clothing, colors, and age) carry nonverbal meanings that vary from culture to culture. In North America, certain styles and colors of clothing are considered more "professional" and more "credible." In Japan, clothing denotes not only status but also occupational group. Students wear uniform. Workers wear different clothes when they are on strike than they do when they are working. In the United States, youth is valued. _____ In Japan, younger people defer to older people. Americans attempting to negotiate in Japan are usually taken more seriously if at least one member of the team is noticeably gray-haired.

7. Height **connotes** status in many parts of the world. Executive offices are usually on the top floors; the underlings work below. _____
Studies have shown that employers are more willing to hire men over 6 feet tall than shorter men with the same credentials. In one study, every extra inch of height brought an extra $1,300 a year.

8. Differences in eye contact can lead to miscommunication in the multicultural workplace. For example, North American whites see eye contact as a sign of honesty. But in many cultures, dropped eyes are a sign of appropriate **deference** to a superior. Puerto Rican children are taught not to meet the eyes of adults, and in Korea **prolonged** eye contact is considered rude. _____
Arab men in laboratory experiments looked at each other more than did two American men or two Englishmen. Eye contact is so important that Arabs dislike talking to someone wearing dark glasses or while walking side by side. It is considered impolite not to face someone directly. In Muslim countries, women and men are not supposed to make eye contact.

Supporting Details

A. Even being tall can help a person succeed.
B. But in other cultures, 15 minutes or half an hour may be the smallest block of time.
C. For example, a group may work better sitting around a table than just sitting in a circle.
D. Then I will like to work with you.
E. People from cities in southern and border states -Atlanta, Louisville, Memphis, and Nashville-smiled most of all.
F. The lower-ranking person is expected to look down first.
G. Repeated studies have shown that older people are healthier both mentally and physically if they are touched.
H. Some men as well as some women color their hair and even have face-lifts to look as youthful as possible.

Determining an Author's Purpose

Directions: Label each sentence according to its general purpose: to inform (**I**), to entertain (**E**), or to persuade (**P**).

_____ 1. **The Ants and the Grasshopper**

On a cold and frosty day the ants began dragging out some of the grain they had stored during the summer and began drying it. A grasshopper, half-dead with hunger, came by and asked the ants for a morsel to save his life.
"What did you do this past summer?" responded the ants.
"Oh," said the grasshopper, "I kept myself busy by singing all day long and all night, too." "Well then," remarked the ants, as they laughed and shut their storehouse, "since you kept yourself busy by singing all summer, you can do the same by dancing all winter."

_____ 2. **Job-Related Stressors**

In recent surveys, Americans rate their jobs as one of the key sources of stress in their lives. Tight schedules and overtime contribute to time-related pressures. More than one-third of Americans report that they always feel rushed, and nearly half say they would give up a day's pay for a day off. Worries about job performance, salary, and job security are a source of stress for some people. Interactions with bosses, coworkers and customers can also contribute to stress. High levels of job stress are also common for people who are left out of important decisions relating to their jobs. When workers are given the opportunity to shape how their jobs are performed. job satisfaction goes up and stress levels go down. (p. 44)

_____ 3. **Communicate!**

Learning to say no--whether to extra work or extra play--is an important part of effective time management. If you don't have enough time for something that your friends are pressuring you to do, you need to use assertive communication to maintain control of your own time. Begin by knowing your priorities and believing in your right to decide what you will do. Remain calm in the face of pressure and don't feel guilty about saying no. For example: "I'd like to go to the club with you, but I have to get started on my English paper. I have only this week to work on it, and it's important to me. I'm sorry you don't have anyone else to go with right now--I could go on Friday if you're available then." When you feel your environment is controlling you instead of the other way around, take charge! (p. 47)

_____ 4. **Workplace Violence**

Each year U.S. workers experience an average of 1.5 million minor assaults, 400,000 serious assaults, 85,000 robberies, 50,000 sexual assaults, and 1000 homicides. In about 60% of cases, workplace violence is committed by strangers; acquaintances account for nearly 40% of cases, and intimates for 1%. Police and corrections officers have the most dangerous jobs, followed by taxi drivers, security guards, bartenders, mental health professionals, and
workers at gas stations and convenience and liquor stores. Middle school teachers are nearly three times more likely than high school teachers and twenty times more likely than college or university teachers to experience workplace violence. (p. 678)

Paragraphs 2, 3, and 4 are from *Core Concepts in Health* by Paul M. Insel and Walton T. Roth, tenth edition, New York: McGraw-Hill, 2006

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Modes of Discourse (Part A)

Name: _____

Instructions: Below are four paragraphs that deal with the subject of poverty. Each paragraph provides a specific example of the four modes of discourse.

Paragraph 1:

Poverty is getting up every morning from a dirt- and illness-stained mattress. The sheets have long since been used for diapers. Poverty is living in a smell that never leaves. This is the smell of urine, sour milk, and spoiling of food sometimes joined with the strong smell of long-cooked onions. Onions are cheap. It is the smell of the outdoor privy. It is the smell of young children who cannot walk the long, dark way in the night. It is the smell of the mattresses where years of "accidents" have happened. It is the smell of the milk which has gone sour because the refrigerator long has not worked, and it costs money to get fixed. It is the smell of rotting garbage. I could bury it, but where is the shovel? Shovels cost money.

Which mode of discourse is paragraph one: _____

Paragraph 2:

It is common among the non-poor to think of poverty as a sustainable condition- austere, perhaps, but they get by somehow, don't they? They are "always with us." What is harder for the non-poor to see is poverty as acute distress. The lunch that consists of Doritos or hot dog rolls, leading to faintness before the end of the shift. The "home" that is also a car or a van. The illness or injury that must be "worked through," with gritted teeth because there's no sick pay or health insurance and the loss of one day's pay will mean no groceries for the next. These experiences are not part of a sustainable lifestyle, even a lifestyle of chronic deprivation and relentlessness low-level punishment. They are, by almost any standard of subsistence, emergency situations. And that is how we

should see the poverty of so many millions of low-wage Americans- as a state of emergency.

Which mode of discourse is paragraph 2? _____

Paragraph 3:

The U.S. government defines the poverty line as the annual cost of a thrifty food budget for an urban family of four, multiplied by three to include the cost of housing, clothes, and other necessities. Families whose incomes fall below that line are officially considered poor. In 2007, the poverty line was set at an annual income of roughly 20,000 dollars for a family of four. One is eight Americans- roughly thirty-five million people, including more than ten million children- lives below the poverty line. If they could all join hands, they would form a line stretching from New York to Los Angeles and back again.

Which mode of discourse is paragraph 3? _____

Paragraph 4:

Making the leap from given-every-opportunity, spoiled-in-every-way middle-class child to boring middle-class housewife and eventually to homeless single mother should be harder than it is. In reality, it doesn't take much more than a series of bad judgment calls and wrong decision that, at the time, appear to be perfectly reasonable and in most cases for the better. My own journey into homelessness did not begin with drug use, alcoholism, or any other things we, as a society, so often attribute to such a downward spiral. Instead, I followed my bliss right into the back of a Subaru station wagon.

Which mode of discourse is paragraph 4? _____

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Name: _____

PART B: PARAGRAPH READING

Instructions: Below are 4 paragraphs followed by multiple choice questions. Write the letter of your choice neatly in the space provided next to the number of the multiple choice question. Note that the modes of discourse can be any of the four kinds of writing.

Paragraph 1:

PREVENTION! EDUCATION! PROTECTION! Avoid unsafe sex practices; avoid intravenous drug use. This advice has become the formula for surviving in the world of AIDS. Messages such as these reaffirm how essential it is to take preventive measures. Controlling your own behaviour is vital to helping prevent human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) infection. It has been more than two decades since Luc Montagnier of the Pasteur Institute (in France) published the first report of the virus (HIV) that is known to cause AIDS. Despite the high-powered arsenal of contemporary biology and media hype, there is nothing on the horizon resembling a cure for AIDS. Nor is science anywhere near a workable vaccine against HIV.

_____ 1. What two modes of discourse are used in this paragraph? (a) narration and description (b) description and exposition (c) exposition and persuasion (d) description and persuasion

_____ 2. The author's purpose is to (a) persuade readers to take precautions to prevent HIV infection, which ultimately become AIDS (b) inform readers why AIDS treatments have been largely unsuccessful (c) persuade scientists to redouble their efforts to develop a vaccine against AIDS (d) inform readers about the background and history of HIV and AIDS.

_____ 3. The intended audience is (a) medical personnel who deal with AIDS patients (b) high school and college students (c) health and sex education teachers (d) anyone who is sexually active, who uses intravenous drugs, or who may be considering becoming sexually active or using intravenous drugs.

Paragraph 2:

Ideally, sexual intimacy is a mutual, enjoyable form of communication between two people. (2) Far too often, however, relationships are approached in an aggressive, hostile manner. (3) These sexual aggressors always have a victim, someone who is physically or psychologically traumatized. (4) Sexual victimization occurs in many forms and in a variety of settings. (5) Sexual victimization includes rape and sexual assault, sexual abuse of children, sexual harassment, and the commercialization of sex.

_____ 1. Which sentence is the main idea? (a) sentence 1 (b) Sentence 3 (c) Sentence 4 (d) Sentence 5

_____ 2. What is the mode of discourse in this paragraph? (a) narration (b) description (c) exposition (d) persuasion

_____ 3. The author's purpose is to (a) entertain (b) inform (c) persuade

Paragraph 3:

The three leading causes of death in adolescence are accidents, suicide, and homicide. More than half of all deaths in adolescents ages 10 to 19 are due to accidents, and most of those involve motor vehicles, especially for older adolescents. Risky driving habits, such as speeding, tailgating, and driving under the influence of alcohol or other drugs, might be more important causes of these accidents than lack of driving experience. In about 50 percent of the motor vehicle fatalities, involving an adolescent, the driver has a blood alcohol level of 0.10 percent, twice the level needed to be "under the influence" in some states. A high rate of intoxication is often present in adolescents who die as pedestrians or while using recreational vehicles.

_____ 1. The mode of discourse in this paragraph is (a) narration (b) description (c) exposition (d) persuasion

_____ 2. The author's purpose is to (a) inform readers about one of the leading causes of adolescent deaths, accidents involving motor vehicles (b) instruct adolescents how to increase their chances of surviving adolescence (c) persuade adolescents to drive more responsibly (d) persuade parents to monitor their adolescent children more closely.

_____ 3. What is the meaning of the word "pedestrians" as it is used in the last sentence of the paragraph? (a) people who are on foot (b) people who are riding a bicycle (c) people walking their dogs (d) people who are drunk.

Paragraph 4:

If our business enterprises are to be flexible and innovative at all levels as they need to be, our youngsters must be prepared to work with and through other people. While there will always be a need for a certain number of solo practitioners, the more usual requirement will be that combinations of individual skills are greater than their sums. Most of the important work will be done by groups, rather than individual experts... Young people must be taught how to work constructively together. Instead of emphasizing individual achievement and competition, the emphasis in the classroom should be on group performance. Students need to learn how to seek and accept criticism from their peers, to solicit help, and to give credit to others, where appropriate. They must also learn to negotiate- to articulate perspectives, and to discover mutually beneficial outcomes.

_____ 1. The main idea expressed in this passage is that (a) most of the work in the future will be by individuals working alone (b) there are advantages and disadvantages to working collectively (c) many students are capable of learning to work together productively (d) young people need to be taught how to work together productively so that our business enterprises can successfully meet new challenges.

_____ 2. The author's primary purpose is to (a) convince us of the necessity of emphasizing group activities in our educational systems (b) explain the dynamics of a business enterprise (c) entertain us with an interesting anecdote concerning the world of business (d) inform us of problems students are likely to face in the near future.

_____ 3. The examples of seeking and accepting criticism, soliciting help, and giving appropriate credit were used to illustrate (a) skills students need to develop in order to work individually (b) skills students need to develop in order to work cooperatively (c) requirements of a top-notch school system (d) the complexity of a business organization.

_____ 4. The best title for the paragraph would be (a) "Group Dynamics in Action" (b) "Cooperative Learning" (c) "The Solo Practitioner" (d) "Group Learning and Business"

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A. WORDS IN CONTEXT

Each sentence below contains an italicized word. Choose the meaning of the word from the multiple choice which comes closest in meaning to the italicized word.

1. ____ When I finally get around to cleaning my fridge, I always find something ***vile*** at the back of a shelf, such as moldy fruit or rotten cheese. ***Vile*** in the above sentence means:
a) tempting b) delicious c) eaten d) disgusting

2. ____ Legal documents are normally very hard to understand. I was pleasantly surprised that this legal contract was so ***lucid***. ***Lucid*** means:
a) short b) inaccurate c) clear d) unclear

3. ____ I always have a ***dilemma*** as to whether to punish my child for using bad language or ignore the obscenities. ***Dilemma*** means:
a) temper b) proof c) difficult choice d) reason

4. ____ Whilst a ***standardized*** version of English is promoted in English textbooks around the world, many different varieties exist. ***Standardized*** means:
a) complicated b) easy c) local d) common

5. ____ If you do not understand a person's mood through what they say, you often have to ***resort to*** body language clues and tone of voice to understand them completely. ***Resort to*** means:
a) think of b) make use of c) conceal inside d) turn away from

6. ____ Having personal photographs revealed on facebook can have ***profound*** consequences on individuals leading to depression and sometimes the suicide of an individual. ***Profound*** means: a) unintentional b) accidental c) deep d) moderate

7. ____ 'Helicopter parenting' involves a parent hovering over their child's every action. A good parent, however, should allow their child some ***autonomy***. ***Autonomy*** means:
a) candy b) careful guidance c) independence d) very limited control

8. ____ Parents are not fully ***cognizant*** of the dangers, such as pornography, to be accidentally found on the internet. ***Cognizant*** means:
a) unaware b) fearing c) knowledgeable d) fluent

9. ____ Though the 21st Century has just started, the world has seen ***unparalleled*** levels of violence in regions such as the Middle East and Africa. ***Unparalleled*** means:
a) extremely vicious b) unmatched c) unexceptional d) worrying

10. ____ In New York, in September 2014, the famous Harry Potter actress, Emma Watson, in her speech as the UN women Goodwill Ambassador encouraged as many boys and girls as possible to become an ***advocate*** of the UN's Gender Equality campaign. An ***advocate*** means: a) opponent b) campaigner c) lawyer d) teacher

11. ____ Old cars have been banned in the European Union because they release ***noxious*** fumes which destroy the environment. ***Noxious*** means:
a) harmless b) hateful c) harmful d) archaic

12. ____ "I'm willing to ***affirm*** that I was present when the crime was committed," the witness said. "But I strongly deny that I took part in it." ***Affirm*** means:
a) guess b) state as true c) predict d) forget

13. ____ To get their ideas across, textbook authors often use tables, charts, and graphs. These visual aids are an effective way to ***convey*** complicated information.
Convey means a) create b) ignore c) conceal d) communicate

B. **Vocabulary Building** (using affixes that deal with numbers)
Read each sentence carefully and insert the word that fits best into the sentence. Do NOT use a word more than once. There are 6 extra words.

sextuplets	decade	heptathlon	dual	unison
quintuplets	tripod	duel	octogenarian	unicorns
quadruped	biped	unilateral	bilateral	septuagenarian
duet	monolog(ue)s	sexagenarians	hexagon	octagon

1. In order to stop the camera shaking whilst taking photographs, photographers often use a three-legged stand called a _____.

2. Writers often include mythical creatures called _____ in their stories for young children.

3. A holder of _____ citizenship will have two passports.

4. It is hard to believe how much progress has happened in technology over the last _____, that is from the year 2010 to 2020.

5. It is unfair that people assume that a(n) _____ is too old to get married just because they are in their eighties.

6. I've never competed in a _____. The thought of competing in seven different events is simply too exhausting.

7. It would seem that science has made it possible for more women to have six

babies in a single pregnancy. Will the scientists be there to help the mother and father feed the _____, I wonder!

8. The teenagers all screamed in _____ when they saw the lead singer of the British pop group *One Direction*.

9. Kangaroos are the most amazing _____ . In addition to walking on two feet, they also carry their young in a front pouch.

10. The father was very strict with the child and always made _____ decisions. That is, he never discussed matters with his wife.

11. When people become _____, that is they are in their sixties, they normally retire.

12. When interviewed in groups, politicians tend to ignore other speakers and give _____. They are not interested in allowing others to speak.

13. My partner and I performed a beautiful _____ for the school play.

14. _____ is actually a Greek word that means 'six-sided' figure.

C. **Prefixes that Express Negativity and Reversal**
Decide which word fits best for each sentence as well as if the word needs a prefix. Not all words will need a prefix. Spelling counts.

active	arm	regulate	possible
polite	decisive	rational	legitimate

1. Charles, the Prince of Wales is the _____ heir to the British throne following Queen Elizabeth's death.
2. It's _____ to predict whether one's marriage will last or not.
3. Mount Etna in Sicily is an _____ volcano as it can erupt at any given time.
4. When she was diagnosed with hyperthyroidism, she was immediately told to take medication that would _____ her thyroid.
5. The bomb squad was called in to _____ the bomb which threatened the lives of so many citizens.
6. My ex-friend's _____ words to me made me cry. Her insensitivity is unforgivable.
7. I am very _____ about whether I should attend Imperial College or Warwick having been accepted to both.
8. His _____ behavior were signs that he must have stopped taking his medication for bipolar disorder.

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LAN 100

Read the following paragraphs and answer the questions which follow:

Paragraph One:

(1) Making up excuses or false attributions for potential failures is especially common when we think we might fail at something. (2) For example, a student fails to get enough sleep before an exam, an employee drinks too much at lunch with his boss, an investor says that he never has any luck in the stock market. (3) According to Edward Jones and Steven Berglas, these individuals are making up excuses so that they can blame some external thing if they fail. (4) The student can blame lack of sleep if she does poorly on the exam, the employee can blame drinking too much if he does not get his raise, and the investor can blame a run of bad luck if he loses money on the stock market. (5) Researchers Jones and Berglas call this tendency to make up an excuse for one's potential failure the use of a *self-handicapping strategy.* (6) By attributing to yourself all kinds of handicaps (missing sleep, drinking, bad luck), you can fail without having failure seem to be your own fault.

1. Which sentence is the main idea?
    a) Sentence 1
    b) Sentence 2
    c) Sentence 3
    d) Sentence 4

2. What is the mode of discourse?
    a) Narration
    b) Description
    c) Exposition
    d) Persuasion

3. What is the author's purpose?
    a) to entertain

b) to inform
c) to persuade

4. What method of paragraph development is used in sentence 2?
   a) Classification
   b) Enumeration
   c) Example
   d) Contrast

5. What method of paragraph development is used in sentence 5?
   a) definition
   b) comparison
   c) cause-effect
   d) contrast

6. Sentence 6 uses which pattern of organization in the parenthesis?
   a) example
   b) contrast
   c) comparison
   d) definition

7. Which other sentence in the paragraph is a main idea sentence?
   a) Sentence 3
   b) Sentence 4
   c) Sentence 5
   d) Sentence 6

Paragraph Two:

Drinking patterns are often set in high school. (2) Thus, the growing use of alcohol by adolescents and even **preadolescents** and the high rate of misuse and abuse are of increasing concern. (3) An estimated 1.3 million teenagers and preteens drink to excess. (4) Though casual drinking is found among all groups of teenagers, problem drinking is found more often among students who also engage in other types of deviant behaviour, who value and expect achievement less and esteem independence more than non-drinkers, and who are more tolerant of deviant

behaviour in others. (5) Girls with drinking problems are likely to have parent problems.

1. Which pattern of organization does the transition word 'Thus' in sentence 2 indicate?
    a) cause-effect
    b) classification
    c) definition
    d) contrast

2. What is the mode of discourse?
    a) Narration
    b) Description
    c) Exposition
    d) Persuasion

3. What is the author's purpose?
    a) to entertain
    b) to inform
    c) to persuade

4. The word 'preadolescents' in sentence 2 means
    a) the same as adolescents
    b) those younger than adolescents
    c) those older than adolescents
    d) old people

Paragraph Three:

There are many reasons why people lie. (2) One of the reasons for lying is to save face. (3) For example, you might pretend to remember someone at a party in order to save that person from the embarrassment of being forgotten. (4) A second reason for lying is to avoid tension or conflict. (5) You might, for instance, say you really like your friend's new hairstyle or a new outfit in order to prevent the hassle that would result if you expressed your real feelings. (6) Lies are also told in order to make everyday relationships run smoothly. (7) You might pretend to be glad to see someone you dislike, or you might fake interest in a person's boring stories just

to make a social event pass quickly. (8) An additional reason for lying is to expand or reduce relationships. (9) In one study, a majority of college students willingly lied to improve their chances of getting a date with an attractive partner. (10) Sometimes people lie to reduce interaction with others: "I really have to go. (11) I should study for a test tomorrow." (12) A final reason for lying is to gain power. (13) A person might turn down a last-minute request for a date by claiming to be busy, saying in effect, "Don't expect me to sit around waiting for you to call."

1. What is the mode of discourse?
    a) Narration
    b) Description
    c) Exposition
    d) Persuasion

2. Which sentence is the main idea?
    a) Sentence 1
    b) Sentence 2
    c) Sentence 8
    d) Sentence 12

3. Sentences 2, 4, 6, 8 and 10 use which pattern of organization?
    a) chronological order
    b) steps in a process
    c) listing
    d) classification

4. Sentences 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, and 13 provide
    a) comparisons
    b) contrasts
    c) examples
    d) classifications

Transition exercises:

Paragraph 1:
Choose from the following transitions to complete the gaps:

Because of/ while/ despite/ because/ on the contrary/ therefore/ however

If you lead a busy life, you are probably not getting enough vitamin C. Given the choice, most of us would rather relax with a cup of coffee, instead of peeling an orange. (1) _____, the cold and flu season is not over yet. Especially at this time of year, vitamin C is not just a necessity, but essential for helping maintain the immune system. (2) _____ the experts' acknowledgement that there is no real substitute for real fruit, our company discovered a new way to maximize the benefits of taking a daily dose of vitamin C. *Redaxon* makes this possible with a capsule. (3) _____ an orange a day may give the body a sudden burst of vitamin C, the effects do not last long- no matter how it is consumed. Vitamin C cannot be stored in the body for a long period of time (4) _____ its solubility in water. So, how does *Rexadon Slow Release* work? Each capsule contains hundreds of coated pellets made up of vitamin C. These pellets dissolve safely and gradually into your system. (5) _____, they provide a continuous and steady source of vitamin C over a period of eight hours. This will help you to maintain the body's natural defences and resistance to infection.

Paragraph 2:

therefore/ however/ in short/ such as/ contrary to this/ for example/ although / at first/ for instance/ prior to

Have you ever wondered how those big ocean storms called hurricanes or typhoons get their names? Who decides to name a hurricane 'Ann' or 'Barbara' or 'Bill'? The way hurricanes and typhoons are named has changed over the years. (1) _____ weather forecasters described them by their position in degrees of latitude or longitude. (2) _____, a typhoon used to be called '21.20 north, 157, 52 west'. (3) _____, this method was confusing because storms don't stay in the same place. (4) _____ people developed other ways to identify them. In the 60's, a weather forecaster in Australia used to name typhoons after politicians whom he disliked. (5) _____ , he could make weather forecasts

(6)_____ 'Typhoon Smith is on a very destructive path.' (7) _____ this caused criticism among the public, this trend continued to exist for quite a long time. (8) _____ this trend, during World War I, women's names began to be used like 'Hurricane Betsy' or 'Typhoon Alice'. (9) _____, during World War II, men's names became popular; a storm could be named 'Fred' or 'George'. (10) _____, we can say that the way hurricanes and typhoons are named has changed over the years and will undoubtedly change again.

University of Cyprus
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LAN 100

Read the following paragraphs and answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

(1) U.S. Census Bureau data on living patterns revealed that in 2000, for the first time, the number of Americans living alone exceeded the number of married couples living with children. (2) Not surprisingly, the number of single-parent households also continued to rise. (3) In addition, there was a staggering increase between 1990 and 2000 in the number of cohabitating couples.

1. What is the mode of discourse of this paragraph?
   (a) narration (b) description (c) exposition (d) persuasion
2. What is the author's purpose?
   (a) to entertain (b) to inform (c) to persuade
3. Which sentence is the main idea?
   (a) Sentence 1 (b) Sentence 2 (c) Sentence 3 (d) implied
4. What is the method of paragraph development used in this paragraph?
   (a) comparison (b) chronological order (c) example (d) cause and effect
5. "Cohabitating couples" are those that
   (a) are married (b) engaged to be married (c) live together (d) are divorced

(1) What kinds of changes might you expect in your own life that will affect your relationship with others? (2) You may change your job 10 or more times. (3) You may move your place of residence even more frequently. (4) You probably will be married at least once, and possibly two or three times. (5) You probably will have one child or more. (6) You will experience loss of family members through death and dissolution of relationships. (7) You may have a spouse whose needs conflict with your needs. (8) Other family members may view the world differently than you and challenge your perceptions. (9) When your life appears to be most stable and calm, unexpected changes will occur.

1. The best main idea for this paragraph is:
   (a) In your life, you will experience many kinds of changes that will affect your relationships.
   (b) No one's life is perfect.
   (c) If nothing bad happens to you, your life will be forever calm and stable.
   (d) Everyone wants to have someone else's life.
2. The mode of discourse in this paragraph is
   (a) narration (b) description (c) exposition (d) persuasion
3. What method of paragraph development is used in this paragraph?
   (a) contrast (b) example (c) enumeration (d) classification

4. The word "residence" in sentence 3 refers to
   (a) where you work (b) where you exercise (c) where you live (d) where you were born.
5. The word "spouse" in sentence 7 can best be replaced by:
   (a) husband or wife
   (b) lifelong partner
   (c) brother or sister
   (d) mother or father

(1) Victims of sexual aggression, including sexual harassment, are more likely to be female than male. (2) Rape- sexual intercourse forced upon a person by either psychological coercion or physical force- affects many more women than men. (3) More than 1 in 5 women report that they have been forced to do something of a sexual nature. (4) Contrary to popular myth, rape is not a crime committed in dark alleys by sexually frustrated strangers. (5) The vast majority of rapists---- as many as three-quarters or more--- are known to their victims. (6) Almost half (47 percent) of college women who are victims of rape are raped by dates or romantic partners.

1. The mode of discourse in this paragraph is
   (a) narration (b) description (c) exposition (d) persuasion
2. What pattern of organization is used in sentence 2?
   (a) classification (b) contrast (c) definition (d) steps in a process
3. The author's purpose is to
   (a) entertain (b) inform (c) persuade
4. The best main idea for this paragraph is
   (a) men commit more sexual crimes than women.
   (b) women, especially college women, need to be more selective about their dates and romantic partners because almost half of them who are rape victims are raped by those men.
   (c) victims of rape and other sexual crimes are predominately women and the rapist is known to them.
   (d) rape is widespread.
5. The author supports his main idea by providing
   (a) statistical information and examples
   (b) comparisons and contrasts
   (c) definition and classification
   (d) listing and examples

University of Cyprus
The Language Center
Instructor: Helen Stavrou
Final exam transition revision

Instructions: Read the following passage and then decide which of the following transitions fits each gap best:

also/ although/ because/ but/ even/ first/ however/ both/ such as/ as well as/ moreover/ similarly/ for example/ therefore

Advantages and Disadvantages of Online Learning

(1) _____ online learning has both advantages and disadvantages, the benefits far outweigh the drawbacks. Most of the disadvantages can be reduced through careful planning.

The (2) _____ and perhaps most obvious disadvantage of online classes is the lack of face-to-face interaction. Teachers cannot gauge their students' nonverbal reactions. (3) _____, students miss the teacher's non-verbal cues: tone of voice, pauses, and gestures. They cannot spontaneously ask a question or volunteer an answer. They (4) _____ have less opportunity to get acquainted with their fellow students.

To mitigate these disadvantages, teachers can post videos online so students can see and hear them almost as clearly as in a large class. They can also plan webinars in which students can ask questions and get answers in real time. (5) _____, by phone, Skype, or online chat. Lack of student interaction can be reduced by incorporating opportunities for students to introduce themselves and socialize (including through icebreaker type games) into the class schedule. Students can work on projects together or organize study groups via Skype, chat, or instant messaging.

The greatest advantage of online learning is its great expansion of opportunities to many whose access to traditional education was very limited due to things (6) _____ geography, income, or various disabilities. Online learning is accessible to anyone who has or can get the use of a computer, anywhere in the

world. It enables major reductions in school expenses for overhead (buildings and utilities), (7) _____ student expenses for transportation, texts, and sometimes living costs.

(8) _____ computers can accommodate physical limitations with text to speech, enlargeable print, foot or mouth-operated controls, and other adaptations, many students with disabilities have much better access to information than in traditional classrooms. (9) _____, slower students or language learners who need to hear material more than once can read or listen repeatedly and learn at their own pace.

The disadvantages of online learning can be reduced, (10) _____ its benefits are increasing with each new technology. (11) _____, online learning does not need to be either-or. In many cases it can be combined with traditional classroom learning to get the best of both worlds. Traditional classrooms can use online learning to get the best of (12) _____ worlds. Traditional classrooms can use online components like flipped learning to make the best use of teacher time. Online classes serving a fairly small geographic area can begin with an orientation on campus so students and teachers can meet and interact face-to-face. (13) _____ in international classes, groups of students in the same area can meet and socialize. The possibilities are limited only by teacher and student imagination. (14) _____, teachers and students should use their imaginations.

7 How to Make It in College, Now That You're Here

Brian O'Keeney

Preview

Give yourself some credit—you're now a college student! But getting into college is only the first step. It's time to plan not only how to deal with the academic demands of college, but also how to cope with the additional demands of family, friends, and work. Based on interviews with college students, this article offers you practical, realistic steps to college success.

Words to Watch

hurdle (1): difficulty
coping with (2): dealing with
queasy (3): upset
distracted (4): sidetracked
relatively (4): compared with something else
plod (7): walk slowly and heavily
maintain (13): keep
hermit (13): one who lives alone, apart from others
simmer down (21): calm down

1 Today is your first day on campus. You were a high-school senior three months ago. Or maybe you've been at home with your children for the last ten years. Or maybe you work full-time, and you're coming to school to start the process that leads to a better job. Whatever your background is, you're probably not too concerned today with staying in college. After all, you just got over the hurdle° (and the paperwork) of applying to this place and organizing your life so that you could attend. And today, you're confused and tired. Everything is a hassle, from finding the classrooms to standing in line at the bookstore. But read my advice anyway. And if you don't read it today, save this article. You might want to look at it a little further down the road.

2 By the way, if this isn't your first day, don't skip this article. Maybe you

haven't been doing as well in your studies as you'd hoped. Or perhaps you've had problems juggling your work schedule, your class schedule, and your social life. If so, read on. You're about to get the inside story on making it in college. On the basis of my own experience as a final-year student, and on dozens of interviews with successful students, I've worked out a no-fail system for coping with° college. These are the inside tips every student needs to do well in school. I've put myself in your place, and I'm going to answer the questions that will cross (or have already crossed) your mind during your stay here.

What's the Secret to Getting Good Grades?

3 It all comes down to getting those grades, doesn't it? After all, you came here for some reason, and you're going to need passing grades to get the credits or degree you want. Many of us never did much studying in high school; most of the learning we did took place in the classroom. College, however, is a lot different. You're really on your own when it comes to passing courses. In fact, sometimes you'll feel as if nobody cares if you make it or not. Therefore, you've got to figure out a study system that gets results. Sooner or later, you'll be alone with those books. After that, you'll be sitting in a classroom with an exam sheet on your desk. Whether you stare at that exam with a queasy° stomach, or whip through it fairly confidently, depends on your study techniques. Most of the successful students I talked to agreed that the following eight study tips deliver solid results:

4 **1. Set up a study place.** Those students you see "studying" in the cafeteria or game room aren't learning much. You just can't learn when you're distracted° by people and noise. Even the library can be a bad place to study if you constantly find yourself watching the clouds outside or the students walking through the stacks. It takes guts to sit, alone, in a quiet place in order to study. But you have to do it. Find a room at home or a spot in the library that's

relatively° quiet—and boring. When you sit there, you won't have much to do except study.

5 **2. Get into a study frame of mind.** When you sit down, do it with the attitude that you're really going to get this studying done. You're not going to doodle on your notebook or make a list for the supermarket. Decide that you're going to study and learn now, so that you can move on to more interesting things as soon as possible.

6 **3. Give yourself rewards.** If you sweat out a block of study time, and do a good job on it, treat yourself. You deserve it. You can "psych" yourself up for studying by promising to reward yourself afterward. A present for yourself can be anything from a favorite TV show to a relaxing bath to a dish of double-chocolate ice cream.

7 **4. Skim the textbook first.** Lots of students sit down with an assignment like "read chapter 5, pages 125–150" and do just that. They turn to page 125 and start to read. After a while, they find that they have no idea what they just read. For the last ten minutes, they've been thinking about their five-year-old or what they're going to eat for dinner. Eventually,' they plod° through all the pages but don't remember much afterward.

8 In order to prevent this problem, skim the textbook chapter first. This means the following: look at the title, the subtitles, the headings, the pictures, and the first and last paragraphs. Try to find out what the person who wrote the book had in mind when he or she organized the chapter. What was important enough to set off as a title or in bold type? After skimming, you should be able to explain to yourself what the main topics of the chapter are and even some of the main points. Unless you're the kind of person who would step into an empty elevator shaft without looking first, you'll soon discover the value of skimming.

5. Take notes on what you're studying. This sounds like a hassle, but it works. Go back over the material after you've read it, and jot down key words and phrases in the margins. When you review the chapter for a test, you'll have handy little things like "definition of rationalization" or "example of regression" in the margins. If the material is especially tough, organize a separate sheet of notes. Write down definitions, examples, lists, and main ideas. The idea is to have a single sheet or two that boil the entire chapter down to a digestible lump. 9

6. Review after you've read and taken notes. Some people swear that talking to yourself works. Tell yourself about the most important points in the chapter. Once you've said them out loud, they seem to stick better in your mind. If you can't talk to yourself about the material after reading it, that's a sure sign you don't really know it. 10

7. Take a break when you're tired. It's all right to let up for a bit when you've 11

had enough. You should try to make it through at least an hour, though. Ten minutes here and there are useless. When your head starts to pound and your eyes develop spidery red lines, quit. Rest for a bit with a short nap, and go back later.

12 **8. Take the college skills course if you need it.** Don't hesitate or feel embarrassed about enrolling in a study skills course. Many students say they wouldn't have made it without one.

How Can I Keep Up with All My Responsibilities without Going Crazy?

13 You've got a class schedule. You're supposed to study. You've got a family. You've got a husband, wife, boyfriend, child. You've got a job. How are you possibly going to cover all the bases in your life and maintain° your sanity? This is one of the toughest problems students face. Even if they start the semester with the best of intentions, they eventually find themselves tearing their hair out trying to do everything they're supposed to do. Believe it or not, though, it is possible to meet all your responsibilities. And you don't have to turn into a hermit° or give up your loved ones to do it.

14 The secret here is to organize your time. But don't just sit around half the semester planning to get everything together soon. Before you know it, you'll be confronted with midterms, papers, family, and work all at once. Don't let yourself reach that breaking point. Instead, try these three tactics:

15 **1. Prepare a monthly calendar.** Get one of those calendars with big blocks around the dates. Give yourself an overview of the whole term by marking down the due dates for papers and projects. Circle test and exam days. This way those days don't sneak up on you unexpectedly.

16 **2. Make up a study schedule.** Sit down during the first few days of this semester and make up a sheet listing the days and hours of the week. Fill in your work and class hours first. Then try to block out some study hours. It's better to study a little every day than to create a huge once-or-twice-a-week marathon session. Schedule study hours for your hardest classes for the times when you feel most energetic. For example, I battled my tax law textbook in the mornings; when I looked at it after 7:00 p.m., I might as well have been reading Chinese. The usual proportion, by the way, is one hour of study time for every class hour.

17 In case you're one of those people who get carried away, remember to leave blocks of free time, too. You won't be any good to yourself or anyone else if you don't relax and pack in the studying once in a while.

18 **3. Use "to-do" lists.** This is the secret that singlehandedly got me through college. Once a week (or every day if

you want to), make a list of what you have to do. Write down everything from "write English paper" to "buy cold cuts for lunch." The best thing about a "to-do" list is that it seems to tame all those stray "I have to" thoughts that nag at your mind. After you finish something on the list, cross it off. Don't be compulsive about finishing everything; you're not Superman or Wonder Woman. Get the important things done first. The secondary things you don't finish can simply be moved to your next "to-do" list.

What Can I Do If Personal Problems Get in the Way of My Studies?

19 One student, Roger, told me this story:

> Everything was going okay for me until the middle of the spring semester. I went through a terrible time when I broke up with my girlfriend and started seeing her best friend. I was trying to deal with my ex-girlfriend's hurt and anger, my new girlfriend's guilt, and my own worries and anxieties at the same time. In addition to this, my mother was sick and on a medication that made her really irritable. I hated to go home because the atmosphere was so uncomfortable. Soon, I started missing classes because I couldn't deal with the academic pressures as well as my own personal problems. It seemed easier to hang around my girlfriend's apartment than to face all my problems at home and at school.

20 And here's what another student, Marian, told me:

> I'd been married for eight years, and the relationship wasn't going too well. I saw the handwriting on the wall, and I decided to prepare for the future. I enrolled in college because I knew I'd need a decent job to support myself. Well, my husband had a fit because I was going to school. We were arguing a lot anyway, and he made it almost impossible for me to study at home. I think he was angry and almost jealous because I was drawing away from him. It got so bad that I thought about quitting college for a while. I wasn't getting any support at home, and it was just too hard to go on.

21 Personal troubles like these are overwhelming when you're going through them. School seems like the least important thing in your life. The two students above are perfect examples of this situation. But if you think about it, quitting or failing school would be the worst thing for these two students. Roger's problems, at least with his girlfriends, would simmer down° eventually, and then he'd regret having left school. Marian had to finish college if she wanted to be able to live independently. Sometimes, you've just got to hang tough.

22 But what do you do while you're trying to live through a lousy time? First of all, do something difficult. Ask yourself, honestly, if you're exaggerating small problems as an excuse to avoid classes and studying. It takes strength to admit this, but there's no sense in kidding yourself. You need to know if your problems are really bad in themselves or if you are perhaps making them worse than they are.

23 Second, if your problems are serious, and real, try to make some human contacts at school. Lots of students hide inside a miserable shell made of their own troubles and feel isolated and lonely. Believe me, there are plenty of students with problems. Not everyone is getting A's and having a fabulous social and home life at the same time. As you go through the term, you'll pick up some vibrations about the students in your classes. Perhaps someone strikes you as a compatible person. Why not speak to that person after class? Share a cup of coffee in the cafeteria, or walk to the parking lot together. You're not looking for a best friend or the love of your life. You just want to build a little network of support for yourself. Sharing your difficulties, questions, and complaints with a friendly person on campus can make a world of difference in how you feel.

24 Finally, if your problems are overwhelming, get some professional help. Why do you think colleges spend countless dollars on counseling departments and campus psychiatric services? More than ever, students all over the country are taking advantage of the help offered by support groups and therapy sessions. There's no shame attached to asking for help, either. In fact, almost 40 percent of college students (according to one survey) will use counseling services during their time in school. Just walk into a student center or counseling office and ask for an appointment. You wouldn't think twice about asking a dentist to help you get rid of your toothache. Counselors are paid—and want—to help you with your problems.

Why Do Some People Make It and Some People Drop Out?

25 Anyone who spends at least one semester in college notices that some students give up on their classes. The person who sits behind you in accounting, for example, begins to miss a lot of class meetings and eventually vanishes. Or another student comes to class without the assignment, doodles in his notebook during the lecture, and leaves during the break. What's the difference between students like this and the ones who succeed in school? My survey may be unscientific, but everyone I asked said the same thing: attitude. A positive attitude is the key to everything else—good study habits, smart time scheduling, and coping with personal difficulties.

26 What does "a positive attitude" mean? Well, for one thing, it means not

acting like a zombie. It means not only showing up for your classes, but also doing something while you're there. Really listen. Take notes. Ask a question if you want to. Don't just walk into a class, put your mind in neutral, and drift away to never-never land.

27 Having a positive attitude goes deeper than this, though. It means being mature about college as an institution. Too many students approach college classes like six-year-olds who expect first grade to be as much fun as *Sesame Street*. First grade, as we all know, isn't as much fun as *Sesame Street*. And college classes can sometimes be downright dull and boring. If you let a boring class discourage you so much that you want to leave school, you'll lose in the long run. Look at your priorities. You want a degree, or a certificate, or a career. If you have to, you can make it through a less-than-interesting class in order to achieve what you want. Get whatever you can out of every class. But if you simply can't stand a certain class, be determined to fulfill its requirements and be done with it once and for all.

28 After the initial high of starting school, you have to settle in for the long haul. If you follow the advice here, you'll be prepared to face the academic crunch. You'll also live through the semester without giving up your family, your job, or *Monday Night Football*. Finally, going to college can be an exciting time. As you learn things, the world truly becomes a more interesting place.

Vocabulary Questions

Use context clues to help you decide on the best definition for each italicized word. Then, in the space provided, write the letter of your choice.

_____ 1. In the excerpt below, the word *confronted* (kən-frŭnt′ĭd) means

A. delighted.
B. faced.
C. finished.
D. forgotten.

"But don't just sit around half the semester planning to get everything together soon. Before you know it, you'll be confronted with midterms, papers, family, and work all at once." (Paragraph 14)

_____ 2. In the excerpt below, the word *tactics* (tăk′tĭks) means

A. methods.
B. reasons.
C. requirements.
D. scenes.

"The secret here is to organize your time. . . . try these three tactics: 1. Prepare a monthly calendar. . . . 2. Make up a study schedule. . . . 3. Use 'to-do' lists. . . ." (Paragraphs 14–18)

_____ 3. In the sentence below, the word *compulsive* (kəm-pŭl′sĭv) means

A. overly concerned.
B. careless.
C. interested.
D. honest.

"Don't be compulsive about finishing everything; you're not Superman or Wonder Woman." (Paragraph 18)

_____ 4. In the excerpt below, the word *overwhelming* (ō′vər-hwĕl′mĭng) means

A. silly.
B. boring.
C. overpowering.
D. enjoyable.

"Personal troubles like these are overwhelming when you're going through them. School seems like the least important thing in life." (Paragraph 21)

_____ 5. In the excerpt below, the word *compatible* (kəm-păt′ə-bəl) means

A. unfriendly.
B. easy to get along with.
C. highly intelligent.
D. concerned only about himself or herself.

"Perhaps someone strikes you as a compatible person. Why not speak to that person after class? Share a cup of coffee in the cafeteria or walk to the parking lot together." (Paragraph 23)

Reading Comprehension Questions

Central Point and Main Ideas

_____ 1. Which sentence best expresses the central point of the selection?
- A. Going to college is exciting.
- B. There are ways to succeed in college and stay in control of your life.
- C. Most students are not concerned about staying in college.
- D. College can be confusing and tiring.

_____ 2. Which sentence best expresses the main idea of paragraph 27?
- A. First grade is less fun than kindergarten.
- B. College classes are sometimes quite boring.
- C. Students should be mature enough to tackle a class even when it's boring.
- D. A boring class encourages some students to leave school.

Supporting Details

_____ 3. The method of time control that was most helpful for the author was
- A. a monthly calendar.
- B. a study schedule.
- C. "to-do" lists.

Transitions

_____ 4. The sentence below expresses a relationship of
- A. illustration.
- B. comparison.
- C. contrast.
- D. cause and effect.

"Don't let yourself reach that breaking point. Instead, try these three tactics." (Paragraph 14)

_____ 5. The sentence below expresses a relationship of
A. illustration.
B. comparison.
C. contrast.
D. cause and effect.

"Soon, I started missing classes because I couldn't deal with the academic pressures as well as my own personal problems." (Paragraph 19)

Patterns of Organization

_____ 6. Just as paragraphs are organized according to patterns, so are groups of paragraphs. What is the main pattern of organization of paragraphs 3–12?
A. List of items
B. Time order
C. Definition and example
D. Comparison-contrast

_____ 7. Paragraph 19 combines the patterns of
A. list of items and contrast.
B. time order and cause-effect.
C. definition/example and time order.
D. definition/example and comparison.

_____ 8. TRUE OR FALSE? Paragraphs 26–27 contrast a positive attitude with a poor one.

Inferences

_____ 9. You can conclude that this article was written for
A. incoming college students who have just completed high school.
B. older students returning to college years after high-school graduation.
C. high-school students considering college.
D. students of any age who are beginning college.

_____ 10. The author suggests that many students who drop out of college
A. have only themselves to blame.
B. tried their best to do the work, but failed.
C. were good students in high school.
D. spent too much time making friends with classmates.

Coping With Nervousness
Pre-Task – Group Speaking
LAN 100

Group 1

1. **Discuss the coping mechanisms you each have for dealing with public speaking.**
   (consider what strategies, habits you have developed, whether these have been effective or not/why?why not?)
2. **Present these to the class.**

Coping With Nervousness
Pre-Task – Group Speaking
LAN 100

Group 2

1. **Discuss your past experiences with public speaking.**
   - What went wrong?
   - What went right?
2. **Present these to the class.**

Coping With Nervousness
Pre-Task – Group Speaking
LAN 100

Group 3

1. **Discuss what you admire in 'other' public speakers.**
   (be specific – what have you seen in others that you consider effective? What actually helps you as a viewer?)
2. **Present your feedback to the class.**

Coping With Nervousness
Pre-Task – Group Speaking
LAN 100

Group 4

1. **What are your biggest fears when faced with public speaking?**
   (be specific – what are you worried about?)
2. **Present your feedback to the class.**

Coping With Nervousness
Pre-Task – Group Speaking
LAN 100

Group 5

1. **Is being a good public speaker an important skill? Why? Why not?**
   (Where might you need such a skill? Why? Be specific.)
2. **Present your feedback to the class.**

6 Coping with Nervousness

Rudolph F. Verderber

Preview

Do you have trouble relaxing when you speak in front of a group? Do your legs tremble, does your heart pound, is your mouth dry? For many people, public speaking can be a nerve-racking experience. However, there are ways to deal with the nervousness. In this selection from his widely used college textbook *Communicate!* Seventh Edition, Rudolph F. Verderber provides information that may make your future speaking assignments less painful.

Words to Watch

virtually (2): almost
channel (3): direct
adrenaline (4): a hormone that stimulates and strengthens parts of the body
flabbergasted (5): amazed
eliciting (5): drawing out
psyching . . . up (9): preparing (oneself) psychologically
initial (10): first

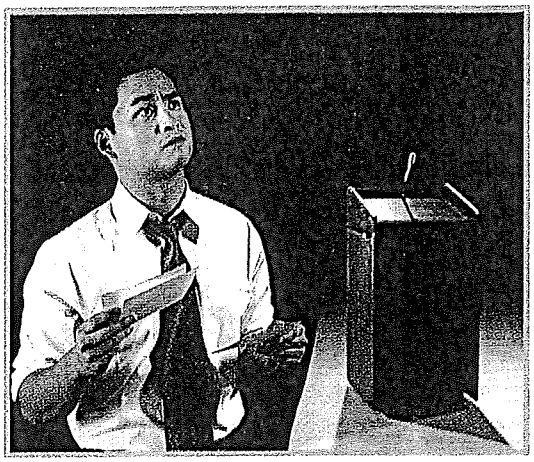
1 Most people confess to extreme nervousness at even the thought of giving a speech. Yet you must learn to cope with nervousness because speaking is important. Through speaking, we gain the power to share what we are thinking with others. Each of us has vital information to share: we may have the data needed to solve a problem; we may have an idea for a procedure that will save money for our company or group; we may have insights that will influence the way people see an issue. We can only imagine the tremendous loss to business, governmental, educational, professional, and fraternal groups because anxiety prevents people from speaking up.

2 Let's start with the assumption that you are indeed nervous—you may in fact be scared to death. Now what? Experience has proved that virtually° anyone can learn to cope with the fear of public speaking. Consider the following points:

3 **1. You are in good company.** Not only do most beginning speakers

suffer anxiety at the thought of speaking in public, but many experienced speakers confess to nervousness when they speak as well. Now, you may think, "Don't give me that line—you can't tell me that [fill in the name of a good speaker you know] is nervous when speaking in public!" Ask the person. He or she will tell you. Even powerful speakers like Abraham Lincoln and Franklin D. Roosevelt were nervous before speaking. The difference in nervousness among people is a matter of degree. Some people tremble, perspire, and experience shortness of breath and increased heartbeat. As they go through their speech, they may be so preoccupied with themselves that they lose contact with the audience, jump back and forth from point to point, and on occasion forget what they had planned to say. Others, however, may get butterflies in their stomachs and feel weak in the knees—and still go on to deliver a strong speech. The secret is not to get rid of all of your feelings but to learn to channel° and control your nervousness.

4 **2. Despite nervousness, you can make it through a speech.** Very few people are so bothered by anxiety that they are unable to proceed with the speech. You may not enjoy the experience—especially the first time—but you can do it. In fact, it would be detrimental if you were not



nervous. Why? Because you must be a little more aroused than usual to do your best. A bit of nervousness gets the adrenaline° flowing—and that brings you to speaking readiness.

5 **3. Your listeners aren't nearly as likely to recognize your fear as you might think.** "The only thing we have to fear," Franklin Roosevelt said, "is fear itself." Many speakers worry that others will notice how nervous they are—and that makes them even more self-conscious and nervous. The fact is that people, even speech instructors, will greatly underrate the amount of stage fright they believe a person has. Recently, a young woman reported that she broke out in hives before each speech. She was flabbergasted° when other students said to her, "You seem so calm when you speak." Try eliciting° feedback from your listeners after a speech. Once you realize that your audience does not perceive your nervousness to the degree that

you imagine, you will remove one unnecessary source of anxiety.

6 **4. The more experience you get in speaking, the better you become at coping with nervousness.** As you gain experience, you learn to think more about the audience and the message and less about yourself. Moreover, you come to realize that audiences, your classmates especially, are very supportive, especially in informative speech situations. After all, most people are in the audience because they want to hear you. As time goes on, you will come to find that having a group of people listening to you alone is a very satisfying experience.

7 Now let's consider what you can do about your nervousness. Coping with nervousness begins during the preparation process and extends to the time you actually begin the speech.

8 The best way to control nervousness is to pick a topic you know something about and are interested in. Public speakers cannot allow themselves to be saddled with a topic they don't care about. An unsatisfactory topic lays the groundwork for a psychological mindset that almost guarantees nervousness at the time of the speech. By the same token, selecting a topic you are truly interested in will help you focus on what you want to communicate and so lay the groundwork for a satisfying speech experience.

9 A second key to controlling nervousness is to prepare adequately for your speech. If you feel in command of your material and delivery, you'll be far more confident. During the preparation period, you can also be "psyching yourself up°" for the speech. Even in your classroom speeches, if you have a suitable topic, and if you are well prepared, your audience will feel they profited from listening to you. Before you say, "Come on, who are you trying to kid!" think of lectures, talks, and speeches you have heard. When the speaker seemed knowledgeable and conveyed enthusiasm, weren't you impressed? The fact is that some of the speeches you hear in class are likely to be among the best and most informative or moving speeches you are ever going to hear. Public speaking students learn to put time and effort into their speeches, and many classroom speeches turn out to be surprisingly interesting and valuable. If you work at your speech, you will probably sense that your class looks forward to listening to you.

10 Perhaps the most important time for coping with nervousness is shortly before you give your speech. Research indicates that it is during the period right before you walk up to give your speech and the time when you have your initial° contact with the audience that your fear is most likely to be at its greatest.

11 When speeches are being scheduled, you may be able to control when you speak. Are you better off "getting it over with," that is, being the first person to speak that day? If so, you may be able to volunteer to go first. But regardless of when you are scheduled to speak, try

not to spend your time thinking about yourself or your speech. At the moment the class begins, you have done all you can to be prepared. This is the time to focus your mind on something else. Try to listen to each of the speeches that come before yours. Get involved with what each speaker is saying. When your turn comes, you will be far more relaxed than if you had spent the time worrying about your own speech.

12 As you walk to the speaker's stand, remind yourself that you have ideas you want to convey, that you are well prepared, and that your audience is going to want to hear what you have to say. Even if you make mistakes, the audience will be focusing on your ideas and will profit from your speech.

When you reach the stand, pause 13 a few seconds before you start and establish eye contact with the audience. Take a deep breath to help get your breathing in order. Try to move about a little during the first few sentences—sometimes, a few gestures or a step one way or another is enough to break some of the tension. Above all, concentrate on communicating with your audience—your goal is to share your ideas, not to give a performance.

Basic Skill Questions

Vocabulary in Context

_____ 1. In the excerpt below, the word *detrimental* (dĕt′rə-mĕn′tl) means

A. helpful.
B. expensive.
C. harmful.
D. funny.

"Despite nervousness, you can make it through a speech. . . . In fact, it would be detrimental if you were not nervous. Why? Because you must be a little more aroused than usual to do your best." (Paragraph 4)

_____ 2. In the sentence below, the word *conveyed* (kən-vād′) means

A. prevented.
B. communicated.
C. forgot.
D. delayed.

"When the speaker seemed knowledgeable and conveyed enthusiasm, weren't you impressed?" (Paragraph 9)

Central Point and Main Ideas

_____ 3. Which sentence best expresses the central point of the selection?
- A. Nearly everyone feels nervous about speaking in public.
- B. It is possible to control the fear of public speaking.
- C. You can control your nervousness about speaking by picking a topic that interests you.
- D. Even famous speakers report feeling nervous before giving speeches.

_____ 4. Which sentence best expresses the main idea of paragraph 3?
- A. Nearly everyone gets nervous before giving a speech, but good speakers are able to channel and control their nervousness.
- B. Franklin D. Roosevelt and Abraham Lincoln were nervous before speaking.
- C. Giving a speech can be a stressful experience.
- D. Speakers who tremble, perspire, and experience shortness of breath and increased heartbeat may lose contact with the audience.

_____ 5. Which sentence best expresses the main idea of paragraphs 7–13?
- A. When preparing a speech, choose a topic you know something about and are interested in.
- B. You will feel far more confident about a speech if you prepare adequately for it.
- C. There are various things you can do to cope with nervousness during the preparation for and beginning of a speech.
- D. According to research, it is just before you walk up to give your speech and the time of your first contact with the audience that your fear is likely to be at its greatest.

Supporting Details

_____ 6. The supporting details in paragraphs 3–6 are
- A. reasons public speaking is important.
- B. suggestions for avoiding the fear of public speaking.
- C. evidence that people learn to deal with the fear of public speaking.
- D. steps in the process of public speaking.

_____ 7. Nervousness
- A. is rarely experienced by people who give speeches on a regular basis.
- B. can actually help a speaker to do his or her best.
- C. cannot be effectively controlled.
- D. always interferes with the effectiveness of a speech.

_____ 8. One way to control being nervous about a speech is to
A. speak loudly.
B. prepare adequately.
C. avoid eye contact.
D. all of the above.

Transitions

_____ 9. The sentence below expresses a relationship of
A. addition.
B. time.
C. cause and effect.
D. contrast.

"Despite nervousness, you can make it through a speech." (Paragraph 4)

_____10. The relationship of the second sentence below to the first is one of
A. addition.
B. illustration.
C. contrast.
D. cause and effect.

"As you gain experience, you learn to think more about the audience and the message and less about yourself. Moreover, you come to realize that audiences, your classmates especially, are very supportive, especially in informative speech situations." (Paragraph 6)

Patterns of Organization

_____11. The main pattern of organization of paragraphs 3–6 is
A. list of items.
B. time order.
C. contrast.
D. definition and example.

_____12. The main pattern of organization of paragraphs 7–13 is
A. time order.
B. contrast.
C. comparison.
D. definition and example.

LAN 100
FINAL EXAM REVISION
INSTUCTOR: Helen Stavrou

READING: Coping with Nervousness Rudolph F. Verderber

Vocabulary from Context
Find 'one' word which means the same as:

1. Crucial, extremely important (par1) _____
2. Hinders, impedes (par 1) _____
3. Shake, shiver (par 3) _____
4. Direct, guide (par 3) _____
5. Move on to, continue (par 4) _____
6. Excited, alert (par 4) _____
7. Burdened, loaded (par 8) _____
8. Foundation, basis (par 8) _____
9. Control (par 9) _____
10. Communicate, show (par 12) _____

Paraphrasing
Select the most appropriate paraphrase for the phrase given.

1. "Most people confess to extreme nervousness" (par 1)
   a) Some people show they are stressed
   b) All individuals express how anxious they are
   c) The majority of individuals admit to being acutely anxious
   d) A lot of people avoid being very stressed

2. "We may have insights that will influence the way people see an issue" (par 1)
   a) It's possible that we have an inner awareness which is sure to impact the manner in which others view a topic
   b) It might be the case that we have information to contradict how others understand things
   c) Perhaps we know a great deal about how others may feel about a subject
   d) Even if we have a deep understanding of how others affect the way we see things
3. "..they may be so preoccupied with themselves that they lose contact with the audience" (par 3)
   a) They could be too busy to notice those who are watching them
   b) They might be too confident about their performance, so they don't pay attention to the audience
   c) They might be self-focused to such an extent that they no longer communicate with those watching them
   d) They may have so much work to do that they can't interact with those who are watching
4. "In fact, it would be detrimental if you were not nervous" (par 4)
   a) But it could be scary if you didn't feel stress
   b) However, it may be understandable if you did not have any anxiety
   c) In truth, not feeling any anxiety would be damaging
   d) Although, it might be interesting if you felt no stress

9 Better, More Affordable Colleges Start Online

L. Rafael Reif

Preview

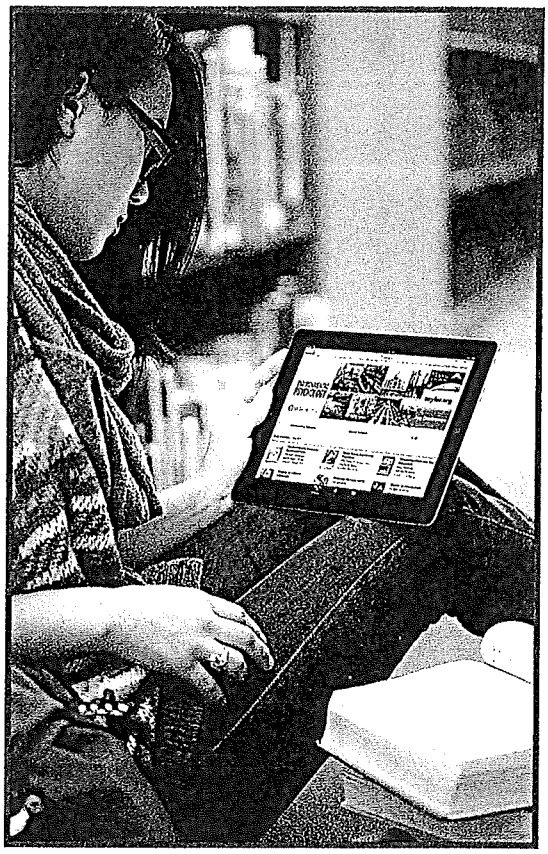
When we think of college, we tend to think of four years spent in classrooms, either living on campus or commuting to it daily. But according to L. Rafael Reif, president of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, it may be time to change the way we think. Online learning, once considered a second-best option to classroom learning, is proving to be as good as (and often better than) time spent sitting in a room full of other students.

Words to Watch

innovators (1): leaders, trendsetters
endowments (1): donations
subsidizing (1): supporting financially
unsustainable (1): weak, unable to support itself
eminent (4): well-known
exploit (4): take advantage of
quantify (5): to count or measure
credentialing (10): giving credit or, in this case, a diploma

1 Everyone would like a solution to the problem of rising college costs. While students worry that they cannot afford a college education, U.S. colleges and universities know they cannot really afford to educate them either. At a technology-intensive research university like the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, it now costs three times as much to educate an undergraduate as we receive in net tuition—that is, the tuition MIT receives after providing for financial aid. To push the research frontier and educate innovators° in science and engineering demands costly instrumentation and unique facilities. Even for institutions with substantial endowments°, subsidizing° a deficit driven by these and other costs is, in the long run, unsustainable°.

2 Some wonder whether today's online technologies—specifically, massive open online courses, or MOOCs, which can reach many thousands of students at a comparatively low cost—could be an answer. I am convinced that



digital learning is the most important innovation in education since the printing press. Yet if we want to know whether these technologies will make a college degree less expensive, we may be asking the wrong question. I believe they will; we are assessing this possibility at MIT even now. But first we should use these tools to make higher education better—in fact, to reinvent it. When the class of 2025 arrives on campuses, these technologies will have reshaped the entire concept of college in ways we cannot yet predict. Those transformations may change the whole equation, from access to effectiveness to cost.

3 To understand the potential, it's important to focus on what digital learning is good for. At least at the moment, it is surely not very good at replacing a close personal connection with an inspiring teacher and mentor. However, it is incomparably good at opening possibilities for billions of human beings who have little or no other access to higher learning. The global appetite for advanced learning is enormous: MIT OpenCourseWare—the initiative we started in 2002 to post virtually all our course materials for free online—has attracted 150 million learners worldwide. Today learners from every state in America and every nation on earth are actually taking MIT online classes; the edX platform we launched with Harvard 17 months ago has enrolled 1.25 million unique learners—10 times the number of living MIT graduates. With our edX partner institutions, we see an immense opportunity to help people transform their lives.

4 Yet digital learning also offers surprising advantages even for students with access to the best educational resources. First, digital technologies are remarkably good at teaching content: the basic concepts of circuits and electronics, the principles of chemistry, the evolution of architectural styles. At an online-learning summit at MIT, one eminent° professor of physics from a peer university explained that although he loves lecturing and receives top ratings in student reviews, he recently came to rethink his entire approach. Why? Because testing indicated that many students did not come away from his lectures ready to apply the concepts he aimed to teach. By contrast, comparable students taught through online exercises—including immediate

practice, feedback and reinforcement—retained the concepts better and were better prepared to put them into practice. With so much introductory material moving online, instructors can take time that was previously reserved for lectures and use it to exploit° the power of innovative teaching techniques. A 2011 study co-authored by physics Nobel laureate Carl Wieman at the University of British Columbia showed the benefits: when tested on identical material, students taught through a highly interactive "flipped classroom" approach did nearly twice as well as peers taught via traditional lectures.

5 Digital learning technologies offer a second advantage, which is harder to quantify° but is deeply appealing to both students and faculty: flexibility. Just as college traditionally requires four years at the same academic address, traditional courses require large groups of students to regularly gather at the same time and place. By making it possible to break the course content into dozens of small conceptual modules of instruction and testing, digital learning allows students to engage the material anytime, any day, as often as they need to, anywhere in the world. A student can now spend a year immersed in remote field research on an important problem while staying in sync with the courses in her major. A team of students working on a project can now reach for a new concept just at the moment they need it to solve a problem—the most powerful learning incentive of all.

6 And we are only beginning to benefit from a third advantage of digital learning: the ability to analyze and gain information from the vast data we are generating about how people actually learn best. By providing, on a huge scale, a systematic, data-driven way to learn about learning, online technologies will provide testable conclusions that could improve teaching methods and strategies for both online and in-person instruction.

For all the strengths of today's 7 digital technologies, however, we know that some things—perhaps the most important elements of a true education—are transmitted most effectively face-to-face: the judgment, confidence, humility, and skill in negotiation that come from hands-on problem solving and teamwork; the perseverance, analytical skill, and initiative that grow from conducting frontline lab research; the skill in writing and public speaking that comes from exploring ideas with mentors and peers; the ethics and values that emerge through being apprenticed to a master in your field and living as a member of a campus community.

Online learning may not help 8 students arrive at such lessons directly—but it may serve to clear the way. At MIT, faculty members experimenting with online tools to convey content in their courses are finding that it allows them more time to focus on education: detailed discussions, personal mentorship, project-based learning. They are developing a blended model that uses online tools strategically—and they are making education more

engaging and more effective for more students than it has ever been before.

9 Digital learning technologies present us with a tremendous opportunity to examine what college is good for, to imagine what colleges might look like in the future, and to strive for ways to raise quality and lower costs. To teach what is best learned in person, do we need four years on campus, or could other models be even more effective? Could the first year of course work be conducted online as a standard for admission? Or could online tools allow juniors to spend a year working in the field? Then there's the question of our physical campuses. MIT has about 200 lecture halls. How many will we need in 20 years—and what different learning spaces should campuses include instead? Should we develop a new kind of blended education that combines the best of online and in-person learning? Would this lead to a new, more customized and valuable model of residential education—and what changes should we make to maximize that value?

Once we answer these questions, 10 the college experience could look quite different in 10 or 20 years. I expect a range of options, from online credentialing° in many technical fields all the way to blended online and residential experiences that could be more stimulating and transformative than any college program in existence now. Higher education will have the tools to engage lifelong learners anywhere, overturning traditional ideas of campus and student body. I believe these experimental years will produce many possibilities, so that future learners will be able to choose what is best for them. If you're wondering how much these options will cost, a better question might be, How much will these options be worth? I strongly believe that by capitalizing on the strengths of online learning, we will make education more accessible, more effective, and more affordable for more human beings than ever before.

Basic Skill Questions

Vocabulary in Context

_____ 1. In the excerpt below, the word *transformations* (trăns'fər-mā'shənz) means

A. problems.
B. changes.
C. questions.
D. mysteries.

"When the class of 2025 arrives on campuses, these technologies will have reshaped the entire concept of college in ways we cannot yet predict. Those transformations may change the whole equation, from access to effectiveness to cost." (Paragraph 2)

_____ 2. In the sentence below, the word *massive* (măs′ĭv) means

A. expensive.
B. very large.
C. secret.
D. challenging.

"Some wonder whether today's online technologies—specifically, massive open online courses, or MOOCs, which can reach many thousands of students at a comparatively low cost—could be an answer." (Paragraph 2)

Central Point and Main Ideas

_____ 3. Which sentence best expresses the central point of this selection?

A. There are various aspects of live, in-person teaching and learning that cannot be replaced by online learning.
B. Online learning is becoming more popular primarily because it is less expensive and more convenient.
C. For several reasons, online learning may transform the way we think about acquiring a college education.
D. Because of the flexibility of online learning, people who thought they didn't have the time to go to college are now able to work toward a degree.

_____ 4. Which sentence best expresses the main idea of paragraph 3?

A. MIT has developed a popular program of online classes.
B. Online learning has dramatically changed the lives of people worldwide.
C. MIT has launched an online program that actually has more users than MIT has living graduates.
D. Although online learning cannot replace a live teacher, it provides learning opportunities for people worldwide.

_____ 5. Which sentence best expresses the main point of paragraph 5?

A. A main advantage of online learning is flexibility.
B. Students taking online classes are free to learn whenever they want.
C. Traditional learning forces students to gather in classrooms, but online learning does not.
D. With online learning, a student can be doing research in a foreign land and still take classes.

Supporting Details

_____ 6. A recent study revealed that students taught through an online course

A. did not do as well as students taught through traditional lectures.
B. did almost twice as well as students taught through traditional lectures.
C. paid only half as much as they would have paid for an on-campus course.
D. did not tend to complete the course as quickly.

_____ 7. It is difficult for online learning to replace skills acquired from
A. face-to-face negotiation.
B. experience in public speaking.
C. values acquired from working with a master in your field.
D. all of the above.

_____ 8. Digital technologies are particularly good at teaching
A. basic content.
B. foreign students.
C. advanced and complex courses.
D. students how to organize their time.

Transitions

_____ 9. The sentence below expresses a relationship of
A. cause and effect.
B. comparison.
C. addition.
D. illustration.

"Just as college traditionally requires four years at the same academic address, traditional courses require large groups of students to regularly gather at the same time and place." (Paragraph 5)

_____10. The relationship of the second sentence below to the first sentence is one of
A. contrast.
B. addition.
C. comparison.
D. cause and effect.

"At least at the moment, [digital learning] is surely not very good at replacing a close personal connection with an inspiring teacher and mentor. However, it is incomparably good at opening possibilities for billions of human beings who have little or no other access to higher learning." (Paragraph 3)

Patterns of Organization

_____11. Two main patterns of organization in this selection are
A. cause and effect / comparison and contrast.
B. series of events / cause and effect.
C. list of items / comparison and contrast.
D. definition and example / cause and effect.

Selection 2

Read the *Preview* and check the *Words to Watch* below. Then you should make a deliberate effort to read at a faster rate. You should *will* your eyes to move faster, and you should *will* your brain to process the incoming facts, ideas, and details more quickly.

If you are not already doing so, sit up straight, put your feet flat on the floor, and hold the book at a comfortable angle. Consciously force your eyes to move at a higher rate of speed. Make the decision that you are going to read faster, and do it.

Learning to Keep Your Cool during Tests

Margaret Jerrard

Preview

If the word *test* fills you with as much anxiety as a visit to the dentist, take heart: Help is available. There are effective ways to deal with test-related anxiety. This selection outlines some of the best.

Words to Watch

secreted (line 6): formed and released

peripheral sight (line 9): the ability to see beyond the edges of the line of direct sight

optimum (line 30): most favorable

keyed up (line 32): excited or tense

interspersing (line 40): doing at varying intervals

intuitive (line 52): done without reasoning

Have you ever felt so panicky during an examination that you couldn't even put down the answers you *knew*? If so, you were suffering from what is known as test anxiety.

According to the psychologist Ralph Trimble, test anxiety is a very real problem for many people. When you're worried over your performance on an exam, your heart beats faster, your pulse speeds up, hormones are secreted. These reactions trigger others: You may sweat more than you normally do or suffer from a stomachache or headache. Your field of vision narrows and becomes tunnel-like, leaving you with very little peripheral sight. Before you know it, you're having difficulty focusing.

"What I hear students say over and over again," says Dr. Trimble, who is associated with the Psychological and Counseling Center at the University of Illinois, "is, 'My mind went blank.'"

For a number of years, Dr. Trimble helped many students learn how to function better during exams and to bring up their grades. Some of these students were interested in sharing what they learned and, with Trimble's help, began holding workshops on overcoming test anxiety. For many students, just being in a workshop with other sufferers was a relief. They realized they weren't freaks, that they were not the only ones who had done poorly on tests because of tension. The workshops were so successful that they are still given.

In the workshops, students are taught that anxiety is normal. You just have to prevent it from getting the best of you. The first step is to learn to relax. If before or during an examination you start to panic, stretch as hard as you can, tensing the muscles in your arms and legs; then suddenly relax all of them. This will help relieve tension.

But keep in mind that you don't want to be too relaxed. Being completely relaxed is no better than being too tense. "If you are so calm you don't *care* how you do on an examination, you won't do well," Trimble says. "There is an optimum level of concern when you perform at your best. Some stress helps. There are people who can't take even slight stress. They have to learn that in a challenging situation, being keyed up is good and will help them to do better. But if they label it anxiety and say, 'It's going to hit me again,' that will push them over the edge."

As a student you must also realize that if you leave too much studying until a day or two before the examination, you can't do the impossible and learn it all. Instead, concentrate on what you *can* do and try to think what questions are likely to be asked and what you can do in the time left for studying.

When you sit down to study, set a moderate pace and vary it by interspersing reading, writing notes, and going over any papers you have already written for the course, as well as the textbooks and notes you took in class. Review what you know. Take breaks and go to sleep in plenty of time to get a good night's rest before the exam. You should also eat a moderate breakfast or lunch, avoiding drinks with caffeine and steering clear of fellow students who get tense. Panic is contagious.

Get to the exam room a few minutes early so that you will have a chance to familiarize yourself with the surroundings and get out your supplies. When the examination is handed out, read the directions twice and underline the significant instructions, making sure you understand them. Ask the instructor or proctor to explain if you don't. First answer the easiest questions, then go back to the more difficult. If you are stumped on a multiple-choice question, first eliminate the impossible answers, then make as good an intuitive guess as possible and go on to the next.

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On essay questions, instead of plunging right in, take a few minutes to organize your thoughts, make a brief outline, and then start off with a summary sentence. Keep working steadily, and even when time starts to run out, don't speed up.

After the examination is over, don't torture yourself by thinking over all the mistakes you made, and don't start studying immediately for another exam. Instead, give yourself an hour or two of free time.

Among the students who are working now as volunteer leaders in the workshops are a number who started out panicky and unable to function on exams. They learned how to deal with test anxiety and are now teaching others. It's almost as easy as ABC.

Time: _____ *Reading Rate (see page 522):* _____ *WPM*

Reading Comprehension

1. Which would be a good alternative title for this selection?
   a. How to Overcome Test Anxiety
   b. The Physical Side of Anxiety
   c. How to Get Better Grades
   d. Why Students Are Concerned about Grades
2. Which sentence best expresses the main idea of the selection?
   a. Most students suffer from test anxiety.
   b. Test anxiety can be controlled.
   c. Being relaxed is essential to doing well on exams.
   d. All students should attend stress-management workshops.
3. If you start to panic during a test, you should
   a. leave the room briefly.
   b. drink a cup of coffee.
   c. stretch and then relax your arms and legs.
   d. skip the essay questions.
4. The first thing to do when you receive the exam is to
   a. answer the questions you are sure of.
   b. underline the important instructions.
   c. make an outline of what you know.
   d. begin timing yourself.

5. *True or false?* _____ Anxiety can cause a well-prepared student to perform poorly on a test.
6. From the selection we can conclude that
   a. textbooks make better study guides than class notes do.
   b. anxiety is learned behavior that can be unlearned.
   c. students who do poorly in tests may need eyeglasses.
   d. good students are completely calm before tests.
7. Which of the following tips is *not* mentioned in the article?
   a. Do easy questions first.
   b. Organize your thoughts before starting to write an essay answer.
   c. Ask the instructor to explain unclear directions.
   d. Budget your time for each part of the test.
8. The author implies that
   a. you should get to the exam room at the last minute in order to avoid panicky students.
   b. you should never guess on an exam.
   c. caffeine can increase anxiety.
   d. if you have kept up with the work, there's no need to study for the test.

Number Wrong: _____ *Score:* _____

0 wrong = 100%	2 wrong = 75%	4 wrong = 50%	6 wrong = 25%
1 wrong = 88%	3 wrong = 63%	5 wrong = 38%	7 wrong = 13%

Critical Thinking and Discussion

1. According to the selection, what are some of the symptoms of test anxiety? What symptoms of anxiety have you most frequently observed in yourself or others?
2. Do you practice any of the anxiety-relieving techniques described in the selection? Can you recommend any others that might be helpful to your fellow students?
3. The selection advises people with test anxiety to avoid fellow students who also get tense, noting "Panic is contagious." Do you think this is true? Does it matter what kind of people surround you as you prepare for or take an exam?

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LAN 100

PART A: Reading Comprehension

Instructions: Read both articles and answer the multiple choice, vocabulary and paraphrasing questions for each.

In a world of digital bystanders the challenge is for all of us to design engaging online education

October 12, 2020 7.45pm BST

By Steven Warbuton, Mahhumad Zuhdi, Stephen Dobson

https://theconversation.com/in-a-world-of-digital-bystanders-the-challenge-is-for-all-of-us-to-design-engaging-online-education-147195

1. We are increasingly becoming digital bystanders, continually monitoring our different palm-and-TV-sized screens. From dawn to dusk and even in moments of insomnia we turn to digitally communicated news and social media. In the world of education, from primary school to university and beyond, we have realised digital learning is not only an option for learning, but is fast becoming the main option.

2. Consider this vignette: during the COVID-19 pandemic a family is living in a big city where access to stable digital streams and affordable data bundles is not a problem. Confined to long periods of school learning now moved online, one of the parents asked their daughter about her experience. She says:

It is boring and I learn almost nothing. Teachers give a lot of instructions with little explanation.
She had become a digital bystander. The teacher struggled to engage with all students, and few experienced rich interactions with the teacher.

3. In the digital world it is not simply about learning the skills (digital self-help manuals and videos are plentiful). Many teachers and professors still argue that a face-to-face experience is more authentic than digitally mediated learning.

Time for a change of mindset

4. So how do we accommodate this changing digital world? Historically, when railway travel arrived, looking at the world through a window as it sped by was an unnerving experience. So, too, was the fear of being part of or witnessing a railway accident. It took people time to catch up and change their mindsets.

5. The same is true of digitally driven change in education. We cannot take time out from change. What is required is "reflection in action", as Donald Schon put it, to work out how to adjust to changes.

6. When we consider our vignette, how can we win the hearts and minds of students and teachers to ensure they both perceive and experience learning online as meaningful and transformative? Is this a question of challenging the traditional mindset described above?

7. By exploring the ways in which face-to-face learning is translated into online learning, we can start to identify a series of approaches on a spectrum from simple technological substitution to more radical redefinitions of teaching. In this model of substitution, augmentation, modification and redefinition, we tend to find many educators remain firmly rooted in using technology to replace what they already do in the classroom. As a result, the human essence of the teaching experience is lost when mediated via a digital interface.

8. An example here might be the distribution of electronic classnotes to replace the course textbook. The result is a learning setting that's clunky compared to the day-to-day user experience of the internet. The mismatch exemplified here in the transition from the physical classroom to online is often not well managed.

9. A learner's experiences of the digital education space can be dramatically different to the seamless and frictionless user experiences of a social internet. Within a paradigm of replacement versus reinvention, we have a natural gap between the experiences of teachers and students.

A need for inclusive design for online

10. Neither better access to technology nor more training to use digital systems will bridge this gap. This is a design gap. In recognising this, the solution becomes more straightforward – there is an absolute need to "design for online", as Cathy Stone persuasively argues.

11. But this design cannot be the sole responsibility of the teacher. We need to bring together multiple perspectives and skills, including those of teachers, students and technologists, to co-design learning experiences.

12. No longer is the teacher the sole voice of authority. All contribute: the teacher skilled in curriculum, the student understanding what it means to be supported and motivated to learn, and the technologist sharing modes of digital delivery.

13. There are then no digital bystanders – all have agency as designers. As Herbert A. Simon once said, anyone who is engaged in "changing existing situations into preferred ones" is a designer.

14. There is no global template for designing for online learning. Each time we come together – the teacher, student, technologist – we form a new community with a shared discourse. This is a reflective and democratic space that allows us to act with consideration and respect for the skills and knowledge of others.

15. With historical hindsight, we will do well to reconsider what the railway journey offered: the ability to visually reflect upon and design a personal world without leaving the carriage. With the digital production of teaching and learning, we too are now called upon to reflect upon and design a world of learning without leaving our seat in front of a digital screen.

Multiple Choice (8 x 3 = 24)

Select the most appropriate answer and place the letter of your choice neatly in the space provided.

1. _____ The overall main idea of the text is:
   (a) online education is less effective than face to face education
   (b) teachers are solely responsible for ensuring the success of their online classes
   (c) the success of online education depends on teachers, students and technologists
   (d) online education is far superior to face to face teaching
2. _____ The mode of discourse is:
   (a) narration
   (b) description
   (c) exposition
   (d) persuasion
3. _____ The author's purpose is to:
   (a) inform
   (b) persuade
   (c) entertain
4. _____ The main idea in paragraph 4 is:
   (a) change necessitates time and patience
   (b) change often brings negative results
   (c) most people can't get used to change
   (d) change is inevitable
5. _____ Which two patterns of organization are used in paragraph 8?
   (a) comparison and contrast
   (b) examples and cause and effect
   (c) classification/division and definition
   (d) chronological order and definition
6. _____ Which pattern of organisation is used in the first sentence of paragraph 11?
   (a) cause and effect
   (b) comparison
   (c) contrast

(d) definition

7. _____ Which word can be used to replace the word 'clunky' as it is used in paragraph 8?
   (a) comfortable
   (b) awkward
   (c) new
   (d) familiar
8. _____ The authors would most likely disagree with which of the following:
   (a) nobody is just an onlooker in the world of online education
   (b) reflection is needed in order for improvement to take place
   (c) there is a fixed path to follow for the future of online education
   (d) there is potential for improvements in online education

Vocabulary from context (6 x 1 = 6)
Find a word (ONE WORD) which means the same as each of the following:

1. evaluating, assessing (p1.) _____
2. restricted (p.2) _____
3. unsettling, upsetting (p.4) _____
4. drastic, major (p.7) _____
5. views, sides (p.11) _____
6. create, make (p.14) _____

Paraphrasing (3 x3 = 9)
Rewrite the phrases below in your own words.

1. The teacher struggled to engage with all students (p.2)
   _____
   _____
2. So how do we accommodate this changing digital world? (p.4)
   _____
   _____
3. the solution becomes more straightforward (p. 10)
   _____
   _____

Universities have invested in online learning – and it can provide students with value for money
October 2, 2020 1.50pm BST

By Kyungmee Lee

https://theconversation.com/universities-have-invested-in-online-learning-and-it-can-provide-students-with-value-for-money-147061

(1)As the coronavirus pandemic continues, so does universities' reliance on online teaching, prompting complaints from students that they are not getting full value from tuition fees. Students who have returned to campus fear that their university experience as a whole is being diminished.

(2) Manchester Metropolitan University has moved first-year teaching online as students self-isolate. The University and College Union has urged universities to teach online until Christmas, and MPs in Leeds have asked the University of Leeds to teach online.

(3) A petition is circulating which calls on the UK government to authorise refunds for tuition fees. It states: "The quality of online lectures is not equal to face-to-face lectures. Students should not have to pay full tuition fees for online lectures, without experiencing university life."

(4) There is no doubt that student experience as a whole will not be the same if universities move entirely online. But we must not assume that online teaching is automatically inferior to face-to-face teaching. Universities can provide students with engaging and invaluable learning experiences online.

(5) The question of whether online learning provides value for £9,000 a year tuition fees is not an easy one to answer, since each student will have a unique experience and value can only be assessed in the long term.

(6) Nevertheless, universities and staff are putting a significant amount of investment – in terms of money, technology, expertise, effort and time – into online teaching. On the part of academics, the costs of online teaching have already exceeded those of face-to-face teaching since it requires a considerable amount of training and extra hours of work.

Staff effort

(7) The overnight shift to online learning in spring 2020 led to frustration and students' concerns over the quality of online learning in the 2020/21 academic year are understandable. But in preparation for the new academic year universities have invested in providing their staff with the skills needed for online teaching.

(8) Working with a team of educational developers, I delivered an intensive course on online teaching at Lancaster University over the summer. Despite the extra workload, staff participation in the course was remarkably high. Participants were very serious about ensuring student success online and

spent hours re-learning how to teach. All those staff hours add up – staff training for online teaching has been very costly.

(9) Both universities and academics have realised that teaching online is not as simple as providing hour-long online lectures. For each course, online tutors need to think through an entire sequence of learning activities and carefully structure learner experiences around them – readings, lectures, discussions and assessments.

(10) Each online learning activity takes time and energy to develop. Students may not be aware of how much effort has been put into a short video. As a lecturer who took part in my summer course said:

(11) *The ability to pre-record (and thus re-record) material has led me to strive for perfection. In a normal lecture, there are no opportunities to go back, but when I'm sat at my desk at home, the possibilities are endless. Obviously, any improvement is good for students, but it has come at a great cost to my time.* Besides, online teaching is a team endeavour, requiring diverse expertise. Universities have hired a huge number of digital learning specialists and learning designers.

(12) This also requires more work to coordinate at a degree programme and department level. At a basic level, student workload across different modules needs to be managed, and live session schedules should not clash.

Always online

(13) Unlike face-to-face activities restricted by time and space, online learning allows students to access course materials and engage with learning activities whenever they want. From private chats on Microsoft Teams to quick meetings on Zoom, online communication tools make one-on-one interaction easy and convenient. Students appreciate the flexible and personal elements of online learning.

(14) But as students adapt to a new way of learning at a distance they also require more pastoral support from online tutors. All of this means that tutors often find themselves monitoring and supporting students' learning all the time – and spending a lot more time teaching online than they would in a lecture theatre.

(15) Many academics have found that their balance of teaching and research has been upended as their teaching hours rapidly increase. This further increases the costs of online teaching.

Value for money

(16) The UK government responded to the petition requesting tuition fee refunds as follows: "Higher education providers must deliver high-quality courses. If students are unhappy, they should first complain to their provider, or the Office of the Independent Adjudicator for Higher Education."

(17) This sort of response can establish a problematic understanding of the relationship between universities and students. Universities are educational providers, but not vendors of a product like Amazon or other retailers.

(18) University education, whether online or face to face, is not a pre-made product. Universities are, without doubt, responsible for excellent student experiences, but students also actively shape and transform their own experience.

(19) Tutors genuinely care for student success and strive for excellence in their teaching. Universities must put their best efforts into supporting their students and tutors. It is important to develop a relationship of trust between universities, tutors, and students, and for all to work together to make online learning a success.

Multiple Choice (8 x 3 = 24)

Select the most appropriate answer and place the letter of your choice neatly in the space provided.

1. _____ The overall main idea of the text is
   a) universities worldwide have spent a lot of money on online learning
   b) institutions, educators and learners must collaborate to ensure successful online learning
   c) the success of online learning depends mostly on the level of student involvement
   d) teacher and student workloads have increased exponentially

2. _____The author's specific purpose is
   a) urge universities to continue offering online learning
   b) stress the need for collaboration between all parties involved with online learning
   c) inform the reader of the advantages and disadvantages of online learning
   d) explain why online learning is so successful

3. _____What is the mode of writing?
   a) narration
   b) description
   c) exposition
   d) persuasion

4. _____The transition word 'but' in paragraph 4 signals
   a) comparison
   b) contrast
   c) cause-effect

d) enumeration

5. _____Which pattern of organization is used in the last sentence of paragraph 6?
   a) classification
   b) example
   c) contrast
   d) cause-effect
6. _____In paragraph 9, 'reading, lectures, discussions and assessments' are
   a) examples of learning activities
   b) the steps in a process needed to complete an online course
   c) the result of the tutor's extra hours
   d) a classification of the work students need must submit to their tutors

7. _____What is the relationship between the first part of sentence 1 and the second part of sentence 1 in paragraph 13?
   a) classification
   b) example
   c) comparison
   d) contrast

8. _____The author believes that
   a) universities will never go back to face to face teaching
   b) tutors' preparation time is less when teaching online
   c) online education can offer students valuable experiences
   d) online learning has more disadvantages to traditional learning environments

Vocabulary from context (6 x 1 = 6)
Find a word (ONE WORD) which means the same as each of the following:

1. reduced (p. 1-2) - _____
2. motivating (p. 4-6) - _____
3. evaluated (p. 4-6)- _____
4. collide (p. 11-12)- _____
5. not rigid (p. 13-14)- _____
6. regulating (p. 14-15) _____

Paraphrasing (3 x3 = 9)
Rewrite the phrases below in your own words.

1. 'As the coronavirus pandemic continues, so does universities' reliance on online teaching' (p. 1)

_____
_____

2. 'But we must not assume that online teaching is automatically inferior to face-to-face teaching' (p. 4)

_____
_____

3. 'requiring diverse expertise' (p. 11)

_____
_____

Part B: Transitions and Writing

Transitions/phrases (8 x 1 = 8)
Fill in the spaces in the text below with the appropriate transitions/phrases from the box. 2 will not be used.

next	although	in contrast	despite	another
but	compared	firstly	however	divided

University stressors

As a university student, there are many daily sources of stress to overcome. 1._____, there is the stress of daily studying, homework and preparation for class. 2. _____ you must deal with the graded tests and assignments which seem to pop up every few weeks and which require a great deal of work. 3. _____ stressor is the preparation of presentations which are sometimes individual and sometimes group tasks. These are quite demanding and require a lot of time and effort. Personally, I prefer individual presentations 4. _____ these taking up so much of my time. 5. _____, my best friend Angie hates individual presentations as she dislikes all the focus being on her while she is delivering her presentation. All of the stressors mentioned so far 6. _____, are nothing 7. _____ to the stress of final exams. These create so much anxiety for many students 8. _____ are necessary if you want to pass your courses.

Writing (1 x 15 = 15)

Choose ONE of the following and write a comparison/contrast /. You will be graded on content, organization, format, sentence structure, vocabulary, grammar, spelling, punctuation etc. at the B2/B2+ level of the CEFR:

1. What are the differences and/or similarities between online and face to face learning?
2. Compare and contrast your experiences with online instructors to your experiences with face to face instructors.

MOCK MIDTERM EXAM

STUDENT NAME: _____

STUDENT ID: _____

SECTION: _____

INSTRUCTOR: _____

University of Cyprus
Language Centre

Language Exam
LAN 100 MOCK Midterm
Spring 2026
B2

SECTIONS	ACTIVITIES	DURATION	POINTS
I	Reading comprehension and linguistic competence	120 minutes	100
II	Answer Sheet		

INSTRUCTIONS

- Use black or blue ink
- Fill in the COVER SHEET and ANSWER SHEET with your name, and student ID number and section.
- Answer all questions
- Total time to complete: 120 minutes

SECTION I – READING COMPREHENSION AND LINGUISTIC COMPETENCE [100 POINTS]

INSTRUCTIONS

You are advised to spend 120 minutes answering the questions in this section.
While you are reading, write your answers here on the question paper.
Answer all the questions.
Give only one answer for each question.
Copy your answers onto the answer sheet at the end of the exam (items 1 - 50).

Transitions/Transitional Phrases

You are working as an editor for an online magazine.

Choose the best answer for each missing word in items 1-5 (A, B, C, D, E, or F).
Important: there is one extra word that you will not use!

Item 1	Physics is a constantly evolving field that shapes our understanding of the universe. _____, advancements in quantum mechanics have led to groundbreaking technologies like quantum computing.
Item 2	_____, researchers have developed more precise measurement tools, enabling them to study subatomic particles in greater detail.
Item 3	_____, classical mechanics still plays a crucial role in engineering and everyday applications.
Item 4	_____, the integration of physics with other disciplines, such as chemistry and biology, has opened new frontiers in research.
Item 5	_____, mastering fundamental physics concepts is essential for students aiming to contribute to scientific progress and technological innovation.

	therefore	nevertheless	in contrast	furthermore	moreover	for example
Item 1	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 2	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 3	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 4	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 5	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍

Reading Comprehension I

Read the article below and decide the best answer for each of the questions that follow.

Choose the best answer for items 6-15 (A, B, C or D).

Bacteria in your mouth may hold clues to your brain health and dementia risk – new study

Published: February 5, 2025 7.07am GMT

Author Joanna L'Heureux

Bacteria in your mouth may hold clues to your brain health and dementia risk – new study

(1) Could the bacteria in your mouth predict whether you are at risk of dementia? Emerging research suggests that the bacteria living on your tongue and gums may affect how the brain works and how it changes as we age. In turn, this could affect whether someone ages normally or develops dementia.

(2) Scientists are uncovering surprising connections between the oral microbiome, which is the bustling ecosystem of bacteria in our mouths, and brain health. A new study my colleagues and I conducted suggests that certain bacteria may help memory and thinking skills, while others could be early warning signs of a decline in brain function.

(3) This raises the possibility that diet and treatments that change our oral bacteria could one day play a role in helping to preserve brain health as we age.

(4) For our investigation, we analysed saliva samples from 115 adults over 50 years old. Among these people, 52% had healthy brain function, and the other 48% had early signs of decline in memory and other brain functions.

(5) We examined the bacteria in these samples and showed that people who had large numbers of two groups of bacteria called *Neisseria* and *Haemophilus* performed better in brain health tests. In particular, people with these bacteria had better memory, and better ability to pay attention and perform complex tasks. These people also had higher levels of the ion nitrite in their mouths. Nitrite is made by bacteria when they break down nitrate, which is a natural part of a vegetable-rich diet.

(6) Bacteria can also break down nitrite to produce nitric oxide, which improves circulation, including blood flow to the brain. This suggests that eating lots of nitrate-rich vegetables, such as leafy green spinach and rocket, could boost levels of healthy bacteria and help improve brain health, which might be especially important as people age.

(7) We are now investigating whether nitrate-rich beetroot juice can improve brain function in older adults by hijacking bacteria in the mouth.

(8) **On the other hand**, a different group of bacteria may be causing more harm than good. Our study found two groups of bacteria that are potentially linked to worse brain health.

(9) One group called *Porphyromonas*, which is often associated with gum disease, was more common in people with memory problems than people who were healthy.
A second group called *Prevotella* was linked to low nitrite, which in turn could mean poorer brain health. *Prevotella* was also more common in people who carry the gene APOE4, which is associated with an increased risk of Alzheimer's. These findings suggest that some bacteria might play a detrimental role in changes in brain health as people age. It also raises the question of whether routine tests to measure levels of these bacteria could be used to detect very early signs of declining brain health as part of dental checkups in the future.

Profound implications

(10) **The implications of this research are profound**. If certain bacteria support brain health while others contribute to decline, then treatments to change the balance of bacteria in the mouth could be part of a solution to prevent dementia.

(11) Encouraging the growth of nitrite-producing bacteria like *Neisseria*, while reducing *Prevotella* and *Porphyromonas*, could help maintain brain function as we age. This could be achieved through dietary changes, probiotics, oral hygiene routines, or even targeted treatments that reshape the microbiome. While we're still in the early stages of understanding the intricate links between the mouth bacteria and the brain, our findings provide a strong rationale for further research.

(12) If future studies confirm that the oral microbiome plays a role in maintaining a healthy brain, then by paying closer attention to the bacteria in our mouths we may unlock new possibilities for detecting and potentially delaying dementia.

(13) In the meantime, the best advice is to keep your teeth clean, see the dentist regularly and eat food with lots of nitrate, like leafy green vegetables, to keep feeding the good bacteria in your mouth.

Item 6 **Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the text?**

A ❍ The bacteria in the mouth have no significant effect on brain health.
B ❍ Scientists have proven that oral bacteria are the primary cause of dementia.
C ❍ Certain bacteria in the mouth may support brain health, while others may contribute to cognitive decline.
D ❍ Dental hygiene has no connection to memory and brain function.

Item 7 **The author's purpose in the text is to.....**

A ❍ ... persuade readers to buy probiotic supplements for oral health.
B ❍ ... inform readers about research linking oral bacteria to brain health and dementia.
C ❍ ... argue that dementia can be completely prevented through oral hygiene.
D ❍ ... entertain readers with an amusing take on dental health and memory loss.

Item 8 **The mode of discourse used in the text is.....**

A ❍ ...narration
B ❍ ...exposition
C ❍ ...persuasion
D ❍ ...description

Item 9 **The transitional phrase 'on the other hand' paragraph 8 shows..**

A ❍ ... cause and effect
B ❍ ... definition
C ❍ ... enumeration
D ❍ ...contrast

Item 10 **Which two patterns of organisation are used in paragraph 9?**

A ❍ ...comparison and chronological order
B ❍ ...contrast and cause and effect
C ❍ ...enumeration and classification/division
D ❍ ...steps in a process and cause and effect

Item 11 **The main finding of the study on oral bacteria and brain function was that....**

A ❍ ... all bacteria in the mouth contribute to brain decline.
B ❍ ... some bacteria are linked to better memory and cognitive function, while others may indicate cognitive decline.
C ❍ ... no significant link between oral bacteria and brain health was found.
D ❍ ... only gum disease bacteria affect brain function.

Item 12 **The two bacterial groups associated with better cognitive performance are...**

A ❍ ... Prevotella and Porphyromonas
B ❍ ... Streptococcus and Lactobacillus
C ❍ ... Clostridium and Bacteroides
D ❍ ... Neisseria and Haemophilus.

Item 13 **By saying that '*the implications of this research are profound*' (paragraph 10) the author means...**

A ❍ ... the study findings are *new*
B ❍ ... the study findings are *obvious*
C ❍ ... the study findings are *clear*
D ❍ ... the study findings are *far-reaching*

Item 14 **A possible future application of this research is...**

A ❍ ... using oral bacteria tests to detect early signs of cognitive decline.
B ❍ ... developing antibiotics to eliminate all bacteria in the mouth.
C ❍ ...encouraging people to stop eating leafy greens.
D ❍ ...replacing dental checkups with brain scans.

Item 15 **The text concludes with...**

A ❍ ... a shocking statistic
B ❍ ... a quote
C ❍ ... a recommendation
D ❍ ... a summary

Paraphrasing

Read the article below and select the best paraphrase from the options that follow.

Mark a cross in the field which corresponds to your choice for each item.

Choose the best answer for items 16-20 (A, B, C or D).

The Importance of Student Participation in Language Classes

(1) Active student participation in language classes is crucial for developing fluency, confidence, and deeper linguistic competence, particularly for B2+ undergraduate ESL students. At this level, learners have already acquired foundational grammar and vocabulary, but their ability to engage in spontaneous, complex communication **remains a key challenge**. Regular participation in discussions, debates, and collaborative activities provides opportunities for students to practice real-world language use, enhancing both their receptive and productive skills. Speaking and interacting in class help students internalize structures, improve pronunciation, and refine their ability to express ideas. Moreover, participation enhances critical thinking, as students must analyze arguments, formulate responses, and negotiate meaning in real time.

(2) Beyond linguistic benefits, engagement in classroom activities builds confidence. Many ESL learners struggle with anxiety or fear of making mistakes, **which can hinder progress**. A dynamic, participatory environment encourages risk-taking, where errors are seen as learning opportunities rather than failures. Peer interaction also facilitates cultural and pragmatic understanding, allowing students to develop a sense of appropriateness in different contexts. Additionally, **active participation enhances retention**—students who speak, write, and listen actively retain information more effectively than passive learners.

(3) Finally, participation develops essential academic and professional skills. In university settings and future workplaces, **students must articulate ideas clearly**, work collaboratively, and engage in discussions. Language classes provide a safe environment to practice these skills. Thus, fostering student participation not only **accelerates language acquisition** but also prepares students for real-world communication, making it a vital aspect of ESL learning at the B2+ level.

Select the most correct paraphrase for each of the phrases below.

Item 16 remains a key challenge...(par 1)

A ❍ is still important...
B ❍ continues to be a basic obstacle...
C ❍ has always been an issue...
D ❍ stays a problem...

Item 17 which can hinder progress.. (par 2)

A ❍ that can stop you from developing
B ❍ that can help you develop
C ❍ that can slow development
D ❍ that can encourage growth

Item 18 active participation enhances retention ...(par 2)

A ❍ being present helps you retain
B ❍ getting involved is vital
C ❍ not being passive is better for understanding
D ❍ actually taking part increases absorption

Item 19 students must articulate ideas clearly ...(par 3)

A ❍ students must speak very well
B ❍ students need to formulate thoughts well
C ❍ students have to speak with good pronunciation
D ❍ students should think of smart ideas

Item 20 accelerates language acquisition ...(par 3)

A ❍ improves language acquisition
B ❍ makes learning better
C ❍ speeds up the process of language learning
D ❍ helps learning to become easier

Vocabulary in Context

Read the text below and select the best synonym for each of the words in bold for items 21-25.

Over a billion people worldwide are obese.	
Item 21	Global **estimates** published in The Lancet reveal that over a billion people worldwide are living with obesity, with approximately 880 million adults and 159 million children affected.
Item 22	Tonga and American Samoa show the highest rates for both men and women. The UK ranks 55th for men and 87th for women out of 200 countries. Experts emphasize the urgent need for significant changes in **addressing** obesity.
Item 23	The World Health Organization **stresses** the importance of government and food industry support to combat obesity, especially among youth.
Item 24	Obesity rates have doubled in the UK over the last three decades, **alarming** researchers.
Item 25	The study underscores the rapid rise in obesity levels since 1990, urging governments to **prioritize** this health issue associated with various ailments like heart disease, diabetes, and cancer.

In the context of the passage, select the best synonym for items 21-25 (A, B, C or D).

Item 21 estimates

A ❍ guidelines
B ❍ cautions
C ❍ calculations
D ❍ suggestions

Item 22 addressing

A ❍ dealing with
B ❍ understanding
C ❍ talking about
D ❍ getting rid of

Item 23 stresses

A ❍ warns
B ❍ reveals
C ❍ predicts
D ❍ emphasises

Item 24 alarming

A ❍ concerning
B ❍ informing
C ❍ confusing
D ❍ showing

Item 25 prioritize

A ❍ understand
B ❍ put first
C ❍ get rid of
D ❍ show

Class Vocabulary Exercise I – Prefixes for Number

Choose the most appropriate word to fill the gaps in the sentences below.

Choose the best answer for each missing word in items 26-30 (A, B, C, D, E, or F).
Important: there is one extra word that you will not use!

Item 26	The peace talks between the two neighboring countries were described as a _____ negotiation, as both sides had equal participation in the discussions.
Item 27	The musical _____ performed a beautiful rendition of the classical piece, with their four voices harmonizing perfectly on stage.
Item 28	The stop sign at the intersection is in the shape of a(n) _____, having eight distinct sides.
Item 29	The renowned _____ of musicians, consisting of a pianist, a violinist, and a cellist, has been invited to perform at the international music festival.
Item 30	Despite being a(n) _____, Mr. Thompson still runs marathons and enjoys hiking in the mountains.

	septuagenarian	**octagon**	**bilateral**	**quartet**	**trio**	**unison**
Item 26	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 27	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 28	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 29	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 30	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○

Class Vocabulary Exercise II – Prefixes for Negativity and Reversal

Choose the best answer for each missing word in items 31-35 (A, B, C, D, E, or F).
Important: there is one extra word that you will not use!

Item 31	The police were able to _____ the suspect before he could cause any harm, preventing a potentially dangerous situation.
Item 32	Due to the company's financial crisis, several employees have been placed on _____ status until further notice.
Item 33	His argument was completely _____ because it contradicted itself multiple times and lacked any factual support.
Item 34	The athlete was disqualified from the race because of his _____ start, which gave him an unfair advantage over the other competitors.
Item 35	The court ruled that the contract was _____ since it had been signed under fraudulent circumstances.

	indecisive	**irregular**	**disarm**	**Illogical**	**illegitimate**	**inactive**
Item 31	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 32	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 33	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 34	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 35	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○

Reading Comprehension II

Read the article below and answer the questions.

Mark a cross in the field which corresponds to your choice for each item.
Choose the best answer for items 36-45 (A, B, C, or D).

Lifelong Learning: The Key to Success

(1) In today's fast-changing world, learning should not stop after graduation. Lifelong learning is essential for personal growth, career success, and overall happiness. Those who continuously seek knowledge stay ahead in their fields and adapt to new challenges.

(2) **The job market is evolving rapidly**, with new technologies reshaping industries. Employees who commit to learning new skills become more valuable to employers, increasing their chances of promotions and job security. In contrast, those who remain **stagnant** risk being left behind. Furthermore, businesses prefer workers who show adaptability and a willingness to develop professionally.

(3) Beyond career benefits, lifelong learning improves cognitive abilities, keeping the brain sharp and active. Studies show that people who engage in continuous education reduce their risk of mental decline and stay more engaged with the world. Whether it's reading books, taking online courses, or learning a new language, expanding knowledge boosts confidence and self-satisfaction.

(4) Some argue that learning requires too much time and effort. However, even small daily improvements lead to significant long-term benefits. A simple habit of reading for 15 minutes a day can transform one's knowledge and perspective. Investing in continuous learning not only secures a better future but also enriches one's overall quality of life.

(5) In a world that never stops evolving, neither should we. Lifelong learning is not just an option—it is a necessity for those who want to achieve success and fulfillment in life.

Item 36 **Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the text?**

A ❍ Businesses only hire employees who take online courses regularly.
B ❍ Lifelong learning is crucial for both personal and professional development.
C ❍ Learning new languages is the most important aspect of lifelong education.
D ❍ Reading for 15 minutes a day is the best way to succeed in life.

Item 37 **The author's purpose is to...**

A ❍ persuade readers that lifelong learning is essential for success and personal growth.
B ❍ inform readers about different types of education systems around the world.
C ❍ entertain readers with a story about someone who benefits from lifelong learning.
D ❍ criticise people who do not engage in continuous learning.

Item 38 **The mode of discourse used is...**

A ❍ narration
B ❍ description
C ❍ exposition
D ❍ persuasion

Item 39 **Which pattern of organisation is used in the last sentence of paragraph 3?**

A ❍ chronological order
B ❍ classification and division
C ❍ cause and effect
D ❍ definition

Item 40 **The relationship between sentence (1) and sentence (2) of paragraph 4 is one of..**

A ❍ comparison
B ❍ contrast
C ❍ cause and effect
D ❍ definition

Item 41 **By saying that the 'the job market is evolving rapidly,' (paragraph 2) the author means that...**

A ❍ the job market is continuing to grow.
B ❍ the job market is advancing at a fast pace.
C ❍ the job market is slowing down fast.
D ❍ the job market is beginning to change.

Item 42 **The word 'stagnant' (paragraph 2 line 3) as used in this context means ...**

A ❍ productive
B ❍ competitive
C ❍ difficult
D ❍ motionless

Item 43 **It is suggested that people who do not engage in lifelong learning ...**

A ❍ are more likely to struggle with adapting to changes in their careers.
B ❍ will never have the opportunity to learn new skills.
C ❍ are less intelligent than those who continue learning.
D ❍ can still succeed without ever learning something new.

Item 44 **According to the text, lifelong learning benefits the brain by...**

A ❍ preventing people from ever forgetting information.
B ❍ ensuring that people become experts in many subjects.
C ❍ helping improve cognitive abilities and reduce the risk of cognitive decline.
D ❍ ensuring that people will never face stress or anxiety.

Item 45 **The text concludes** ...

A ❍ by warning readers that without continuous education, they will fail in life.
B ❍ by encouraging the reader to view lifelong learning as a necessary and ongoing process.
C ❍ by stating that lifelong learning is only important for career success, not personal growth.
D ❍ by suggesting that lifelong learning is optional and only beneficial in certain industries.

Reading Comprehension III

Read the article below and answer the questions.

Mark a cross in the field which corresponds to your choice for each item.
Choose the best answer for items 46-50 (A, B, C, or D).

Eyelashes help fling water from our eyes

By Emily Conover.

The hairs' water-wicking abilities could help keep vision clear of rain, sweat and tears

(1) Next time you're caught in the rain, thank your eyelashes for keeping your vision clear. Several traits help eyelashes fling water away from the eyes, a new study finds.

(2) One secret to their water-wicking superpower is their structure. The outside of an eyelash, or cuticle, is covered in scales. These scales overlap like shingles on a roof. That structure acts like a "micro-ratchet," researchers in China now find. Water can flow easily from root to tip, but not the other way round.
In one experiment, scientists dipped loose eyelashes in water and pulled them out again. More force was required to move the eyelash when the water was working against the ratchet than when going with it.

(3) In another test, researchers dripped water on loose eyelashes. This showed that eyelashes are hydrophobic. That is, water beads up on them and tends to roll off.

(4) A team at the Chinese Academy of Sciences in Beijing did the research. It shared the new findings December 20 in *Science Advances*.

(5) Eyelashes also are shaped like a brachistochrone (Bra-KIS-toh-kroan). This type of curve minimizes the time it takes to get from point A to B under the force of gravity.

(6) To test how this might affect the ability of eyelashes to remove water, the scientists worked with nylon fibers. These had a size and stretchiness similar to eyelashes.

(7) They compared fibers in the shape of a brachistochrone to those that were were straight or curved in some other shape. The droplets slid fastest off the brachistochrone.

(8) Eyelashes were already known to guard against dust. But they hadn't been known for their water-flicking traits. This newfound effect could help keep vision clear when out in the rain, bathing, sweating or crying.

(9) Beauty treatments could mess with this ability, though. Mascara can make eyelashes attract water instead of repelling it. And curling lashes alters their shape.

Item 46 **The primary purpose of the text is to...**

A ❍ explain the different beauty treatments that can affect eyelashes.
B ❍ describe how eyelashes protect against dust and dirt.
C ❍ present scientific findings on how eyelashes remove water from the eyes.
D ❍ compare human eyelashes with those of other animals.

Item 47 **In wet conditions, the main function of eyelashes is to...**

A ❍ absorb water to keep the eyes moisturised.
B ❍ help remove water from the eyes to maintain clear vision.
C ❍ trap water to prevent it from reaching the eyes.
D ❍ act as a filter for dust and dirt particles.

Item 48 **The brachistochrone shape of eyelashes helps water removal by...**

A ❍ slowing down water droplets, allowing time for evaporation.
B ❍ preventing water droplets from forming.
C ❍ minimising the time it takes for water droplets to slide off.
D ❍ absorbing water and then releasing it slowly.

Item 49 **The relationship between sentence (1) and (2) of paragraph 8 is one of..**

A ❍ comparison
B ❍ cause and effect
C ❍ definition
D ❍ contrast

Item 50 **A possible consequence of beauty treatments like mascara and eyelash curling is...**

A ❍ they can make eyelashes attract water instead of repelling it.
B ❍ they can make eyelashes dry and brittle.
C ❍ they can permanently change the shape of the eye.
D ❍ they can make eyelashes grow in random directions.

Spring 2026 LAN 100 MOCK Midterm ANSWER SHEET

Name: _____ UCY ID Number: _____
Section: _____ Instructor: _____

Instructions: Write the letter of your choice neatly in the space provided for items 1-50. It is preferable to use capital letters: A, B, C, D, E or F.

Transitions/Transitional Phrases: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 1	
Item 2	
Item 3	
Item 4	
Item 5	

Reading Comprehension I: (10x2=20 points)	
Item 6	
Item 7	
Item 8	
Item 9	
Item 10	

Reading Comprehension I (continued)	
Item 11	
Item 12	
Item 13	
Item 14	
Item 15	

Paraphrasing: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 16	
Item 17	
Item 18	
Item 19	
Item 20	

Vocabulary in Context: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 21	
Item 22	
Item 23	
Item 24	
Item 25	

Class Vocabulary Ex I (5x2=10)	
Item 26	
Item 27	
Item 28	
Item 29	
Item 30	

Class Vocabulary Ex II: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 31	
Item 32	
Item 33	
Item 34	
Item 35	

Reading Compréhension II: (10x2=20 points)	
Item 36	
Item 37	
Item 38	
Item 39	
Item 40	
Item 41	
Item 42	
Item 43	
Item 44	
Item 45	

Reading Compréhension III: (5x2=10)	
Item 46	
Item 47	
Item 48	
Item 49	
Item 50	

MOCK FINAL EXAM

STUDENT NAME: _____

STUDENT ID: _____

SECTION: _____

INSTRUCTOR: _____

University of Cyprus
Language Centre

Language Exam

LAN 100 MOCK Final Exam (Pilot Phase)

Fall [illegible]

B2

SECTIONS	ACTIVITIES	DURATION	POINTS
I	Reading comprehension and linguistic competence	90 minutes	90
II	Writing	30 minutes	10

INSTRUCTIONS

- Use black or blue ink
- Fill in the boxes at the top of the ANSWER SHEET with your name, and student ID number
- Answer all questions in Section I
- Total time to complete: 120 minutes

SECTION I – READING COMPREHENSION AND LINGUISTIC COMPETENCE [90 POINTS]

INSTRUCTIONS

You are advised to spend 90 minutes answering the questions in this section.
While you are reading, write your answers here on the question paper.
Answer all the questions.
Give only one answer for each question.
Copy your answers onto the answer sheet at the end of the exam (items 1 - 45).

Transition/Transitional Phrases I

You are working as an editor for *The New York Times*. Your task is to choose the most appropriate transition/ transitional phrase to fill the gaps in the sentences below (items 1-5).

Choose the best answer for each missing word in items 1-5 (A, B, C, D, E, or F).
Important: there is one extra word that you will not use!

Item 1	The rapid expansion of urban areas has created opportunities for economic growth and improved living standards. _____, advancements in transportation have allowed cities to become better connected, facilitating trade and the movement of people.
Item 2	_____, urbanization has also led to significant challenges, including overcrowding and environmental degradation. The increase in vehicles, for instance, has contributed to poor air quality, affecting public health.
Item 3	_____, rising housing demands have caused property prices to soar, making it difficult for lower-income families to afford adequate housing.
Item 4	_____, governments must implement policies that promote sustainable urban development while addressing social inequalities.
Item 5	_____, community engagement plays a key role in ensuring these policies are effective, as residents can provide valuable insights into local needs. By addressing these issues holistically, cities can evolve into inclusive and sustainable environments that benefit all their inhabitants.

	finally	furthermore	specifically	as a result	similarly	in contrast
Item 1	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 2	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 3	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 4	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○
Item 5	**A** ○	**B** ○	**C** ○	**D** ○	**E** ○	**F** ○

Reading Comprehension I

Read the article below and decide the best answer for each of the questions that follow.

Choose the best answer for items 6-15 (A, B, C or D).

Black Friday and Buy Nothing Day

(1) Black Friday is the day after the American holiday of Thanksgiving, which is celebrated on the fourth Thursday of November. Because it is a holiday in the United States, it has long been a popular day for consumers to start shopping for Christmas. Over the last 20 years big retailers have started to offer discounts and bargains on this day, and it has become more and more popular. Last year, people in the USA spent an estimated $54.7 billion between Black Friday and Cyber Monday (the Monday after Thanksgiving, when people often buy more online). The idea of Black Friday has also spread around the world. For example, in 2017, people in the UK spent the equivalent of $10.3 billion, in Germany $7.6 billion and in France $6.2 billion.

(2) Many of us love to get a bargain, but some feel that events like Black Friday encourage people to buy things that they don't really need and can't afford. Many people seem to completely lose control of both their spending and their tempers. It is easy to find video online of customers physically fighting each other over bargains. It is also argued that Black Friday is bad for small shopkeepers, who cannot afford to offer the kinds of price cuts that the big companies can.

(3) Instead of taking the opportunity to buy as much as possible on Black Friday, you could do the opposite and buy absolutely nothing. Since 1997, Buy Nothing Day has been held on the same day as Black Friday. The rules are simple. Just don't buy anything at all for 24 hours. Many people are surprised how difficult this actually is. The aim is to make people think more about their spending and to make better decisions about what they buy and where they buy it from.

(4) As well as spending less and not buying unnecessary items, Buy Nothing Day aims to raise awareness of how to be a more ethical consumer. For example, you can avoid buying 'fast fashion', that is, very cheap clothes that are worn a few times before being thrown away. Or you could decide not to automatically upgrade your mobile at the end of a contract. These kinds of decisions can help to protect the environment as well as saving you money.

(5) Some people carry out protests at shopping centres. Others avoid the shops completely and go for a walk in nature instead. Another alternative, the Buy Nothing Coat Exchange, is an idea which is spreading. People donate winter coats throughout November and anyone who needs one can come and take one on Buy Nothing Day.

Black Friday and Buy Nothing Day | LearnEnglish

Item 6 **Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the text?**

A ❍ To explain the history and global spread of Black Friday as a shopping event.
B ❍ To compare Black Friday and Buy Nothing Day, highlighting their purposes and effects on consumer behaviour.
C ❍ To argue that Black Friday is harmful to small businesses and promotes unnecessary spending.
D ❍ To describe the environmental benefits of avoiding fast fashion and upgrading electronics less frequently.

Item 7 **The author's purpose in the text is to.....**

A ❍ ... persuade readers to participate in Buy Nothing Day instead of Black Friday.
B ❍ ... inform readers about the history and global impact of Black Friday.
C ❍ ... explain to readers how to think critically about their spending habits and the ethical implications of consumerism.
D ❍ ... criticize the behaviour of people who shop during Black Friday sales.

Item 8 **The mode of discourse used in the text is.....**

A ❍ ... narration
B ❍ ... exposition
C ❍ ...persuasion
D ❍ ... description

Item 9 **Which pattern of organisation is used in the final sentence of paragraph 1?**

A ❍ ... cause and effect
B ❍ ... definition
C ❍ ...example
D ❍ ... chronological order

Item 10 **Which pattern of organisation is used in the first sentence of paragraph 2?**

A ❍ ... comparison
B ❍ ... contrast
C ❍ ...definition
D ❍ ... steps in a process

Item 11 **Black Friday is known for being a day....**

A ❍ ... to celebrate Thanksgiving
B ❍ ... for starting Christmas shopping with discounts
C ❍ ... dedicated to online shopping
D ❍ ... for small businesses to offer bargains

Item 12 **One argument against Black Friday is that it...**

A ❍ ... helps large retailers gain more customers
B ❍ ... encourages over-spending and unnecessary purchases
C ❍ ... creates a shortage of online products
D ❍ ... promotes environmental sustainability

Item 13 **The purpose of Buy Nothing Day is to...**

A ❍ ... promote discounts at small shops
B ❍ ... encourage people to buy only local products
C ❍ ... raise awareness of ethical consumption and reduce spending
D ❍ ... create a day for sharing shopping tips

Item 14 **Which of the following is an example of ethical consumer behaviour mentioned in the text?**

A ❍ ... Buying multiple items on sale during Black Friday
B ❍ ... Purchasing fast fashion to save money
C ❍ ... Donating a winter coat to the Buy Nothing Coat Exchange

D ❍ ...Upgrading your phone at the end of a contract

Item 15 Some people protest against Black Friday by....

A ❍ ... spending money on eco-friendly products
B ❍ ... organizing sales for small businesses
C ❍ ... avoiding shopping and engaging in alternative activities like walking in nature
D ❍ ... offering larger discounts than big retailers

Paraphrasing

Read the article below and select the best paraphrase from the options that follow.

Mark a cross in the field which corresponds to your choice for each item.

Choose the best answer for items 16-20 (A, B, C or D).

Time Management Tips for Students

Effective time management is crucial for undergraduate students to balance academic responsibilities, personal commitments, and leisure activities. ***Developing this skill enhances productivity*** and reduces stress. Here are some strategies to help manage time effectively:

1. Create a Calendar: List all upcoming deadlines, exams, social events, and other commitments. Use tools like Google Calendar or Outlook to visualize your schedule and ***ensure nothing is overlooked***.
2. Set Reminders: Use alarms or alerts to prompt you about approaching deadlines or tasks, helping you stay on track and avoid last-minute rushes.
3. Prioritize Tasks: Identify tasks based on their urgency and importance. The Eisenhower Matrix ***can assist in distinguishing between tasks that are urgent and important***, allowing you to focus on what truly matters.
4. Avoid Procrastination: Break tasks into smaller, manageable parts to make them less daunting. Setting specific goals and deadlines for each part can help maintain momentum.
5. Schedule Breaks: Incorporate short breaks between study sessions **to *rejuvenate and maintain focus***. Techniques like the Pomodoro Technique, which involves working for 25 minutes followed by a 5-minute break, can be effective.
6. Learn to Say No: Recognize your limits and avoid overcommitting. Politely declining additional tasks or social events when your schedule is full helps maintain balance.
7. Seek Support: Collaborate with classmates for group studies or find an accountability partner to stay motivated. Utilize academic resources offered by your institution for additional assistance.
8. Be Flexible: Understand that unexpected events may occur. Being adaptable and adjusting your schedule as needed ***ensures you remain on track without added stress***.

By implementing these strategies, undergraduate students can enhance their time management skills, leading to improved academic performance and overall well-being.

8 Time Management Tips for Students - Harvard Summer School

Select the most correct paraphrase for each of the phrases below.

Item 16 developing this skill enhances productivity

A ❍ acquiring this skill builds productivity
B ❍ learning this ability boosts efficiency
C ❍ mastering this skill decreases focus
D ❍ improving this skill eliminates the need for effort

Item 17 **ensure nothing is overlooked**

A ❍ guarantee that everything is delayed
B ❍ make sure everything is ignored
C ❍ confirm that no detail is missed
D ❍ focus only on the most important tasks

Item 18 **can assist in distinguishing between tasks that are urgent and important**

A ❍ helps identify tasks that can be ignored completely
B ❍ can prioritize only the easiest tasks
C ❍ assists in ignoring urgent tasks entirely.
D ❍ helps differentiate between tasks that require immediate attention and those of high importance

Item 19 **to rejuvenate and maintain focus**

A ❍ to lose energy and become distracted
B ❍ to refresh yourself and stay concentrated
C ❍ to avoid breaks and work continuously
D ❍ to procrastinate and reduce focus

Item 20 **ensures you remain on track without added stress**

A ❍ guarantees you will fall behind but feel relaxed
B ❍ helps you stay focused while avoiding unnecessary pressure
C ❍ forces you to work harder with more stress
D ❍ encourages taking on extra work to stay ahead.

Vocabulary Exercise I

Read the text below and select the best synonym for each of the words in bold.

The Rise of Remote Work	
Item 21	The rapid advancement of technology has significantly reshaped the modern workplace. In recent years, remote work has become a **prominent** feature of professional life, with many organizations embracing it as a viable alternative to traditional office setups. This shift has been accelerated by global events, such as the COVID-19 pandemic, which forced companies to adapt to new ways of operating.
Item 22	Proponents of remote work argue that it offers numerous advantages, such as increased flexibility, reduced **commuting** time, and the ability to tap into a global talent pool. Employees, in turn, often report higher job satisfaction due to improved work-life balance.
Item 23	However, remote work is not without its challenges. Issues such as feelings of isolation, difficulty in maintaining boundaries between work and personal life, and the need for reliable technology can **hinder** its effectiveness.
Item 24	Despite these drawbacks, the **trend** toward remote work continues to grow.
Item 25	Many experts believe that **hybrid** models, combining in-office and remote work, represent the future of employment, allowing organizations to enjoy the best of both worlds.

In the context of the passage, choose the best synonym for items 21-25 (A, B, C or D).

Item 21 prominent

A ❍ significant
B ❍ minor
C ❍ common
D ❍ invisible

Item 22 commuting

A ❍ travelling
B ❍ staying
C ❍ relaxing
D ❍ settling

Item 23 hinder

A ❍ block
B ❍ promote
C ❍ encourage
D ❍ simplify

Item 24 trend

A ❍ pattern
B ❍ disruption
C ❍ surprise
D ❍ decline

Item 25 hybrid

A ❍ combination
B ❍ separation
C ❍ uniformity
D ❍ division

Transition Exercise II

Choose the most appropriate transition/transitional phrase to fill the gaps in the sentences below (items 26-30).

Choose the best answer (A, B, C, D, E, or F).
Important: there is one extra word that you will not use!

Traveling can be an enriching experience; _____ (26), it often comes with challenges. _____ (27), planning a trip requires careful budgeting and organization. Moreover, travellers must consider factors such as weather conditions, cultural differences, and language barriers. _____ (28) these logistical concerns, some may find it difficult to adapt to new environments. Nevertheless, the benefits of exploring new places often outweigh the drawbacks. For example, traveling provides opportunities to meet people from diverse backgrounds, which can broaden one's perspective. Similarly, it allows individuals to develop problem-solving skills by facing unfamiliar situations. Furthermore, experiencing different cuisines and traditions can lead to greater cultural appreciation. _____ (29) these advantages, it is crucial to be mindful of sustainability while traveling. _____ (30), eco-friendly practices, such as minimizing waste and supporting local businesses, should be prioritized. In conclusion, while traveling requires effort and planning, the rewards it offers make it a worthwhile pursuit.

	for instance	for this reason	however	although	in addition to	despite
Item 26	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 27	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 28	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 29	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍
Item 30	**A** ❍	**B** ❍	**C** ❍	**D** ❍	**E** ❍	**F** ❍

Vocabulary Exercise III

For each of the words in bold, select the word closest in meaning based on the context of each sentence. Choose the best answer for each missing word in items 31-35 (A, B, C, or D).

Item 31	Engaging in group discussions allows students to explore **diverse** perspectives and refine their analytical skills.
Item 32	The professor emphasized the importance of citing reliable sources to ensure the **validity** of academic work.
Item 33	Many students struggle to balance their academic responsibilities with **extracurricular** activities, especially during exam periods.
Item 34	The research project required students to design a detailed methodology that addressed ethical **considerations**.
Item 35	Effective time management is a critical skill that can significantly **enhance** academic performance and reduce stress.

Item 31 **diverse**
A ❍ unique
B ❍ varied
C ❍ limited
D ❍ specific

Item 32 **validity**
A ❍ accuracy
B ❍ originality
C ❍ relevance
D ❍ strength

Item 33 **extracurricular**
A ❍ optional
B ❍ additional
C ❍ recreational
D ❍ non-academic

Item 34 **considerations**
A ❍ decisions
B ❍ factors
C ❍ beliefs
D ❍ opinions

Item 35 **enhance**
A ❍ improve
B ❍ support
C ❍ measure
D ❍ explain

Reading Comprehension II

Read the article below and answer the questions.

Mark a cross in the field which corresponds to your choice for each item.
Choose the best answer for items 36-45 (A, B, C, or D).

Microsoft Word AI 'to improve writing'

7 May 2019

A new feature in Microsoft's Word aims to help improve writing beyond the usual grammar fixes.

(1) Using artificial intelligence, Ideas will suggest rewrites for **clunky** sentences as well as changes to make sure language is gender inclusive.

(2) It will help users lay out different parts of a document, including tables, and suggest synonyms and **alternative** phrases to make writing more concise.

(3) It will be cloud-based and initially available to users of Word Online only.

(4) A test version of Ideas will go live in June, becoming more widely available in the autumn.

(5) It was announced at Microsoft's Build developer conference in Seattle.

Human creativity

(6) In a blogpost to explain the changes, Microsoft said: "Writing requires a dash of **uniquely** human creativity. Artificial intelligence alone cannot do it for us, at least not very well. But AI can - and already is - helping us do things like make sure we spell words correctly and use correct grammar.

(7) "As the AI in these products is becoming more sophisticated, they are helping us do more than spot a mis-spelled word."

(8) Rival Google announced its own AI-based writing tool for Google Docs recently, which it promised would be more than just a grammar-checker, being able to detect "**nuances**" in language.

(9) Writer and AI expert Calum Chace said he thought the advance of AI in the **sphere** of writing could "only be a good thing".

(10) "It began with predictive text and the next evolution will be making changes to sentences, then entire paragraphs," he said.

(11) "The more AI can take the low-level composing work off the shoulders of journalists and other writers, the better, but I don't think that AI will replace human creativity."

Item 36 **Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this text?**

A ❍ Microsoft Word's new AI feature, Ideas, focuses on enhancing writing by suggesting improvements, ensuring inclusivity, and aiding document organization, while emphasizing the complementary role of AI in creative tasks.
B ❍ Google Docs' new AI tool is a more advanced version of a grammar checker that detects nuances in language.
C ❍ Microsoft and Google are competing to create AI tools that will replace human creativity in writing.
D ❍ AI tools like Microsoft's Ideas are designed to perform low-level writing tasks, eliminating the need for human writers altogether.

Item 37 **The author's purpose is to...**

A ❍ persuade readers to use Microsoft Word's new AI feature, Ideas, for better writing.
B ❍ inform readers about advancements in AI-driven writing tools and their role in assisting, not replacing, human creativity.
C ❍ compare the features of Microsoft Word's Ideas and Google's AI-based writing tool.
D ❍ criticize the use of AI in writing for potentially undermining human creativity.

Item 38 **The mode of discourse used is...**

A ❍ narration
B ❍ description
C ❍ exposition
D ❍ persuasion

Item 39 **The transition word 'but' (p6) indicates...**

A ❍ comparison
B ❍ contrast
C ❍ definition
D ❍ example

Item 40 **The text uses all of the following except...**

A ❍ quotes
B ❍ examples
C ❍ opinions
D ❍ statistics

Item 41 **The word 'clunky' (p1 line 1) as used in this context means ...**

A ❍ not easy to read
B ❍ grammatically incorrect
C ❍ extremely detailed
D ❍ extremely rude

Item 42 **The word 'alternative' (p2 line 2) as used in this context means ...**

A ❍ a better option
B ❍ another option
C ❍ a worse option
D ❍ a similar option

Item 43 **The word 'uniquely' (p6 line 1) as used in this context means ...**

A ❍ something strange
B ❍ something obvious
C ❍ something easy
D ❍ something special

Item 44 **The phrase 'nuances' (p8 line 2) as used in this context means ...**

A ❍ small problems
B ❍ slight differences
C ❍ large changes
D ❍ some issues

Item 45 **The word 'sphere' (p9 line 1) as used in this context means ...**

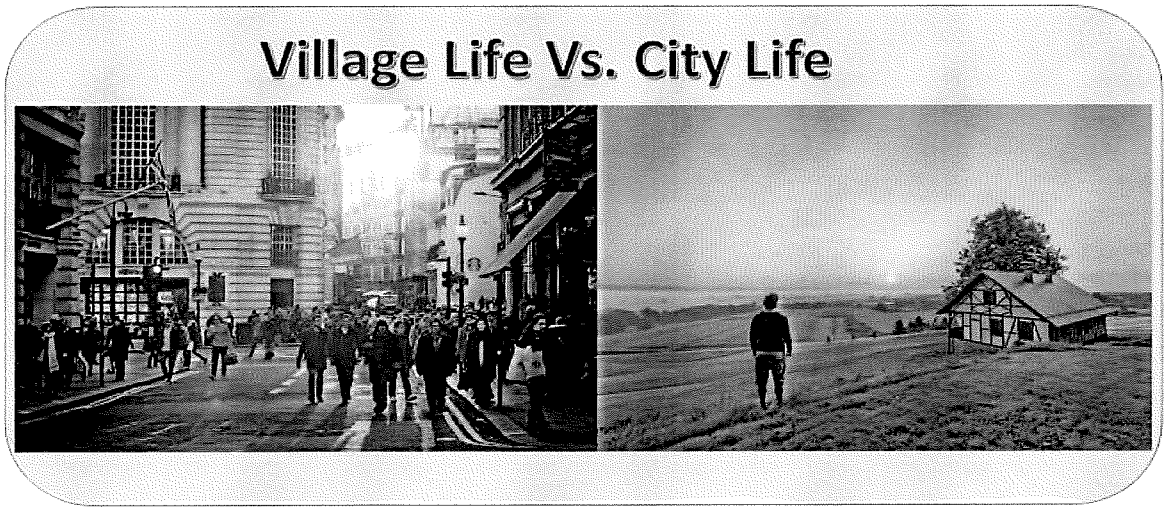
A ❍ general area
B ❍ specific knowledge
C ❍ specific decade
D ❍ general history

SECTION II – WRITING [10 POINTS]

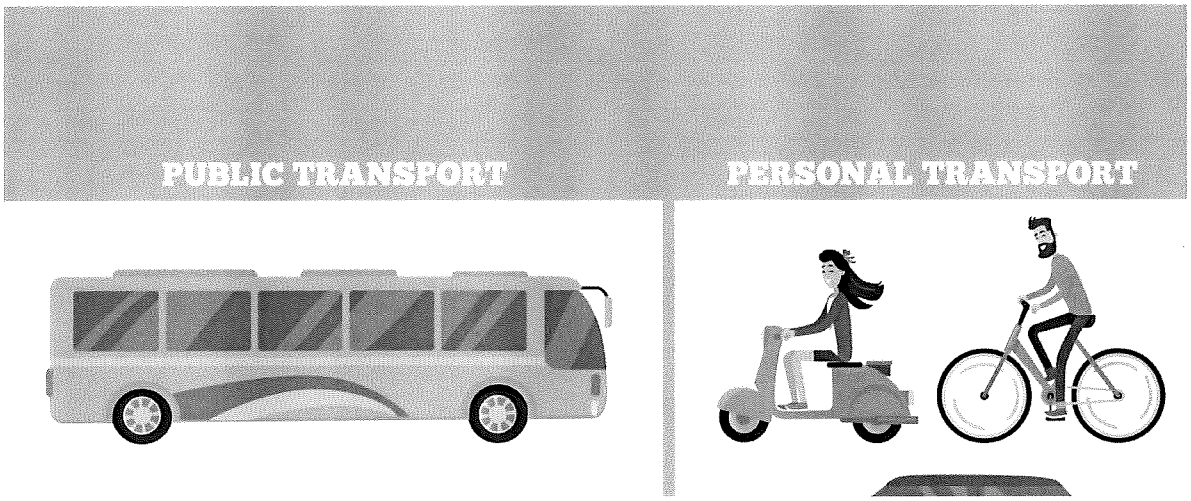
INSTRUCTIONS
You are advised to spend 30 minutes on this section.
You can write a draft of your text on the space provided
Write the final version of your text on the answer sheet.

Choose and answer **one** of the following topics.

Option 1
Compare and contrast city life versus rural life.



Option 2
Compare and contrast using public transport versus owning a car.



Write approximately **150-200** words. Count your words and write the total number at the end of your answer in brackets.

Notes (Ungraded)

(278)

Write the final version of your text **on the separate answer sheet.**

Fall 2025 LAN 100 MOCK Final Exam ANSWER SHEET Sections I and II (Pilot Phase)

Name: _____ **UCY ID Number:** _____
Section: _____ **Instructor:** _____

Instructions: Write the letter of your choice neatly in the space provided for items 1-45. It is preferable to use capital letters: A, B, C, D, E or F.

Transitions/Transitional Phrases: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 1	
Item 2	
Item 3	
Item 4	
Item 5	

Reading Comprehension I: (10x2=20 points)	
Item 6	
Item 7	
Item 8	
Item 9	
Item 10	

Reading Comprehension I (continued)	
Item 11	
Item 12	
Item 13	
Item 14	
Item 15	

Paraphrasing: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 16	
Item 17	
Item 18	
Item 19	
Item 20	

Vocabulary Exercise I: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 21	
Item 22	
Item 23	
Item 24	
Item 25	

Vocabulary Exercise II (5x2=10)	
Item 26	
Item 27	
Item 28	
Item 29	
Item 30	

Vocabulary Ex III: (5x2=10 points)	
Item 31	
Item 32	
Item 33	
Item 34	
Item 35	

Reading Comprehension II: (10x2=20 points)	
Item 36	
Item 37	
Item 38	
Item 39	
Item 40	

Reading Comprehension II: (continued)	
Item 41	
Item 42	
Item 43	
Item 44	
Item 45	

Grading

Items 1-45	____/90
Writing	____/10
Total	____/100

Section II: Writing (10 Points)

Instructions: Write your completed comparison and contrast paragraph here. Only this paragraph will be graded. Write approximately 150-200 words.

Number of words: _____